

A woman with long, wavy blonde hair and blue eyes is standing on a sandy beach at sunset. She is wearing a black and white horizontally striped bikini top and matching bottoms. She is looking directly at the camera with a slight smile. The background shows the ocean and a bright sunset sky with silhouettes of rocks.

HIS
WIFE
WOULD NEVER
CROSS
THAT
LINE

JUST WATCH ME

KENNY WRIGHT

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JUST WATCH ME

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Chapter 1

Nuance

I watched Danielle laugh on the other side of the lounge. Her face always glowed when she did, and after three days under the Hawaiian sun, her rich tan made it shine. A man in his late 30s leaned beside her at the bar. He would have been handsome if he didn't have the tendency to smile out of the corner of his mouth. He didn't have a chance. I didn't need to hear their conversation to know that, but the sight still left my stomach tight and my heart fluttering.

We'd been playing this game for close to a year. Danielle would go into the bar; I'd follow separately and settle in somewhere with a view. Men would circle her in the darkness and I'd watch. Even after seeing it half a dozen times, it was electrifying. Usually, they'd flirt, buy her a drink, dance if there was a dance floor and she'd shown an interest in the guy.

Afterwards, we'd reunite and have explosive sex.

On a couple of occasions, the dancing got more intimate and we pushed our already dubious boundaries. In a sea of undulating bodies, Danielle and her man-for-the-night would melt into one. His hands would explore and Danielle would do nothing to stop them. I still remember the nauseating feeling the first time I witnessed another man kiss my wife...and how hard I fucked her at the end of the night.

Tonight, she was dressed in a haltered slip dress printed with bold, coral flowers. Perched cross-legged on her barstool throne, she looked like a Hawaiian princess. She dismissed the crooked smile of her suitor with a straight-forwardness that always caught men off guard. His smile hung for a moment as though he was unwilling to accept the rebuff. Danielle nodded again, and his cool-guy facade finally crumbled. Hands up, he backed away. His face only got ugly when he turned away from her, muttering about wasted time and wasted drinks. It was always the same.

I met her eyes across the bar, and raised my glass. She just smiled and went back to her phone.

That summed up Danielle's feelings on our game. She had fun, but never seemed to get the same enjoyment out of it. We'd flown into Maui

two days ago and I probably could have spent the last couple nights doing this; Danielle could not.

Not that I had much to complain about. We got to spend the time as a couple, free of our child and our jobs. Good jobs and a great child, but our vacations together were scarce enough that just lounging naked in our hotel room felt deviant. I didn't need the bar game to appreciate the time—but it sure was nice.

Maybe it was all the anticipation that had frayed my nerves. Maybe it was when we went dress shopping earlier today and my sexy wife modeled tiny outfits that she'd never dream of wearing back home. Or maybe it was the memory of one night back in Vegas when this game almost got out of hand. Whatever it was, my body buzzed, drunk before I even picked up a drink.

I wrote off the next guy that approached her almost immediately—not that he wasn't good looking. Tall, broad-shouldered and tanned, the guy had the kind of jaw that WPA artists used to depict the hardworking men of the U.S. of A. That was just it. Danielle didn't go for guys so generically masculine.

My attention wandered to the bar. The concierge at our hotel had directed us to this trendy little nightspot and it didn't disappoint. More lounge than club, Nuance was as polished and pretty as its clientele. A DJ played subdued beats in the corner, loud but not so loud that it overwhelmed a close conversation. Low-tabled booths filled one half of the space, separated by gauzy privacy curtains and half-filled with rich patrons who bought their booze by the bottle.

The space in front of the DJ booth was crowded with customers who'd put their drinks down and their hands up. Danielle would be out there soon enough, swallowed in the undulating sea of dancers. She didn't get the same thrill on these nights as I did, but she loved to dance.

It worked out nicely since I loved to watch.

A couple of women passed my spot, holding hands and giggling at each other. Both were brunettes, their dark hair loose and glossy in the ambient light, and both wore dresses that Dani would never wear no matter how far away from home we were: skin tight and short and intensely distracting.

I watched them without realizing it, following their swaying hips as they weaved onto the dance floor, then into one another's arms. I adjusted

myself. Fuck, that was hot. I wasn't the only guy who'd noticed them. They seemed to feed off the attention. One whispered into the other's ear and the next thing I knew, the two were kissing.

One of the guys dancing to their right stopped moving entirely to watch, slack-jawed. That's how I felt. I'd seen plenty of lesbian porn, but never the real deal. I reached for my pint, found it empty, and set it back down. My eyes never left the brunettes.

The server swooped in, breaking me out of my trance.

"You look thirsty." She followed my eyes to the dancers. The brunettes had broken off their kiss, but were still close enough to keep me hard. "Can I get you another?"

"Um, sure. Yes please." My face burned.

The waitress winked and sauntered away. I took a deep breath, remembering why I was here, and turned back to Danielle...who wasn't on the stool anymore.

Momentary panic swept through me. Why? Fuck if I knew. I'd been living with a little paranoia since these games began. It was probably a product of that. Had the newest guy been successful in chatting her up? Had she spotted me checking out the Sapphic show on the dance floor and gotten fed up? Neither of those sounded like Danielle at all, but the fear was still there.

I found her on the dance floor—with Mr. Shoulders. I blinked, making sure that it was her. I wouldn't call her petite, but even in her spindly sandals, she looked small against the other man's body.

I quickly forgot about the pseudo-lesbian show. All attention was on Danielle and how she moved against Shoulders. This wasn't that grinding freak practiced by so many out on the floor, but my wife had grown up dancing—she'd paired her Bachelor's in human resources with a ballet minor—and knew how to move her body.

Watching Danielle dance always hit me hard. She wasn't always into the guy, but she was always into the dance. It embodied all that was hot and naughty about our game. She lost herself out amidst the mass of revelers, letting the bass and rhythm and this other man's body thread through her—carry her to a place where *Danielle: working mom and dutiful wife* did not exist. She was still my Danielle, but completely new. And so fucking sexy.

With her back to the guy and her hands in her blonde hair, elbows out and hips swinging, I met her eyes. I loved those eyes: deep blue and fringed

with long lashes that curled up and up. Danielle had perfected the way to say *I'm horny* with those eyes. Did I see that look now?

Behind her, one hand on her hip, the other walking up her arm, Shoulders had only eyes for my wife. He turned her. She spun, stretching her body as her arms encircled his neck. He drew her close—

To kiss.

My heart froze. I stopped breathing.

She pulled back just before their lips met, turning her face away. I'd watched her play this game before. Some men got upset. Some men got more persistent. This man was cool enough to take it in stride. He tipped his head and nuzzled her neck, kissing until his lips were against her ear.

He whispered something. Their bodies continued to roll and pitch with the music, even as she drew back and studied him.

This was the tipping point in our game. It came every time we played it, when the possibility that things could go further hung ripe and ready for plucking. Almost every time, Danielle dispelled it with a laugh. They'd dance another number, but eventually she'd leave the guy and find me in our bed.

On a couple occasions, though, things *had* gone further. The game had gone from one being played by me and Danielle, to one in which I took a more peripheral role. The transition always made me feel sick to my stomach, yet I couldn't get enough of it. I remembered it long after the night was over and we were back to our normal lives. And when I did, I saw the other Danielle—the one who didn't just play along with my game, but was awoken by it.

So here we were again at the point of transition. Their hips were locked, legs entwined as they rocked to the music. She had an arm braced on one of those wide, thick shoulders, steadying herself as she leaned away and looked up at him.

The guy became her world. She his. And me? I was no different than the rest of this crowd, watching the inevitable seduction.

Danielle reached up with her free hand, circling it around the back of his neck to pull him close. When he was, she whispered something. He laughed, nodded, and they left the dance floor for the bar.

Disappointment warred with relief. I drank deeply at my beer as the more rational side of my brain reminded me that this was a good thing. The

last time we'd played past the tipping point had ended in disaster. This was definitely a Good Thing.

Only it could have been better. That was the reckless part of me—the one that thought of the first time she'd crossed this line back in Vegas.

I stood and headed for the spot I'd last seen Danielle. She was alone again and my disappointment grew stronger. Even though I knew it was a long shot that anything would happen, I'd built a lot of hope coming out here. Perfect locale. Perfect time to be bad. And now she was alone and Shoulders was out of the picture.

I squeezed into the spot next to her. She was checking Facebook on her phone, just passing time.

"You should have let him down quicker. Could have saved him time and money."

She noticed me for the first time, but only gave me a side-long glance. "Oh yeah? Such concern."

"You enjoy leading guys on, don't you?" I was speaking more about me than Shoulders, and felt a frustrated anger begin to build.

"What makes you think I was leading him on?"

Her smile only tweaked my ire.

"Come on, Dani. That guy was all wrong and you know it. At least give this a chance."

Her smile didn't drop, but I didn't miss the way her jaw clenched. "I wouldn't say he was *all* wrong. He certainly felt right in certain places."

"So 'right' that you chased him off?"

She looked at me out of the corner of her eyes, but didn't answer immediately

"You sure you're ready for me to go there?"

I knew that tone. She wasn't asking a question; she was answering my challenge. "You know I do."

"You're *sure* you're sure."

"I'll believe it when I see it."

The smile that crept across her lips was wicked. "OK then. Just watch me."

I saw him push through the crowd. Mr. Shoulders. Up close, I realized how handsome he was. Still more generic than her usual type, he looked like he'd stepped off the cover of a romance novel with his blonde,

structured hair and deep tan. He wore his shirt with too many buttons undone. His shoulders weren't the only thing broad about him.

I wondered why he was back. Was he back to give her a piece of his mind? He didn't look like the kind of guy who took rejection lightly. I wondered if this night was going to take a turn beyond salvaging.

I looked away before he noticed me talking to Danielle, my ears open and my fists curling. Could I even take this guy, if things got violent?

"Hey, beautiful. You waited."

"Told you I would," Danielle said.

This was unexpected.

"I got us a booth, but they're prepping it. Thought we could dance a little more while we wait."

"You know all the right things to say. I'll have to remember to reward you."

That one had to be for me. Right? She was still leading this guy on? It turned my stomach into a queasy mush, whatever her intentions.

"Like I said, those booths are pretty private. You can reward me all you want later on."

I just stood there, leaning on the bar as my head spun. I'd felt safe taunting her when I thought she was alone. Now, as I watched them settle back onto the dance floor, the safety net was gone.

I returned to my spot against the wall, drifting through the crowd like a ghost.

Was it my imagination, or was she dancing closer to him? Had she tickled the back of his neck like that before? Had they locked eyes as intensely?

"You're empty again. You want another?"

The waitress had returned, snapping my attention off the floor once again. When I looked up at her, that same knowing smile was there; she'd caught me looking again.

"Sure, I'll have one more. Why not?"

The young woman wore her brown hair in a high ponytail that shimmered auburn when it bounced. Her short black skirt and fitted blouse hinted at a nice body beneath. I groaned. Her cheeks rose high and sculpted, her nose cute and pierced with a tiny stud. Why did she have to be so pretty? For some reason, that made me feel even more perverted.

I looked back at the dance floor. My heart clutched. Danielle was kissing her broad-shouldered dance partner, openly and open-mouthed.

"It's okay, you know. I like to watch, too."

The server had returned with my lager. She surprised me when she took a seat, facing the dance floor to my left.

The unexpected nature of my newest companion made me thirst for the beer. I pulled long and deep at it as my mind scrambled for conversation.

She helped me out before I'd set my glass down. "It's why I love working here. I get to people-watch. Make up stories for them; who's going home with whom, what their lives are like outside of tonight. Why are they here?"

I felt her eyes shift to me, but didn't look.

"I guess you see a lot of crazy stuff," I said.

She had a soft laugh, just barely audible over the music. "Depends on what you consider crazy. Most of it's pretty standard drunken-bar stuff—even in an upscale spot like this. Like those two girls you saw out there? I can't tell you how many times I've seen girls make out in that very spot." I didn't miss the judgment there. "They do it to get the guys."

"So you don't think they're into each other?"

"Sorry to disappoint, dude, but not a chance. That's for show."

"And you're an expert on girl-on-girl affection?" The beer made me bold; her smile made me flirt.

"Hmm...sure, you can call me an expert." She even had dimples.

"Anyway, what I know is that they're attention whores more than lovers. And they're pretty typical."

"So what do you like?" I asked. She read into the question and smirked before I added, "When you people-watch, I mean."

"I usually look for someone with an unusual story." She waved her arm across the bar in presentation. "Most of them are here to hook up. You can tell by the way they're dressed. It starts to feel almost desperate after watching it night after night."

I had to agree, although I wondered how Danielle and I fit in. I watched Danielle lock eyes with her stranger and my insides tightened. Out there, amidst those that my voyeur-companion had called desperate, I felt like she stood out. Her floral dress may have been short, but it was far from the shortest. It clung to her without looking painted on, molding to her high, perky breasts without giving away the show. She was the approachable girl

who'd decided to take a walk on the wild side tonight. She was a dabbler amidst a bunch of sluts. That sounded pretentious, even to my beer-saturated brain, but it resonated.

The server seemed to read my mind. "Yeah, I think that chick is interesting, too. Been watching her since she came in."

"Why?" I managed to say it without squeaking.

"She's different. She's here to have a good time, but that's not dependent on her going home with someone."

"Looks like she might."

The waitress's hazel eyes studied me for a moment. I kept my focus on Danielle. I wished she wasn't smiling so much at the guy. I could almost hear it.

"Yeah, maybe."

"So what's her story?" I asked. "Or what do you think it is?"

"She's a tourist, here on vacation. That much I know."

"How?"

"She opened her tab with a bank I didn't recognize. And there's just something about how relaxed she is. We're pretty laid back here, but life isn't a vacation, you know?"

"What else?"

"Hmm... I think she does something professional. In an office."

"Like an admin assistant?" I offered.

"No, something with more responsibility. I think she manages people on some level. She seems good with people. Those kinds of skills are career skills."

My new companion was hitting a little too close to home. Danielle managed to juggle raising our son with her job in human resources at a big an enterprise-sized corporation.

"So why is she here?"

"To blow off some steam, maybe. She's far from home and can be someone she's not. Here, she's free from her normal responsibilities."

Shoulders leaned in, whispering something that made Danielle's smile turn into a laugh.

"And..." I almost said Shoulders. "That guy? What's his story?"

"Oh, I know him. Sandy comes in here all the time. Career bachelor. Successful businessman. Owns his own company on the other side of the

island.” Her dimples emerged with her smirk. “Is known to throw some wild parties at his ocean-side home. I’d say he’s plenty interesting.”

I felt like the stakes had just been raised, but didn’t know why. “He sounds like most of the others here—desperate to get laid.”

The waitress shrugged. “Maybe. But he goes home alone almost as often as he does with a girl...or two.” This one was fond of smirking. Good thing she looked so good doing it.

“You’ve watched him work. How about tonight? Think he’s got a shot?”

She tipped her head from side to side. “Could go either way.” We watched them dance. Danielle had her back to Sandy again, arms bent and reaching up. He held her by the hips as she gyrated against his. “Depends on if her husband lets it get that far.”

It took me a moment to process what she’d just said, and when I did, it was like a vat of acid had been upended inside of me.

“I... she...she’s married? How...do you know?”

The waitress had every right to look pleased with herself. She’d just confirmed her theory with my blanched expression.

“I’ve seen it a few times. Not as often as Team Sappho over there, but you’d be surprised at how often we get a playful couple in here.”

“So you think her husband is here?” I didn’t know what else to do but to play dumb.

“Oh yeah. He’s here.” She had a throaty laugh. “I better get back to work. Break’s over, but it’s been fun.” She pushed a strand of brown hair over one ear. “Don’t worry. Your secret’s safe.”

I thought of the volcanoes that dotted the Hawaiian islands. Was this what it felt like to fall into one?

The server looked at the dancing couple. “She’s hot. You’re lucky.”

As I watched her make her way back to the bar, I stifled the urge to crawl under the table and hide. Here I was, thinking the pretty young woman was flirting with me because she thought I was cute, and really it was all a mind fuck.

Every time she looked in my direction, heat bloomed inside me. I waited until she was making her rounds, then settled my tab at the bar. Then the text came.

—leaving me all alone?

I'd been so embarrassed that I'd forgotten all about my wife. Jesus, how was that even possible? When I searched the dance floor and didn't find her, my phone buzzed again.

—check the booths

I swung around to the private booths with their gauzy partitions and found Danielle sitting alone in the very farthest one, her phone in her palm. Because of the angle and the curtain, I could only see a bit of table, but it was enough to make out the bottle of champagne and two glasses. According to the menu I'd been fake-studying, that spread cost upwards of \$200, although that was probably the price of the booth.

My hands shook as I typed.

—having fun?

If they were to slip into the back of the booth, they'd be completely out of my sight—out of everyone's sight. With that angle, the only way it could have been more private was if the curtains could be pulled over the front.

My phone buzzed.

—too much fun. too bad he's "all wrong"

My cock flexed as my breath caught. She really knew how to pluck my strings. I typed her another shaky reply.

—looks like I may have been the one all wrong

Danielle looked at ease as she sat at the edge of the booth, legs crossed, bent forward to read her phone. Her golden hair fell across her eyes. She raked it back, smiling at my text. Before she could type out a reply, though, Sandy rejoined her and she slid deeper into the booth.

I found myself planted on the barstool, too stunned to stand. Everything slowed down. Seconds felt like hours. Minutes felt like days. And during that excruciating time, I saw almost nothing. I'd catch a flash of Sandy's arm as he reached for the bottle of champagne. The curtains separating them from the next booth over would ripple every now and again as a hand or a body would sweep across it. But that was all I got.

My imagination was doing a damn good job filling in the details, though—every one more over-the-top than the last. They went from kissing to groping to fucking. My heart was alive and wild, fighting to tear through my chest.

I drank water instead of beer, happy to be at the bar where I could semi-avoid my former waitress. She did swing by to pick up a round of drinks, though, but only flashed me a dimpled smile before twirling away.

That didn't help matters. I thought about leaving. I'd done that once—on our first real foray into this game—but being alone in my hotel room had been torture. There was also the thing where I wanted Danielle to see me when she finally emerged. I wanted her to remember that this was a game before she went too far.

Unless she already had.

The thought arrived like a blow to the gut. Even the bartender looked my way. "Everything cool, buddy?"

I waved him off. "More water, please."

All the liquids caught up with me a half hour later—a half hour in which they didn't emerge. I adjusted my cock before heading to the restroom, craning my neck in the hopes of getting a better angle into the booth.

I saw nothing more than vague impressions, deep in the booth's shadowy recesses. Groaning, I pushed into the private bathroom and forced my erection down as I took a piss.

Like the rest of Nuance, the bathroom was fresh and upscale. The floor was dark tile and cherry wood panels lined the lower half of the wall. The sink was a bowl sitting on a slate slab with a spout made of copper. Even the toilet was decorated with the slender shoot of an orchid.

I barely saw any of it. My mind was filled with questions and doubt. Maybe they were just chatting? Dani knew what this did to me and could be playing me. She'd done that before, leading me to believe that things had gone much farther than they actually had.

We'd discussed these fantasies at length before, and while we both agreed that they were hot, we also agreed that they were best left as fantasy. But each time we did this, we pushed closer to the line. We'd gone from me pretending to be the stranger, to flirting with strangers as I watched, to dancing and kissing them, to... this? What was this?

My cock was so hard I had to fight to get it back in my pants. And even then, I had to stand at the door and let it soften a little before opening it.

Danielle was back in Sandy's arms when I found them. They stood in front of the booth they'd been so cozy in earlier, nuzzling and kissing.

It registered in my queasy gut.

Danielle nodded at whatever Sandy whispered. He grinned and pulled out his phone. She did the same. They were exchanging numbers. OK, so maybe the edge wasn't completely gone.

The night closed out quickly after that. At least the part of the night involving Sandy and Nuance and our naughty little game. Danielle caught a cab back to our hotel, although not before sharing a long, wet make-out session with Sandy outside the bar. I waited long enough to watch Sandy watch the cab leave, shake his head with a grin, and re-enter the lounge. Then I grabbed a cab of my own.

The lights were off when I entered our hotel room. I clutched my stomach as it knotted. Had she doubled back? Had she gone back to Sandy's place instead?

Then I saw her standing by the windows, watching the ocean crash up the dark beach. The hotel door clicked shut, cutting off the light that leaked from the hall.

"Hi," I said. I couldn't see her face. I couldn't tell if she was upset or not.

"Hi."

I licked my lips. The darkness coiled around me until I couldn't breathe or move or think.

"I thought you may have left," she said softly. "Like before."

"No. I stayed." I took a step forward. "Not that I could see much."

Danielle turned, but didn't come to me. Instead, she pushed the straps of her dress from her shoulders. It pooled about her ankles, leaving her in nothing save her strapless bra and panties.

"I was bad tonight." Light caught in the whites of her eyes before her hair tumbled across her face. "I had naughty thoughts about another man."

The tension bled away. My legs found life. I began to cross the gulf between us. "How naughty?"

"Very."

My cock was as hard as it had been all night by the time I stopped before her. I pushed her blonde bangs from her face. Her lips glistened in the pale glow of the window. "These were just thoughts?"

She bit her lip and shook her head. Danielle played the wilting innocent so well. I could almost forget how naughty she could be. Dani put her hand on my chest, where my heart was going nuts. Her breasts swelled

over the cups of her bra with each short breath she took. She looked up at me. Her lashes fluttered, dark and sharp.

Our lips found each other. Her tongue was wild against mine. She pulled at my clothes and I heard a button snap in her haste. Any restraint we'd had was gone.

"You're going to pay for that."

"Baby, after what I did tonight, that's the least of what I owe you." She dropped to her knees as she yanked my pants down. I nearly came as she took me into her mouth.

"You're so hot, Dani. So fucking naughty."

The words just spilled out with little thought or consideration. The beers I'd knocked back and the things her lips were doing as they slid along my length had shut down my brain.

"It makes me so hard watching you tease other guys. Does it make you horny, too? With all that attention?"

I knew that it did, but the moan that vibrated up my cock confirmed it.

"But you were extra bad tonight, weren't you?" I said.

She moaned a "yes" without pausing her oral attention.

"You were in that booth a long time, baby. That very private booth."

She sucked harder. I groaned.

"And you weren't just talking in there, were you?"

Danielle pulled off me, a strand of saliva trailing between my cockhead and her wet lips. She wiped them with the back of one hand as she jacked me with the other.

"We didn't talk at all."

I nearly lost it. I pulled free before I did and took a deep, calming breath. I looked at the ceiling, focusing on the popcorn tiling that cast its rocky landscape, and forced my mind off sex.

I thought of the upcoming week of meetings I had, pitching my company's latest tech to some Maui-based firms. Success meant a big bonus for me and possible return trips to Hawaii.

Which meant more nights like this.

Which brought my mind back to my naughty wife. At least it was calmer now, despite how good her breasts felt as she kissed up my body. When had she removed her bra? Had her tits always felt so soft?

"So if you didn't talk, what did you do?"

She answered with a kiss. "Some of that."

“Just some?” My temporary calm was almost gone.

“Yeah, just some.”

I couldn't take the teasing. I pulled her against me with my hands on her ass, lifting her and spinning us until we could drop onto the bed. She scrambled out of her thong just in time for me to line up and sink in.

We groaned at the union. Dani tipped her head back with a happy sigh.

My voice rumbled like tires along a gravel road. “Tell me. Tell me what happened in that booth.”

“I...” She broke off in a moan. She arched up against me, her hips leaving the bed to meet my frantic fuck.

“Did he touch you here?” I palmed the side of her breast and thumbed the knotted nipple.

“Mmm...hmm...” It was more of a moan than an answer. “Yes...”

“Here?” I touched her buttocks, feeling how they squeezed with each thrust.

“Yes...”

My heart began to climb up my throat. I slipped my hand around her hip, pushed my fingers into the space between us. I danced them across her smoothly waxed mound to her clit. “What about here?”

Dani jerked as my fingers tickled her button. “Yes!”

Danielle's pussy clenched around me. She hissed her climax against my neck and ear. I could have joined her. The image of another man's hand between her legs was certainly reason enough. But instead, I drove into her harder, meeting her orgasm pound for pound.

When she came down and I slowed my pace to something just shy of calm, she spoke, her voice a hoarse croak.

“It really gets you off.”

It wasn't a question, although she'd asked it like one in the past. We'd had this conversation more times than I could recall, but we never got to the why. I didn't understand it anymore than Danielle, but the blood fueling my erection left no doubt that it turned me on.

“I love watching you be bad.”

“I was bad tonight, baby.”

“How bad? Tell me.”

“Are you sure you want to know?”

I stroked her hard, our skin slapping. My stomach twisted into a knot.

“Yes.”

“Even if I did things with him that I’ve never done with anyone but you since we got married?”

If I could find that rational side of me that I knew I had, I could have seen this game for the self-destructive thing it was. Like some kind of drug for the emotions, I kept coming back and back. How long before it destroyed me? Us?

“Tell me.”

She rolled us until she rose over me, slick skin aglow in the dim light. I could just make out her tan lines, as small as they were across her breasts and hips.

“You know how dancing turns me on? Well, Sandy was a really good dancer.”

“His name was *Sandy*?”

“I know, right? But I can assure you, he’s all man.”

My cock jerked. “I thought gym rats weren’t your type.”

She’d explained it to me in the past. Guys that look like they spend all their time in the gym or in front of a mirror were almost always conceited dickheads. I’d found this to be the case, too.

Danielle nodded and for a second, I thought she was going to tell me that Sandy was *different*. I was ready to call her out on the bullshit when she owned up to it.

“A girl can have some guilty pleasures on vacation, can’t she?”

“How guilty?” And stop teasing me! “You’re killing me, baby.”

She giggled, squeezing my cock with the walls of her pussy. “And you love it.”

“Did you fuck him?”

She leaned forward, kissing up my chest and into the crook of my neck. “Maybe I did.”

My balls tightened. “Did you?”

Danielle let the mystery hang there long enough to take me past the point of no return. Her pussy glided across my cock as it swelled, smooth and frictionless. I stopped breathing.

“I did...” Everything imploded. Darkness closed in, snuffing out the last scrap of sanity this night had. I ground my teeth, tightened my hands around her hips, and came deep inside her.

“...not.”

I barely heard the negation, and even when I did, the words didn't register.

"I wanted to, Dean. I wanted to take him inside me." Her breath shivered against my ear as she confessed. "I've never...I knew I shouldn't..."

She joined me in release, sighing as we released the evening's anxiety. She wasn't leading me on. She wasn't confessing for me. This got her as hot as it got me—and now we both knew where we stood.

Somewhere, in the deep recesses of my mind, I recognized this moment for what it was: a turning point. What did the future hold? Would this game make us stronger?

Or would it destroy this beautiful thing that we had?

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Chapter 2

Cascade

Danielle pulled her phone from her back pocket, checked it for the text, and laughed. “Apparently I missed some *killer* waves this morning.”

“Too bad you had to spend it with me.” I chuckled, glancing to my right, where we had a view of the ocean. “This hike has had nothing to offer.”

Danielle stopped, too, back-peddling into my arms as we admired the vista. The land seemed to rise straight out of the ocean more like an iceberg than an island. The steep inclines of volcanic rock were covered in verdant forest, and I must have already taken fifty photos that could have been mistaken for postcards.

“I love you, honey.” Danielle snuggled closer.

I put my arm around her. She’d warmed with our hike. I could smell her sweat just beneath the fresh scent of her deodorant. This was the woman I knew, the one who liked to hike and camp and exercise. That temptress in the bar last night was just a costume.

“I love you, too.” Still, I liked that temptress. Quite a bit. “So you going to reply?”

“Nope. He’ll take a hint. Eventually.”

Sandy had been texting all morning long. First to meet up for breakfast, then surfing lessons, and now this. So far, she hadn’t responded.

“For a player, his game feels a little desperate. I thought you were supposed to wait at least a couple days before calling.”

I still wasn’t sure how I felt about Sandy having my wife’s number at all—that felt dangerous in the light of the morning—but so far, she’d seemed disinterested in continuing the flirtation.

Danielle shrugged. “He knows I’m here on vacation and that his window’s pretty narrow.”

And that he really, really wants you? If what the waitress last night had said was true, Sandy was a guy who had no problem with the ladies. That he was texting Dani the morning after said a lot—a thing that wasn’t lost on either of us. After the first invite came in, we’d taken a shower together that involved a hell of a lot more than just getting each other clean.

“Come on.” She pulled free and turned back to the steep trail. “We’re only halfway up and I’m getting hungry.”

The view while hiking behind Danielle was actually better than anything I saw at the bluffs that we stopped at along the way. She wore a pair of khaki hiking shorts that hugged her hips and covered only the very tops of her taut thighs. The tank top was tight enough to compliment her slender torso, but the thing I loved most were the white straps of her bra I could see where the tank top didn’t cover. If the summit was empty, I already had ideas of how our lunch would go.

Unfortunately, it was far from empty. We’d seen a few people coming down on our way up, but that didn’t prepare me for the crowd milling about the rocky overlook. When I saw the view, I realized why.

The islands we’d spotted on the hike to the top were all below us, and beyond stretched endless sparkling ocean. We settled onto a boulder and looked out.

“This is incredible.”

I nodded, at a loss for words.

“Bobby would love it here,” she said.

I craned my head over the sharp drop. That would be a hard fall. “He would, but I’m kind of glad he’s not. You wouldn’t be able to relax.”

“Fair enough.” Dani laughed. The breeze rustled through her blonde hair. “Fair enough. And he’s probably having more fun with his friends at camp than with his boring parents.”

“Yeah. Very boring parents.”

We stared out at the horizon.

“We’re so small,” Dani said. “Puts things into perspective, you know?”

I shook my head.

“It’s so easy to get caught up in the minutiae. I see it at work all the time. Office politics. Raises. Whether the guy in the mailroom likes them. Is there going to be an office picnic and why can’t I bring my dog?”

I grinned at that; Danielle was in charge of the picnic and it was a headache every year.

“Look out there, Dean, and tell me why any of that matters. In the grand scheme of things.”

She wasn’t wrong. “And what about getting Bobby to soccer practice a few minutes late?” I asked, thinking about how she fretted with our son and

his scheduled life. “Or making sure the toilet seat is down? Or that the bathroom is always spotless?”

“You’re right. It goes for us as well.”

In the distance, beyond the island, we watched a fishing boat no bigger than a raisin troll along the shallows. I thought about our dangerous fantasies. “Goes for more than just that everyday stuff.”

She kissed my neck. “I know. That’s what I was thinking about, actually.”

I looked at her. Her beautiful face eclipsed even the majesty of the view.

“I’ll always love you, Dani. No matter what. That’s real. That’s not minutiae.”

“I love you, too, baby.”

Our kiss started sweet and ended deep and profound. When it broke, we turned and looked across the world.

An elderly couple made their way into the clearing. Each was armed with hiking poles and were huffing by the time they stopped and looked out over the vista. They were smiling.

I nudged Danielle. She followed my gaze. The couple was holding hands. Dani snuggled closer.

“That’s what I want us to be like when we grow up.”

I did, too. More than anything.

“Sometimes, I get caught up in nights like last night and it scares me,” she said.

“Me, too. But you never know. That couple over there could be wilder than us. They still could be. Does that mean they love each other any less?”

“You’re right. I mean, I know you’re right. It’s just...” Dani blushed—something she rarely let herself do. “You don’t know the things I want to do when I get caught up.”

Things took a turn to the erotic. My trousers tightened.

“Do you think you’d ever get so caught up that you wouldn’t love me anymore?” I asked.

“No. Of course not. I don’t think that could ever happen, baby. You’re an awesome husband and an amazing father. Sometimes I can’t believe how lucky I am.” She looked back out at the ocean. “I guess what I’m saying is that I’m afraid you’d hate me. That *I’d lose you.*”

I couldn't stop staring at her. I couldn't. I loved how her blonde brows pinched and her forehead furrowed. I loved the intensity in her blue eyes. I loved that she cared enough to have this conversation, yet part of her was as self-destructive as I was.

I turned her to me, fixed her with a hard stare. "You will never lose me. I promise."

We kissed until the rest of the world was shut out. The breeze. The salt in the air. The dizzying drop to crashing waves. All of it dissolved, leaving just me and Danielle and the feel of our tongues and mouths colliding. Everything but our bond was minutiae in that moment.

When we came out of it, the elderly couple was passing in front of us. Now it was their turn to share smiles and stares in our direction. The woman leaned over and said, "You know, if you're looking for more privacy, take that little deer path about 100 meters down. It'll lead you to a very private waterfall."

Behind her, her husband nodded and grinned. The woman winked.

"Um... thanks."

"Enjoy it." And then the couple moved on.

We ended up following their instructions and sure enough, we found a waterfall that emptied itself into a shallow lagoon. It wasn't large, but it was secluded.

Dani pulled her tank top over her head and looked over her shoulder. "I've always wanted to make love under a waterfall."

Danielle left her clothes in a small pile by the bank of the lagoon and dove in. I watched her for a moment by the bank; she glided through the green-hued waters like a nymph, then I followed.

I thought my heart would stop as soon as my skin touched the icy water. The shock of it knocked the air of my lungs. I came up gasping. Danielle glided up to me, pushing her hair off her forehead and kissing my nose.

"You could have warmed me it was fucking freezing."

"See, I find it refreshing."

A shiver ran through me. "Uh, huh."

"Poor, baby. Come on, let me warm you up."

Instead of kissing me, or draping her body all over me, she dipped beneath the water and swallowed my cock. The shock of that was almost as great as hitting the water.

But it did the trick. I forgot all about the freezing mountain water as I hardened inside Danielle's warm embrace. She came up for air a couple times, fixing me with a look that said, *soon, soon...* before going back under.

By the third dive, I was as hard as I was going to get in water this temperature, and pulled her into a kiss. We folded into each other, sharing heat as our passion made more. Even with the lagoon up around our waists, I could feel her slippery excitement against my thigh.

Making love outdoors, beneath a waterfall. This had been Danielle's fantasy since before I could remember—long before any of the wife watching stuff entered our lives. After what she'd done for me this past year, I was going to make sure she wasn't cheated.

I maneuvered us beneath the falls, this time anticipating the chilly splash. Regardless, the jolt nearly knocked me off my feet. Even Danielle gasped. Before I let it get to me, I pushed her back against the rocky face behind the falls, sank to my knees, and lifted a leg over a shoulder.

The water wasn't as deep back here, coming up to her thighs, so I didn't have to worry about holding my breath as I worked her.

I've always loved going down on Danielle. I loved the taste, tangy and unique. I loved how soft her skin was and how good her pussy looked. She'd always kept it bare, confessing that she wasn't a fan of hair anywhere but on her head.

Most of all, though, I loved her deep, throaty moans. She could keep quiet as we made love, or even when it was just my fingers between her legs, but when I pressed the flat of my tongue against her clit, she couldn't stop her cry from shattering the air.

Add to that the sound of the waterfall and the smell of earth and forest, and my cock managed to stay hard throughout. I'd never considered risky sex a core fantasy, but eating her in a spot where anyone could wander into was fueling my erection.

I shoved two fingers into her. Her skin had cooled with the water, but everything was warm and slippery inside. I felt her inner muscles dance around my digits. She shoved her cunt against my mouth as the waterfall hammered me from the other direction. Somewhere above the roar, I thought I heard Dani climax.

The heat against the cold had me dizzy when I finally regained my feet. I pulled her against me and kissed her beneath the falls as water ran across our faces. Still riding the high of her orgasm, she was like warm clay in my hands. I turned her, bent her forward until she braced against the rocks. My cock skittered across her sex on its first pass. On its second, it burrowed deep.

I never imagined how powerful it would feel to fuck under a waterfall. Even a small one like this thundered around us in a way that a shower could never recreate. This wasn't just a spray. It wasn't like rain. It came and came, driving us ever downward. I fucked Danielle against its relentlessness, defying it even as it became part of us. Dani's hips met mine with equal fervor, her unrestrained cries echoing between the rocky wall and spilling falls.

I harnessed the energy crashing down around us in those last moments. I squeezed her hips, dancing a thumb along the crack of her ass. Danielle's cries shot up an octave. She hung her head between her shoulders and came.

With one last thrust, I joined her with a roar, pouring the last of me deep inside her.

When we found came back to our senses, huffing the fresh, tropical air, the waterfall was still there, still driving us down and down. But I was no longer cold.

"You're right," I said. I pulled Dani into my arms and kissed her forehead, matted with her blonde bangs. "It's definitely refreshing."

We made it back to the hotel by mid-afternoon, just in time to catch the last of the high sun by the pool. I was sleepy from the hike and our waterfall adventure, but had to prepare for the meetings I'd come to Hawaii for. A cup of coffee in hand and my notes spread across the glass-topped poolside table? I could get used to this kind of work.

Danielle sunning beside me was an added bonus—and a huge distraction. On her stomach with the back of her bikini top untied, I couldn't stop looking over. She looked so tempting: bronzed skin glistened with sweat and lotion; bikini bottoms stretched around her ass, which rose round and perfect off the lounge. Work was the furthest thing from my mind.

Still, I had a job to do, and if there was one thing I prided myself on, it was my work ethic. I sifted through my research, refamiliarizing myself with what I already knew for the hundredth time.

I was here to pitch our cloud-based video streaming service to a company that didn't even know it needed us. Aloha Spirit Media was a cable-access channel all about surfing that had taken the islands by storm. Thanks to ease of access to HD cameras and the creative genius of its owner, the shows and news were all professionally produced. They were just a few steps from making it to the big time, and I was here to help them those last few.

The owner, a guy named Alexander Kalani, already recognized the potential. He'd moved to uploading select videos to YouTube to producing short webisodes for the streaming site, but to turn his company into an Internet channel, he needed more than YouTube.

That's where Nimbus Solutions came in. We serve a niche market of small companies who want to stream live, high definition content across the web. It was only a matter of time before Mr. Kalani went looking for a way to do this. What I did was identify these kinds of opportunities and catch them before they went with one of our competitors.

"I'm going to go take a dip in the pool." Danielle rose, breaking me out of my study. "Want anything?"

"I'm good."

I watched her out of the corner of my eye as she fastened her bikini top, catching a glimpse of side boob. I got a whole lot more cleavage as she bent forward to slip into her flip-flops. She caught me looking and smiled.

With her sun-kissed blonde hair and tight little body, she had a classic all-American hotness to her. The black and white striped bikini was neither conservative nor racy, but she'd look good in anything, and she commanded the attention of every guy that she passed.

Her phone rattled alive on the glass-topped table. I watched her wade into the pool and dip beneath the water before looking.

—how about dinner tonight? come on, you know you want to

In place of the beat that my heart decided to skip, our illicit evening the night prior came flooding back. Work, our hike, our liaison under the waterfall; it all faded to sepia next to the vibrant memory of Dani's time with Sandy.

Even after I remembered to breathe, the task was labored. This guy was really taken with her, and who could blame him?

What if I texted back for her? The idea sliced through me, gutting me even as I considered it.

“No.”

The hypothetical played itself out. A reply was all Sandy needed to keep pestering her. He wouldn't leave her alone for the rest of the week and eventually, Dani would figure out why. Then, she'd be *pissed*. I still remembered how angry she'd been the first time this game got out of hand nearly a year ago, and I'd left her at a bar with a stranger. Pretending to be her and texting a reply to Sandy would have been magnitudes worse.

“No.”

That was the problem, in a nutshell—a microcosm of my struggle. I kept wanting to push the envelope, even when I knew how stupid it was.

Danielle was at the pool bar, her hair wet and slicked back from her quick dip. A guy talked to her as the bartender mixed up a strawberry daiquiri. His build was closer to mine than Sandy's—lean and tall—but he must have been at least ten years Dani's junior. He had no chance, but even still, she chatted with him like no one else existed.

It's what had attracted me to her when we'd first met. I quickly realized that she was more than a pretty, blue-eyed blonde—not that there was anything wrong with that. Danielle possessed an empathy that could be startling.

Back then, this quality had also driven me crazy with jealousy. I'd confronted her about it once, asking why she flirted with every guy who said hello. She didn't see it as flirting. *It's not my fault that I actually listen when someone's talking*. It made her such a natural fit for HR. It was also most likely one of the reasons that my wife watching fantasy had taken seed. After seeing that so often, either it boils over and destroys you, or it becomes part of you.

Her daiquiri arrived, but she remained out there, flirting with the young guy. This was the new part of her friendliness—something she'd confessed she'd started to enjoy, despite initially doing it for me.

I chuckled at how obvious she was. She kept her attention divided between the beach beyond the bar and the guy, giving him ample time to check her out. When she looked over at me, I just shook my head and laughed.

It ended with her pointing in my direction and the guy looking infinitely disappointed. Pride surged through me as she rose from the pool, water cascading down her curves as the guy's eyes followed her longingly. That woman was my wife. Why was I so keen to risk losing that? Thoughts of texting back for her were gone.

Dani didn't tell me about the dinner offer from Sandy until later that evening, as we were getting ready for a dinner date of our own. She came out of the bathroom wearing nothing but her makeup and a g-string.

"He wants to know if I'm free for dinner tonight. What do you think?"

There was no mention of how long she'd been sitting on that text. Only a sly smile and hard nipples. My cock swelled.

"Well, I'd suggest you put on a little more, but I'm sure he'd be fine if you didn't."

"And would you?"

She let the question hang as she slipped into her sundress. Last night, she'd looked like a Hawaiian princess in her short, floral outfit. Tonight, she looked like the Danielle I knew—the Danielle from this morning's hike. She was a jeans and blouse kind of girl. She wore yoga pants when relaxing and dresses like tonight's that ended closer to the knee than mid-thigh.

And as I sat there, across from her in the candlelight of the restaurant, I wouldn't have wanted any other version of my wife.

Danielle reviewed the dessert menu, set it down, and looked at me. "You know what would be the perfect ending to this awesome day? A slice of Key Lime Pie."

"Sounds good to me. Go for it!"

"Coffee, too," she added.

"Now you're getting crazy."

"Is that what passes for crazy? I think you know how crazy I can get..."

My cock stiffened. I shifted on my seat.

"Actually, I don't. You never got specific about last night."

"I think you have a pretty good idea." We both watched her fingers travel up the stem of her glass.

"Do I?"

I really didn't. I wasn't sure what she'd made up last night for my own benefit, and what really happened, other than that they'd kissed. I didn't say a word—just stared until she rolled her eyes and went on.

“It’s probably much sexier in your head than it really was.”

“You mean it wasn’t sexy?”

“No. I didn’t say that.” She had the demeanor of a cat being backed into a corner. “I mean, I was worked up after all the drinks and the dancing. When he suggested we take a break, I had no idea that he meant in one of those booths. And once we were in there...”

Our server chose that moment to arrive and ask about desserts. I wanted to strangle the guy. Instead, I ordered us the pie and a couple coffees.

“Cream and sugar?” he asked.

“Fine, sure. Bring whatever.”

Dani laughed as he retreated. I tried to refocus.

“Where were we?”

Danielle batted her lashes.

“Gee, I don’t recall.”

“I think you were talking about last night. Something about a private booth and another man?”

“Oh. Right.”

“So did you two really not talk at all?” I asked.

“We didn’t talk much.”

“Did he make you come?”

“Yes.”

“How?” I needed to know.

“With his fingers.”

I didn’t speak because I didn’t know what to say. Christ, she’d really done that. She’d really gone that far.

She continued when I stayed silent. “I was so worked up. Like, on the edge. When he touched me—” She glanced up at me, a nervous smile on her lips. “When he touched my pussy, I didn’t last very long.”

“Over your panties?”

Her irises flicked away for an instant. “Yes.”

“That’s so hot.” I reached for my water, letting the cool liquid coat my parched throat.

“It was insane. I mean, it’s not like we were alone. I could hear everything around me. The music. People talking. Hell, there was a group in the booth right next to us planning some road trip up the California coast. I’ll never think of Bodega Bay quite the same way now.”

I laughed. "I think I know where we need to go next."

"Well, today you proved that we can have fun anywhere." Her eyes flared. "So you're really okay with yesterday?"

"You know I am. It drives me nuts, but in a good way. I like seeing you be my naughty little wife."

I held my tongue before I said everything I was thinking. Part of me wanted her to go farther last night, but I wasn't sure I could confess that quite yet.

"How about you?" I said instead.

"I love *being* your naughty little wife." She paused. "It scares me how much I loved it."

"Are you tempted to text him back?"

Her hesitation was all the answer I needed. That, plus the wine, fueled my next suggestion.

"Go for it, if you want. We're here for another five days."

Pink blossomed across Danielle's high cheeks. "I don't think so, Dean. Not after last night. That...that wouldn't be a good idea."

"I'm not saying it's a good idea. All I'm saying is that if you want it, you should go for it."

Our Key Lime Pie arrived with our coffee cups. Neither of us said a word as the server filled the mugs with dark java.

"Can I get you anything else?"

"I'm good for now." I never took my eyes off Danielle. Yes, her cheeks were definitely pink.

"So are you ready for tomorrow's meetings?"

"As ready as I can be." I let her change the subject, but the unspoken suggestion hung out there. "The hardest part is done—getting the meeting in the first place. Selling it is easy."

We left the conversation of texts and naughty wives and other men behind us for the night, and enjoyed our dessert. Danielle was right, the pie was the perfect way to end the day.

It also tipped me over the edge. Between the rich meal, the wine, and dessert, I was done for the night. We fooled around a little back in the hotel room, but passed out before things could get started.

Chapter 3

Aloha Spirit

My dreams were as crazy as they were incoherent. I woke up with a painful hard-on that wouldn't go away, even after a piss and a quick shower.

Danielle finally stirred as I rooted through my suitcase for my clothes. She'd stripped naked but for her g-string and had a bed sheet twisted around her body, just barely covering her breasts.

"I feel like shit," she groaned. "One of these nights, I need to go to bed sober."

"We're not as young as we used to be, are we?" I pulled on my suit trousers. "Keep sleeping. No reason for both of us to be hung over."

She rolled onto her back and cradled her head into the pillow. Her panties didn't cover any of her ass, but seeing that string disappear between her plush cheeks added a new dimension to her sex appeal. I was hard all over again.

"Good luck today, Dean."

"I'll call you when I'm free."

The offices of Aloha Spirit Media were in a commercial park that could have been anywhere in the country were it not for the palm trees and the dramatic hills that rose up around it.

I parked my rental in the lot, which was nearly empty but for a few cars, and stepped out into the warm Hawaiian morning. I'd traveled a lot of places, but this was the closest to paradise I'd come.

Aloha Spirit's offices looked new and suggested recent success. That was a good sign. The major deals I'd landed in the past all had a similar feel: renovations meant success, which meant a desire for more success.

The receptionist, a pretty Hawaiian woman with a pink orchid tucked in her long black hair greeted me with a dimpled smile.

"You must be Mr. Williams." She looked down at her console. "And you're early."

"I'm still on Pacific Time." That wasn't exactly true.

“I hear you. Early to bed, early to rise.”

I thought about the last couple nights and grinned. “That’s what they say.”

“Well, Mr. Kalani isn’t here yet, but I can get you some coffee if you’d like.”

“That would be great.”

She disappeared into the kitchen, presumably, and I had a chance to look around. The lobby was enormous: glass-walled and double-storied, it gave the sense of being open to the nature around. Behind the receptionist’s desk were two floors of offices and cubicles, all as open as the lobby. And all as empty.

“Is anyone here?” I asked when the receptionist returned.

“It’s Monday morning,” she said without further explanation.

The coffee perked me up. “So I’m just meeting Mr. Kalani? Or his team—”

“Just me.” Behind me, the man’s voice carried the hint of a Hawaiian accent, echoing through the spacious lobby. “If that works for you.”

I turned, ready to explain that I normally met with the financial and operational officers as well as the owner, when I got a look at Mr. Kalani.

“Yes, that works for me.”

He stuck out his hand and I barely kept my composure as I shook it. I want to melt into the floor and disappear.

“Nice to meet you. I’m Alexander Kalani, but please, call me Sandy.”

“Dean...Williams.” Get a hold of yourself.

“I’m sorry if I got you up early.”

Sandy waved it off. “Don’t worry about it. I’ve been up since dawn. Tide comes in early.”

Up close, I got a better sense of the man. He wore a crisp button down over her broad upper body, open enough to show a lack of an undershirt along and a rich tan. His blonde hair was swept back into a more executive look than the way he’d worn it Saturday night, but that strong jaw and wide shoulders left no doubt. This was the guy Dani had disappeared into the booth with. The guy who’d touched her in ways no other man had since me.

I couldn’t unify those thoughts. It was too surreal.

“Everything okay? You need another cup of coffee?”

“No, I’m good.” Snap out of it. “Sorry, just didn’t get much sleep last night.”

“I know what that’s like.” Sandy grinned and put a hand on my back. “Come on, let’s get started.”

I don’t remember much about that morning meeting, other than that I rattled through my usual spiel and got the sense that Sandy wasn’t buying it. I could usually pick up on these things and adjust, but the coincidence had me off my game.

At one point, he seemed more focused on his phone than my PowerPoint. I soldiered on, pretending I had his attention but feeling myself sinking deeper and deeper.

By lunchtime, I felt like this pitch was a lost cause, no matter how perfect the fit. I just couldn’t get beyond who this guy was.

Sandy stood as I closed my laptop and gathered my things. He held his hand out for a shake—the it-was-nice-knowing-you salutation. I took it, already thinking about the free time ahead of me. I never imagined that the thought of laying on the beach with Danielle could be depressing, but there it was.

Sandy didn’t release my hand right away. Instead, he squinted at me, took a deep breath, and gave me a second chance.

“I’d like to bring my partners in. Let them hear this. I think there may be something here that we could use.”

I blinked. Really? “That would be great.”

“How about after lunch? They should be in by then...I hope.”

I couldn’t tell if it was a joke or not, but laughed anyway. I’d already begun to reorganize my presentation.

“After lunch is perfect.”

“Great.” He checked his watch. “How ‘bout we meet back here at 2? I’d offer to take you to lunch, but I’ve already got plans.” He grinned. “And as much as I think I like you, you’re not quite as pretty.”

A pit opened up, deep in my gut, and chaos poured out. I managed to contain it—or so I hoped—even as Sandy escorted me out to the parking lot. We shook hands again, he climbed into his surfboard laden Hummer, and I scrambled for my phone.

Sure enough, I had a message there. From Danielle.

—guess who i’m having lunch with?

All kinds of crazy shit went into that moment. My emotions ran the gamut. Fear. Betrayal. Jealousy so crippling I couldn’t feed my keys into

the ignition of my car. But above and beyond that was a tsunami of erotic excitement. It carried me to the edge of the world and dumped me off the unexplored edge. I hadn't felt this mind-fucked since we first started playing this game and Danielle pretended that she'd fucked the guy.

I finally found the dexterity to ram the keys home and gunned the engine...with no where to go.

A picture text came in from Danielle before I figured out what to do next. She was posing in front of the mirror in our room wearing a blue sundress and tall, matching heels. She took the photo with her left hand—a ring-free left hand.

It made sense. She hadn't worn a ring on Saturday when she'd met Sandy, so she shouldn't show up with one now. Still...

—when i get home, i'm going to tear that dress off of you

—not if my date tears it off first

Date. The word shattered me into a million different emotions all over again—every one of them as exciting as the next.

It was only noon. Was there enough time to get into trouble before Sandy got back for our meeting? Would she even get into trouble, with me not there?

—have fun. tell me about it tonight

Finally, I pulled out of the driveway and headed to a seafood shack I'd seen on the way here.

I watched a sailboat on the horizon. It didn't seem to move, no matter how long I watched it, until the moment I realized it had traveled from one edge of the sky to the other. That's how my lunch hour crawled by—that's how my last *year* had crawled by. Dani and I had gone from watching her flirt with other men in front of me, to going out alone with a man she'd admitted she wanted to fuck.

As I pushed my *papua* around with a fork, my mind jumped between the thought of how we'd gotten here to ones involving Danielle and Sandy getting naked in the back of his Hummer.

It was on me. I couldn't be mad and I didn't have a right to be jealous. I'd told her to text him. I'd dangled the suggestion out there. And I'd fucked her again and again while we both imagined her with someone else. But part of me *was* mad. *Was* jealous. And that was fucked up.

I tried hating Sandy for doing what he did, but that didn't feel right, either. When he saw something he liked, he went for it. Fortunately for him, he possessed the skills to get it. Or so I suspected after watching him work and reading his history.

The chaotic, spewing pit in my stomach hadn't closed by the end of lunch, but I knew how to move forward—with Aloha Spirit, anyway. The rest of it would have to wait until after I'd won or lost this client.

Sandy was already back at the offices when I returned, shortly before two o'clock. That surprised me. I'd expected him to walk in fifteen minutes late, tucking his shirt into his trousers, smelling of sex and sweat. That he arrived as impeccable as he'd been this morning was a little disappointing.

With him were the executives I'd expected this morning. The COO was a young woman with sun-bleached blonde hair and a surfer vibe, named Penelope. The other man, Mick, was younger still. He was the production chief, although I wondered how he stayed so pale based on the outdoor nature of their videos.

I shut my laptop before PowerPoint had even booted up and looked them over: the surfer, the vampire, and the entrepreneur (who'd possibly just fucked my wife). Sandy had given me the rare opportunity of a do-over, but he hadn't done it just to hear the same canned speech again.

"So I could show you a presentation on what Nimbus Solutions can do for you. It's pretty great, filled with facts and figures on ROI, how we measure up to the competition, and why you need to move beyond the cable network model. Sandy saw it this morning."

He gave me a nod from the back. His smile encouraged me.

"But you already know most of that stuff. You just don't realize it yet. You guys are working here because you love to surf, right?"

Pale Mick seemed unlikely, but something told me otherwise, so I took a chance and was rewarded when he nodded.

"Right, so you love to surf. You love it so much that you wanted to share that affection with others." I looked at Sandy. "So far, so good?"

He nodded.

"You're also a group that sees something they want and goes after it." I thought of Sandy's fixation of Danielle, paused to let my heart jump around

for a moment, and moved forward. “That’s great, too, because I’m the guy who’s going to make it easier for you.”

From that moment on, I had them—no, correction: I had them when I first identified them in our office, months ago. But it was that pitch that made them realize it.

By the end, we were buddies. So much so that as Sandy shook my hand, he offered to take me out for a drink.

“To celebrate my new partner. I owe you that much, after slipping out on lunch.”

Now this situation was awkward—potentially *extremely* awkward. And because of that, I couldn’t refuse. I mean, I’d already fought the temptation to dig for details about his lunch date, and now he was offering to buy me a beer?

I left my car parked as he drove me out to Lahaina, on the west side of Maui. I’d read about it, but Dani and I hadn’t made the forty minute trip yet. He asked where I was staying and when I told him, he shook his head.

“You need to get out of Kahului, man. This is where it’s at.” Sandy raced along the ocean road quick enough that I was tempted to grip the handhold of the door.

Lahaina was more beach town than city. Built along the ocean, facing west, the commercial stuff that had crept into Kahului hadn’t made it this far yet. We ended up at a seaside bar, sitting outside and drinking beers out of tall pilsner glasses. Most of the sailboats had come in, docked in their slips as sailors sprayed them down.

“I can’t believe you live here, man.”

Sandy slipped his sunglasses on and looked out at the horizon. The sun had just started thinking about setting, but still rode high in the sky. He nodded after a moment. “Me either, friend. It’s why I love visitors. Nothing like experiencing every day stuff through their eyes.”

“I know the feeling. I’m from San Francisco, but I only see the touristy stuff when I have friends come to stay. Different perspectives. It helps keep an open mind.”

“I’ll drink to that.” Our glasses clinked. “You love what you do, don’t you? Sales?”

“Not sure if *love* is the word. I believe in the product. I started as a software engineer. Helped develop it. I think it’s better than anything

Google or Microsoft or any other big company is offering. I think it can revolutionize media.”

“Like Aloha Spirit?”

“Definitely. You want to push your content as far as you can? We can help you.”

“I like you, Dean. When we get this contract in order, I want to take you out.”

That sounded promising. “Hopefully we can smooth out the details tomorrow.”

“Oh, I’m sure. Penelope is awesome. She’s probably already finished reviewing the paperwork and is working up her own report for me to read when I get back.” He laughed. “So you’re married, I see?”

I looked at my ring. “Coming up on ten years.”

“Man, I don’t know how you do it. Any secrets?”

“Honestly? Communication. All that stuff you hear on daytime talk shows.” I gulped at my beer as my heart rate began to rise. I knew where I was steering this conversation, but I needed some liquid courage. “Open-mindedness, too.”

“Oh? How so?”

“Well, I travel a lot, you know? Like now. I’m gone for a week. Next month, I travel to London, actually, for a couple weeks. It means we’re apart a lot. So—”

“You have an arrangement.” Sandy grinned. “Interesting. I wouldn’t have guessed. You seem so clean cut. Maybe you’re more ‘salesman’ than you think.”

I didn’t clarify that it wasn’t me with the arrangement, but my wife. Seemed easier this way. “So how about you? Sounds like you’re not ready to settle down.”

“Not even close. Maybe if I meet the right girl, but I’m having too much fun to think about it.”

“So your lunch date wasn’t the right girl?” I managed to ask the question without my voice cracking.

“Oh, she could be. Blonde hair. Slender, but with an ass, you know? Long legs. She’s awesome.” Talk about being beaten up on the inside. “But she’s a visitor. To Maui and in my life. That’s the downside about visitors, and in Hawaii...well, everyone’s a visitor.”

The sun had finally decided to start its decent, casting the sky in yellow and orange. He blinked, shook his head, and grinned.

“Not that visitors are bad. Especially women like her, here on vacation. Far from home, people on vacation do stuff they’d never dream of in their every day lives.”

“Like what?”

I hope he hadn’t noticed my gulp.

“Well, I met her last weekend, right? I knew immediately that she was looking for fun. Alone at a bar. Choosy. That’s important. A challenge is a good thing, and I watched her turn away guy after guy before moving in.”

“You’re pretty confident, aren’t you?”

“I am, but that’s not what I mean. She could have told me to fuck off and that would have been cool with me. But if I didn’t risk a little disappointment, I’d never have a chance. You said it yourself in that meeting: when I see something I want, I go for it. If I fail, I fail.”

“But you didn’t fail when you hit on her?”

Sandy grinned. “I don’t fail very often.”

My beer was almost gone and our server noticed, asking for another round. Sandy ordered us one before I could.

“So what did she do that you don’t think she’d dream of doing in her every day life?”

I had to regulate my breathing and focus or I’d probably fall out of my chair, shaking.

“It’s more an attitude thing. At home, she’s got responsibilities. A good job. I suspect maybe even a husband.” He held up his hand. “I didn’t ask, she didn’t offer, and I’m not going to judge. Who knows, they may have an arrangement like you and yours.”

Oh, you have no idea.

“But on the dance floor, she moved like she had none of that. Like a burden had been lifted, however temporarily. You don’t surf, do you?”

I shook my head.

“Well, there’s this moment when you catch a really great wave. You’re in the pipe. You’ve got water to your left and open beach to your right, and only one way to go—straight forward. It’s beautiful, man. That’s the zone this chick was in. She was riding out that beautiful wave.”

I got what he was saying—it sounded fantastic—and I was happy to hear Dani had had so much fun. But the intellectual nature of her “freedom”

disappointed me. I'd been hoping for something juicier.

"Bet that's not all she was riding," I said. I think I was buzzing more from the wrongness of this conversation than the beer, but I got what I was looking for.

"Now that would have been sweet, but no. No sex in the champagne room." Sandy laughed. "She'd probably never let me finger her back home, though."

I was in the middle of sipping my beer and it all came shooting up, sizzling out my nose. The fizz watered my eyes and left me racked with coughs.

"Sorry, man. I run with some foul-mouthed friends. Sometimes I forget myself."

Jesus Christ, my scalp burned. He'd actually fingered her at the club? That was a detail she'd conveniently left out. I curled my fingers around my glass, wanting to crush it in my hand. Dani and I had a few things to clarify.

At least now I knew why a guy like Sandy seemed so impatient to get back together. And about that...

"So you closed the deal over lunch?"

"Sadly, no. That was definitely the idea, though."

I was equally relieved and disappointed.

"Lunch went longer than I'd expected. Usually chicks like that don't have a whole lot going on in the personality department, but Danielle was different."

Twang went my heart. There it was: her name.

"Anyway, I'd used up most of my time before I could get her into the back of the H3."

"Bummer. For that, you could have been a little late to the meeting." The joking felt safe.

"Oh, we had time to fuck. That wasn't it. I mean, we were as keyed up as you can get. But when I went for my box of condoms I keep in the SUV, it was fucking empty. Can you believe that?"

That pit that had formed in my stomach over lunch? All these revelations tore it open wider and wider. If I stopped to think about it, it would have swallowed me whole, so I didn't.

"Bad timing." My words spilled forth on auto-pilot.

"I'll say. But, I mean, it's not like it wasn't fun."

This time, he didn't elaborate. The sun edged closer to the horizon. I sank with it.

"So is she gone now? Or are you getting together again?"

"She's here a few more days, she says. I asked her to dinner, but she put me off. I think she was a little freaked after what happened at lunch."

And what had happened? Gah!

"She'll come around. Or she won't," Sandy went on. "Like I said, she's a visitor here. This is her vacation. It all depends on how far she wants to take it."

He finished his beer and signaled for the check.

"But if she says yes, I'm not going to make the condom mistake again."

The ride back was just as dizzying as it had been earlier, but for a different set of reasons. I didn't even see the twists and turns along the coastal road. The sunset broke across the sky like colored glass, but I didn't admire that, either.

I saw Danielle and Sandy in the back of this very vehicle. That fact alone killed me. She'd been in this SUV only a few hours ago, with the guy sitting right beside me, doing God knew what.

The twenty minute ride tormented me. I couldn't get out of there fast enough. I gave Sandy a handshake, hopefully said something about looking forward to seeing him tomorrow, and then got the fuck out of there.

I texted Danielle to tell her I was done for the day. She texted back that she'd be waiting for me at the bar. Flame filled my veins. By the time I parked, my blood was boiling over.

A guy was hitting on her, of course. She wore the blue dress from her photo earlier and was perched on a stool, legs crossed. She had a mostly full margarita in front of her.

I marched over to their spot and leaned against the bar opposite her—the guy she was with between us. Danielle looked past him with a weak smile that said, "Help."

I grinned and looked at the bartender.

"Whiskey and coke. Rail's fine."

She went back to her conversation.

"No, I really don't think we've met. I told you, I'm just visiting."

“No, no. I swear we have. I could never forget someone as pretty as you, believe me. Where are you from?”

“Tusane.” A lie.

“That must be it. I travel to Tusane all the time. On business. I love New Mexico.”

I snickered. Danielle glanced again at me, but I wasn’t bailing her out.

“Tusane is in Arizona.”

“Right, right. That’s what I meant. You know, I travel so much.”

“I think it may be time to travel somewhere else, then.”

“Huh?”

“Like, away from me.”

The guy must have heard me laughing as he sulked away, muttering, “Bitch,” but he didn’t look back.

Danielle had gotten more sun today. I could see it in the face, where freckles had begun to form across her small, up-turned nose. The short dress was even sexier in person. Its wide halter tied behind her neck and scooped low enough to tempt any man into her cleavage.

“Do I know you?” I asked after a moment.

Danielle rolled her eyes. “Really? You guys have anything original?”

“You just reminded me of someone I used to know.”

“Is that right?”

“Yeah. Same blonde hair. Same blue eyes. Attractive in that same cute-slash-hot kind of way. But she was an innocent girl and I don’t think you are.”

“No, definitely not.” She ran her finger through the icy liquid of her margarita. “But how do you know my look-a-like was so innocent? We all have our naughty sides. We just don’t always broadcast them.”

I moved into the seat between us.

“You seem to be broadcasting…”

Her blue-eyed stare knocked the wind out of me.

“I had a broadcast worthy day,” she said.

When I found my voice again, it fumbled on its scratchy way out. “Want to tell me about it?”

“If you want me to. But not here.”

I reached for my wallet and slapped a stack of bills down without bothering to count. My hands were shaking. “Let’s go.”

The Marriott was only two stories, as were most of the buildings in Kahului. We took the main staircase in the lobby to our landing and practically raced along the hall to our room, Danielle tripping in her tall heels.

Inside the room, I couldn't keep up the fantasy rhetoric. I wanted my wife—not the stranger/slut in a bar. I slipped my hands up the backs of her thighs, pulling the loose dress up her ass. I found the lacy edge of her panties—not a thong, but a pair of clingy boy-shorts that she looked equally good in.

“So tell me, babe. Did he feel these like I am?” I cupped her ass through the thin lace.

“Yes.”

I pushed my hand lower, sliding it between her buttocks until I felt the heat of her pussy. “Here?”

“Mmm hmm.”

I pressed my fingers against her and drew a gasp. “You *were* naughty,” I said.

She pulled back and fixed me with guilty eyes.

“Dean, you have no idea.”

Oh, but I do. “Tell me.”

“I... we...” She looked away, found resolve, and squared up again. “I went down on him.”

Shock. That came first, like a high-pitched whine that dulled every other sense. Close behind were my other friends from the day: jealousy, doubt, anger...excitement so visceral it had my cock tearing a whole in my trousers.

She. Went. Down. On him.

“I...” I didn't know what to say. I didn't trust myself to be delicate in this delicate situation, but as she looked at me with fear in her eyes, I realized she was getting the wrong impression anyway.

So I unleashed the pack of coiling emotions in the only way I could think to do: with a hard kiss that left us panting when we finally tore apart.

“Are you mad?” she asked.

How could I answer that question? Yes? No? Fuck yeah?!

I pushed her back onto the bed and started unbuttoning my shirt. She stared across the rise and fall of her chest and spread her legs. I yanked my shirt open.

“Tell me how it started.”

Danielle hesitated only a moment. “Well, I was so nervous, meeting him for lunch after Saturday, but I knew how turned on it would make you.”

“So you just did this for me?” I began to work on my belt.

“Well, not totally. But I don’t think I would have gone if it wasn’t for you. I mean, Sandy was very good looking. And after having lunch with him, he’s a charming guy, but I have lunch with charming guys all the time.”

The implication sent a ripple up my spine. I pulled the belt free and unzipped my trousers.

“After lunch, he told me he wanted to show me his favorite view of the north side. He drives this gas-guzzling black Hummer, and when I climbed into it, I was pretty sure what was going to happen.”

I pushed my boxers down along with my pants. My cock bobbed out, hard in my hand. “But you got in, anyway?”

“I was even more nervous then, but I wanted to. We’d already fooled around a little bit at the restaurant—a little kissing, that sort of thing.”

My gut tightened even more.

“And since you were in your big meeting, you wouldn’t be available all day—” She seemed to remember why we were here in the first place. “How did it go?”

I shook my head and stepped between her legs.

“Not right now. I’ll tell you all about it later, but right now, you’re finishing this story.”

I rolled her panties down. Her pussy was swollen and wet, bald from the waxing she’d had in preparation of this trip. Sandy’s fingers had been here, not once, but twice, thumb rubbing across its naked bud. Doubt flooded through me, but was quickly replaced by lust.

I crawled higher, running my cock across her damp folds. Dani shuddered before reaching down and positioning me against her opening.

I slipped in easily. “You’re so wet.”

“And you’re so hard.”

“So what happened next?”

“We got to this overlook. And it was beautiful. But so is everything here. I told him, and...”

She trailed off, but I filled in the details. He would have agreed with her, all the while keeping his eyes on her. Dani ate that stuff up.

“We made out for a long time, and it was great, but we both knew we’d gone up there for another reason.”

My cock grew another inch inside of her. I started fucking her faster.

“I’m not sure how it happened, but he had my panties off and his hand was... was... oh, Dean, you’re so hard!”

“You’re driving me crazy. What did he do with his hand?”

“He put it between my legs. His fingers felt so good there.”

“Did he make you come?”

“Yes. Yesss...”

I was losing her. I could feel her psyche breaking apart. “Is that when you sucked his cock?”

“Uh huh...”

“But you really wanted to fuck him, didn’t you?” Our hips slapped. “You’re thinking about it now, aren’t you?”

“Yes, baby. Fuck me. Fuck me!”

“Tell me. You wanted to fuck him. Tell me.” My jaw ached as my teeth clenched.

“I wanted to fuck him. I would have, but...mmm...but I couldn’t...”

Because you didn’t have a condom. For a moment, I wondered if I’d said it aloud. If I had, it was lost somewhere in Danielle’s climax. Then I lost it too, ramming home one last time before joining her.

We came down together, snuggling and sweaty and sated—for now, anyway. That fiery anger that had been so crippling earlier was turned down to a low simmer. What replaced it was uncertainty and fear. We’d crossed a line; could things ever be the same?

We snuggled up under the sheets, removing the last scraps of our clothes.

“Talk to me, Dean. I hate it when you’re quiet.”

“What do you want me to say?”

“Tell me what you’re thinking. Tell me you hate me, if you want. Just...tell me.”

“Is that what you want? For me to hate you?”

She tensed. “I shouldn’t have gone to lunch. That was stupid of me.”

I hugged her close and kissed the top of her head. “I love you, baby. I think it was hot—what you did.”

“But...” She was just as afraid as I was. That was comforting.

“I basically said it was okay last night. And if you’d have texted to ask, I would have told you to go for it.”

“I should have done that. I just got... I just got carried away.”

“I like that you did. It’s hot.” It was making my cock grow again. “It would have taken something away if you’d asked for my permission.”

“You like me being naughty, don’t you?” Her body melted against mine as she relaxed.

“I can’t get enough of it.”

“I have a confession for you, then. This afternoon wasn’t the first time he...used his fingers on me.”

My heart began to race. It was the only warning my body gave before my own confession slipped out. “I know.”

She shifted on me, looking up. I met her eyes.

“How? You couldn’t have seen.”

“I didn’t. Sandy told me.”

Danielle sat bolt upright. “He *what?* You *planned* this?!”

“No, no. It’s not like that.”

Danielle crossed her arms beneath her breasts. “Start explaining then.”

“His name is Alexander Kalani. He runs a local surfing channel here in Hawaii and it turns out he’s the client I met with today. I swear to you, Dani, I had no idea on Saturday that he was the same guy I was meeting. Not until we met this morning and he introduced himself as Sandy.”

She didn’t look convinced, but seemed to soften.

“Doesn’t he run a surfing channel? How could you not know what he looked like before meeting him?”

She had a good point. “Well, I did watch some of the shows, but most of them were interviews and profiles of local surfers. Maybe he was the voice behind the camera, but I barely heard him talking last Saturday. And I can’t remember ever seeing him appear on camera.”

I could barely believe it, even as it came out of my mouth.

“Ever heard of Google?” Dani was definitely softening now.

“No, what’s that?” I said.

There was a smile.

“So you really didn’t know?”

“I swear to God. I was just as shocked as you. And I was going to tell you when you got home, but then you had lunch, and—”

Her brows went up again. “You talked to him before that.”

“Of course. I’d been talking to him all morning.”

“And let me guess: you got the contract.”

“I did, but...” It dawned on me what she was implying. “No, no, that’s not it either! Stop jumping to damn conclusions. He still has no idea that we’re together. He just thinks you’re a hot chick here on vacation. That’s all. I swear.”

“Well, this is awkward.”

To put it mildly.

I pulled her close. “I think of it as *unique*. He’s really taken with you, you know. When we went out to grab a drink, he couldn’t stop talking about you.”

“Oh, God...” she groaned. “He must think I’m a total slut.”

“Not really.” Well, that was a bit of a white lie, but she didn’t need to know that. “He even said something about how impressed he was that you actually had a personality.”

“Gee, that’s comforting.” She buried her face in my shoulder. “I think I’m going to stay in this room for the rest of the week.”

“Are you sure you don’t want to have dinner with him?”

I held my breath, waiting for her to answer. It didn’t come for so long that I would have thought she may have fallen asleep were it not for her racing heart beat against my breast.

At last, she shifted enough to look up at me. “You know what that would mean, right?”

Sex. They’d have sex. There would be no more escapes. No inconveniences to get in the way. She wanted it and Sandy knew it. He’d bring her back to his place, and at his place, he’d have everything ready.

I barely heard my reply through the blood pounding in my ears.

“Yes.”

“Are you sure?”

I think I said yes in response. I wasn’t sure. Her hand curled around me where I’d recovered to full strength and length. She mounted me, rolling her hips in silence as we let our thoughts settle.

“I will always love you, Dean. No matter what.”

“And I’ll love you, Dani. Forever. No matter what.”

No matter what, she mouthed, tasting the words. “I can’t believe we’re actually thinking about doing this.”

“It’s crazy, isn’t it?”

She nodded.

“Tell me you want to. This isn’t just for me,” I said.

“I want to. I’ve wanted to ever since Saturday, when he had me in that booth...” Her nostrils flared. “Ever since he pushed his fingers inside my panties and fingered me.”

She pumped her hips faster and faster, closing in on her orgasm.

“I want you to fuck him, my naughty wife. I want you to fuck him all night, and come back to me in the morning and tell me all about it.”

“Dean!” Her face twisted as her voice cracked through the air. “I’m close.”

“Tomorrow night, it won’t be my cock you’re riding. Tomorrow, it won’t be my name you’ll be crying out.”

“Uh, uh! Dean, come! Come with me!”

“Oh, Dani, yes...”

This time, we came together, perfectly synced. She arched back, grabbing my knees as I held her hips. Sweat glistened across her tawny body. I lost myself in her sculpted beauty and the perverse promise of tomorrow. I filled her shivering cunt and felt dizzy with desire.

“I love you,” she managed to say in the last moments of the night.

“No matter what.

Chapter 4

Date

I filled the next day—Tuesday—with my uncertainty, taking navel-gazing to new heights. Was this what I really wanted? Would I be able to look at Danielle the same way, knowing she'd slept with another man? Could we survive this?

The questions were with me when I woke up—hours before I needed to be. They echoed through my head as I met with Sandy, Penelope, and Mick to work out the details of the contract. And they haunted me as the day wound down and the point of no return approached.

I clung to the idea that I could still call it off. Certain things had already happened, sure, but the final line had not been crossed. At any point, I could call Danielle and tell her that I didn't want her to go—and I knew that she wouldn't. She'd be disappointed. Hell, I'd be disappointed, but she'd be equally relieved. We could return to our lives, suffer a little through the what-ifs, but ultimately, we'd be happy.

But that was safe, and we'd teased along the brink for too long to keep playing it safe. Over the past year, each time we'd played this game, we drew closer to it. Each time, we let things play out a little longer than the last, only to pull back at the last moment and laugh at how dangerous we felt.

I didn't want to pull back anymore. The very idea of Danielle fucking another man screwed with my head so much I couldn't think past the jealousy and hurt and excitement, but I also knew I wanted it. I wanted it, wanted it, *wanted* it.

"What do you want?" Mick's question jarred me out of yet another wandering thought.

I blinked and there I was, sitting at dinner with Penelope and Mick as we looked over our menus. "Where had the day gone??" was my first question. My second was: had my wife's date with Sandy already begun?

"I don't know. You choose."

"Let's get champagne to celebrate!"

Penelope's suggestion was delivered with the upbeat exuberance that I'd warmed to all afternoon. Usually, the number crunchers were boring

desk-jockeys who kept their ties cinched too tight around their necks. Penelope was actually fun.

“Works for me.”

“Me too,” Mick agreed. “I just didn’t want to suggest since you’re picking up the tab and all.”

“Hey, this is as much a celebration for me as it is for you guys,” I said. “I can’t tell you the last time I’ve been so excited by a client.”

This was totally true. After a day with the people at Aloha Spirit—even as distracted as I was—I knew that they were good people. They really believed in what they did, and I wanted to help them do it better.

Sandy inspired that. I’d worked with a lot of companies over the years, both big and small, and I could recognize a good leader when I saw one. Sandy had collected people who were not just good at their jobs, but shared his passion for surfing. He wanted to share it with the world and had the people to do it.

We’d wrapped the contract up by late afternoon. I’d offered to take the group out for a celebratory dinner, but Sandy had regretfully declined. “Remember that chick I talked about yesterday? I’ve got dinner plans with her already, you understand? But Penny and Mick are better company than me, anyway,”

I did *understand*, and it filled me like a fever. It had been the next thing that filled me with lead.

“I’ll text you guys later. We’ll grab a drink at Beach Club.” To me, he added, “When you meet her, you’ll understand what all the fuss is about.”

I planned on begging off. All through dinner, I prepped my getaway. As tempted as I was to meet up with Sandy and Danielle, I was just as terrified. I wasn’t sure how I’d react, and more to-the-point, I wasn’t sure if we could keep up the fiction.

Three months back—and the last time we’d played—Danielle and I had been caught in the middle of our game. It had begun like any other: she went into a bar first; I followed. She flirted; I watched. She hit it off with one guy so well that she’d forgotten about me in the moment. These were usually the best experiences.

When the night wound down and the inevitable questions were asked, she begged off, making the excuse that a friend was meeting up with her early the next morning and she needed to go. The guy pointed his finger right at me and asked if I was her friend. “Because I think your husband

will be fine if I return you by dawn,” she later told me he’d said. I didn’t know what was going on, other than that we were made.

It had ended in a scene that still made me hot around the collar. She’d played dumb, sticking to her story as she backed away from him. When she turned and bolted, he’d shouted, “What kind of game are you playing, bitch? Your wimp-husband is cool with it. Why aren’t you?”

I’d heard the quip and it set me off. Security intervened before it came to blows, but the psychological ones had landed, and landed deep.

I had no desire to be humiliated. We talked about at length after that, and it took more than a month for us to even consider playing again. I had no desire to have her dalliances rubbed in my face. I didn’t want to feel inferior, or wimpy, or less of a man. Thankfully, Dani felt the same way.

The next time we were free and away from home was last Saturday, at Nuance. And now here we were.

“Dean, you need to come surfing with us before you fly home.”

It had come up over dinner that I’d never gone and Penelope was adamant I try.

“You’re here until Saturday?”

“That’s what my ticket says.”

“Tomorrow’s out if we’re going to hit the clubs, but don’t book any meetings for Thursday or Friday morning.”

“Not sure about HulaBabes, but the guys at Island Erotica aren’t into the early morning meetings, anyway,” Mick added. My other two potential clients were Hawaii-based porn studios—their money was as green as any other—and Mick happened to moonlight as a video producer at one of the more “artistic” of the two.

“So Mick, is that why you’re so pale?” I asked.

We’d followed up the champagne with a pitcher of frozen margaritas and I finally had enough liquid courage to ask the question that had been bugging me since I met him.

“Kind of.”

Penelope poked him. “You do spend a lot of time in doors, looking at tapes of naked chicks.”

“Hey, someone’s got to do it, right? It takes time to make something classy. Am I right, Dean?”

“I suddenly realized you may have one of the best jobs ever,” I said.

“Men.”

“Anyway, I took that job after the accident. Once upon a time, I was as much a sun-worshiper as Penny or Alex—and definitely a better surfer. “

“Is this revisionist history now?” Penelope asked.

Mick ignored her.

“It was on a trip down in Australia that it happened. The waves are awesome here, but there were some monsters down in Oz. Huge things, as tall as most of the buildings in Maui. It makes me shiver just thinking about it.”

He didn’t shiver, but he did start rubbing his shoulder.

“As if that weren’t enough, a storm rolled in on our third day. I knew storms from living here half my life—knew I should stay away. But the waves were too tempting.” He shook his head. “I got caught inside this gnarly wave. Hammered me. I remember hitting the bottom, then rolling up onto the beach like a piece of ocean garbage.”

He looked at me and smiled.

“Broke my neck. It was months before I could even walk, and if I surf... well, docs say I shouldn’t even think about it again.” He laughed. “You look freaked. It’s cool. I’m alive, right?”

“So that’s why you work with Sandy? Since you can’t surf, you share it with others?”

“I work with Alex for all kinds of reasons. That’s one of them.”

“Why do you call him Alex?”

“Inside joke that stuck.” He left it at that and I didn’t press.

“I think I’m ready to dance!” Penelope broke in, standing up and moving her hips as if we’d not believed her.

“I think you’re ready to crash.” Mick was chattier after the drinks that we were all feeling. “Penny is as much a night owl as the sun is. I give her a half hour at the club before she sneaks off to catch a cab home.”

We arrived at the club shortly after ten. Inside, the music was loud, the drinks were being poured, and the club was empty. Strange sight, that, but one I should have expected for a Tuesday night.

“I guess we’re early?” I offered.

Penelope shook her head. “This isn’t where the fun is. Come on.”

She took my hand and pulled me through the club’s empty interior. Without the press of bodies to absorb the beats, it was *loud*.

Outside, though, things became clearer. “Ah. *Beach Club*.”

The back of the club opened onto a poured concrete patio that crawled down to the beach. Tiki torches and paper lanterns provided a chill ambience that worked with the dance music—same as what was playing inside, but so much more manageable out here. A bonfire raged closer to the water, surrounded by dancers, their blurred silhouettes tribal and surreal.

“This is awesome,” I said.

“Isn’t it?”

Beyond the fire, nearly lost in the star-lit beach, I could just make out sofas and tables strewn across the sand, some occupied by couples looking for a private moment out in the open.

Before I’d made a few steps into the salty night air, I felt a tap on my shoulder and turned to her. Not my wife. She was lost in the crowd. No, someone much more unexpected.

That moment when you recognize someone but have no idea how? That. She was hot, for sure. Her long hair fell blade-straight from her center part and flashed crimson in the yellow firelight. She had a tiny nose stud that should have given her away, but my eyes kept darting up and down her tall, lithesome body, which was adorned in a short denim skirt and a pink top more kerchief than blouse. You don’t forget a body like that.

It was her sharp cheeks and dancing hazel eyes that brought recognition, although she looked so different here than she had ferrying drinks at Nuance—more glam than tough girl chic.

Once I finished congratulating myself on making the connection, my heart sank. The one person in Hawaii who knew our game had just entered, stage left. Fuck.

“Hey, dude. Long time...”

“Hi...” I trailed off when I realized I never caught her name, other than Waitress.

“Avery.”

“Avery. Nice to see you again. I’m—”

“Dean. I remember. I also remember you left without saying goodbye.”

“I’m sorry. I didn’t realize we had that kind of relationship.”

She smirked. “Well, apparently you felt close enough to stalk me.”

“I’m not—” I remembered Mick and Penelope. “I’m out celebrating, actually. Mick, Penelope, this is...Avery?”

“We’ve met,” Mick said with a laugh. “How’s it going, Aves?”

“Hey, Mickey. Penny. How fuckin’ crazy small a world is this? You’re working with this guy?” She blinked, making quick connections of her own. “Hold up. Is this the new guy?”

Mick laughed. “No, no. Ha. No, Dean is helping Aloha Spirit stream video.”

Penelope was laughing too and I felt like the punch line to a joke I didn’t understand.

“What are you guys talking about?”

“Avery thought you were in porn.”

“I was just *asking*. He’s cute enough.”

Penelope nodded.

“Thanks, but why would you—Ohhh...”

Avery finally looked sheepish. She was a porn star? No way. No way! I studied her again. Long and lean with small, high breasts and narrow hips—not to mention her intimidating beauty...she just wasn’t the kind of girl I’d imagine doing porn.

“Really?”

“Really? You’re judging? You?”

The one person in Hawaii who knew our game...

“No, not judging. Just surprised. You’re so—”

“Hot? Or sexy.”

“Beautiful.”

Avery beamed. “Thanks, man. But you do know that kind of things works in this industry, right? Or are you saying I’m *too* beautiful for porn? Because that sounds an awful lot like a judgment.”

“I—”

Mick bailed me out. “Have you seen Alex?”

“I saw him earlier. He’s here with some tasty arm candy.” She finally released me from her hazel gaze.

Danielle. Here with Sandy. I shriveled inside at the potential awkwardness of this situation. All my plans of begging off, claiming jetlag or exhaustion from the long day and spending my night alone in my hotel room came flooding back. Somewhere along the way—probably around the part where the margarita pitcher was introduced—I’d forgotten all about those plans. Now, here I was, standing before the one woman who could make things ever more awkward, and being lead out to find my wife and her new lover.

Avery squeezed in beside me, her arms around mine. “Don’t worry, your secret’s still safe.”

My ears burned. “Thanks.”

“Just relax. Tonight’s going to be fun.”

I found Danielle on the dance floor, washed in the orange light of the bonfire. She’d worn her hair loose, cascading straight before forming lazy, golden coils around her shoulders.

“Come on.” Avery pulled me away from Mick and Penelope.

Penny gave me a little wave and a smile, as though to say, “Have fun.”

I almost pushed Avery away, worried about appearances when she whispered, “Be cool.”

I tried to be. I did. I let myself be led to the bar. I let her order us a round of tequila shots. I even let Avery push close enough to fill my nose with her flowery scent. But cool, I was not. Not with Danielle out there, tossing her hair and wiggling her hips before a chill and pleased looking Sandy.

“This is the first time you’ve done this.” Avery drew me back with her husky voice.

“Not exactly. Remember Saturday?”

She shook her head. “Saturday, you were playing. Maybe it got a little out of hand, but she was always going to go home with you. But they walked in together tonight, and I’m pretty sure they’re going to leave the same way.”

My gut churned. “Yeah, me too.”

“How do you feel about that?”

“Like I need a drink.”

“I’ve got ya covered.” She picked up the shot glasses, brimming with clear liquid. “Tequila is what you drink when you’re about to do something completely fucking insane.”

“This qualifies.”

“Sure does.” With that, she downed the shot without aid of salt or lime or ritual. I followed suit. “Another, for good measure?”

“Maybe later. I didn’t come here exactly sober.”

“Your loss.” She ordered another for herself. “I think it’s pretty awesome, you know. What you two are doing. It’s hot as hell.”

“Preaching to the choir.” Although I wasn’t sure this choir was singing in harmony just yet. Every time I thought about what we were doing, I hit a discordant note.

“So does it work both ways?”

I realized how close Avery was standing and stiffened. “We never...we never talked about it.”

Well, we kind of did. Back when this fantasy first came up, Danielle half thought I had an ulterior motive to sleep with other women. At the time, I hadn’t. But women who looked like Avery weren’t coming on to me. Christ, a *porn star* was coming on to me.

I felt the wash of guilt for not discouraging, but I still didn’t discourage.

“Talking is important.” Her fingers walked up my chest. “Keep me in mind if you do.”

“Sure.”

“Your heart is racing. I like that. That for me? Or them?”

She directed me back out to where Danielle and Sandy were. They’d slowed down and Sandy was whispering something to Dani. Her wide smile made me more jealous than the dancing.

“Both.”

Whatever Sandy had said made Danielle laugh, and in turn made my heart thump.

“More them though. Your wife’s going to love Sandy. He’s got a nice big cock.”

Oh, God. My trousers tightened, but I couldn’t adjust myself—not in front of Avery.

“Don’t worry, though. You’re cuter than Sandy.” When had she moved the hand on my chest down to my cock? “And more than man enough, it seems.”

“Avery...”

Mercifully, she stepped away. “And a gentleman, too. Your wife is lucky.”

I mumbled something like a thanks.

She leaned back on the bar, elbows back. I darted a glance at her chest, where her nipples screamed through her halter top. She had a belly piercing to match her nose ring, I saw, a glittering stone that cast a rainbow across her flat stomach.

“Go back to your party. And remember, be cool.”

I left Avery at the bar, feeling like I’d lost my life preserver, and rejoined Mick and Penelope. A wooden railing marked the edge of the patio before the club yielded to the beach, and the two were leaning against it, watching the waves crash through the night. A few people were settled into the Adirondack chairs clustered in the sand, but most of the crowd was behind us.

Mick rubbed Penelope’s lower back and she sidled closer. They were a couple? Interesting.

“Hey, you two.”

They didn’t jump or quickly distance themselves. They just turned and smiled.

“I thought you were getting a drink,” Penelope said. Her smile made me color.

I flexed my empty hand. “I...forgot.” I almost added that we were just talking, but knew how that would sound. “It’s peaceful out here.”

“It’s a nice night. Calm.”

The calm before the storm? “Yeah.”

“Our fearless leader looked like he’s having fun,” Mick said.

“I’m pretty sure he’s going to have a lot more later tonight.”

My chest tightened at Penelope’s words. “She does look fun.” Did I really say that? Or was it only in my head?

“Here they come.”

Mick nodded behind me, and when I turned, I saw them pick their way through the crowd.

I couldn’t take my eyes off her. Dressed in a pair of white, cuffed shorts and a white bikini top, draped with a mesh blouse to give the sexy outfit class, Danielle demanded attention.

That her fingers were entwined with Sandy’s didn’t go unnoticed.

When she saw me, her shock was so brief that I was pretty sure no one else saw it—just the quick flare of her eyes and a stutter in her step, then she was all sheepish smiles.

“Everyone, I’d like you to meet Danielle. Danielle, Penny, Mick, and Dean. While they don’t look it, Penny and Mick are some of the best executives I could ask for. And this fellow,” he clapped me on the shoulder, “is my newest best friend. He’s going to propel me into the future.”

“Nice to meet you all,” Danielle said with a wave. “If you don’t mind, I need to use the restroom.”

The four of us watched her strut back toward the main building, her ass encased in her white short-shorts. She put an extra sway in her hips.

Sandy’s strong jaw was all grin. “Didn’t I tell you she’s something?”

I couldn’t deny that she was. “Very hot.”

“Come on, Mick, let’s dance.” Penelope dragged the pale surfer out onto the dance floor, leaving me alone with Sandy. Now I really felt like I’d lost my life preserver.

“I want to thank you again for reaching out to us. The more I think about what Aloha Spirit can become, the more excited I get.”

“Hey, I’m glad I found you before someone else.” It was hard to maintain professionalism when I felt so shell-shocked.

“You don’t have a drink. Come on, let’s fix that.”

He turned and walked toward the bar before I could object. I could definitely feel the tequila shot. My phone buzzed as I followed.

—i had no idea it was YOU we were meeting up with. i swear!

For whatever reason, that was nice to read. As long as she was as uncomfortable as I was. With Sandy right next to me, I didn’t dare text her back. A little silent treatment would do her good, anyway.

Sandy ordered us a couple beers rather than liquor—thank God—and a margarita for Danielle. Our beers arrived before either the margarita or Danielle, and he raised his glass.

“To partnership.”

How ironic.

“To success,” I said. And drank deeply.

Toast done, Sandy waved someone over. “Avery. Hey, Avery. I’d like to introduce you to someone.”

Of course. I gulped more beer down.

“Hey to you, too, Sandy.”

The surfer ignored her sarcasm. “Dean, meet Avery. Avery, this is Dean.”

“It’s nice to meet you, Dean.” Avery was a better actor than I figured most porn stars were.

“Dean and I are in business together now.”

“So you are...” Her tongue darted out between her teeth as she smiled at me.

Danielle chose that moment to rejoin us. Sandy reached out and pulled her close. She glanced at me, but didn’t resist.

“And this is Danielle. You two met Saturday, I believe,” Sandy said.

“Oh, you remembered?” Was that jealousy in Avery’s voice?

“Don’t be like that, Aves. You know I always remember you.”

Avery rolled her eyes and sidled up to me. “So tell me what kind of business you two are up to.”

I picked up on the double meaning and started speaking before Danielle or Sandy did, too. I fumbled out an explanation of what Nimbus Solutions did, and Avery pretended to cling to every word, even as I heard myself descend into technical jargon.

I finally chanced a look at Danielle. She was smiling inwardly. It was Sandy who finally rescued me.

“Dean’s going to help Aloha Spirit Media reach millions of new viewers. That little cable access show I started five years ago is about to go global, and that’s awesome.”

He looked from Danielle to Avery to me, and I could feel the enthusiasm radiating off him.

“Do you know what the ‘aloha spirit’ is?” he asked.

The question was mostly for Danielle, who was leaning with her back to him. She shook her head. “Not the spirit part. Aloha means ‘hello’ and ‘goodbye,’ right?”

“And ‘love,’ yes. That’s all part of it. Aloha spirit is about harmony, unity, kindness. You know Jung’s concept of collective unconscious? That’s part of it.” He dribbled his fingers down her arm. “We’re all connected, like your shoulder to your arm to your hand.” He threaded his fingers into hers. “But aloha spirit takes it further. It’s not just about connection, but what we do with that connection.”

Closing his hand, he turned her against him. Even in her tall, white heels, she had to lean back to look up at him.

“So aloha spirit is just an elaborate Hawaiian pick-up line?”

Avery laughed at the joke.

“We take it very seriously. It’s even in our constitution—”

“Supposedly,” Avery interrupted.

“It’s there, in the Revised Statutes. Google it if you don’t believe me. Point is—”

Danielle cut him off this time. “Point is Hawaiians have legalized pick-up lines. Got it.”

Avery snickered. Sandy sighed. “Want to dance some more?”

“See, all you had to do was ask.”

This time, when she took to the dance floor, with an audience that encompassed more than Sandy’s hands and Sandy’s dark eyes, she performed. I saw it in the bump and grind, how she tossed her hair and became one with the rhythm. She knew my eyes were on her and wasn’t going to disappoint.

“You can’t stare at them all night. Sandy will think you’ve got a crush on him. Come on.” Avery dragged me out to join them

Dancing and I have never had the best of relationships, and hip-hop and I were even more estranged, but as soon as Avery slid up against me, her lean body coiling like a snake, my hips came alive.

And then the DJ spun the current beat into *Jump Around* and the dance floor went nuts. Avery wrapped her hand around the back of my neck, drew me close, and started grinding against me. The smile leaped to my lips. I let go of my last reservations and finally enjoyed myself out there, laughing out loud as the entire floor started bouncing with the refrain.

“I feel like I’m in middle school all over again.” I was out of breath by the time a slower, slinkier beat took its place.

“Oh? Does that look like middle school to you?”

I followed her eyes to Danielle and Sandy, who were openly making out as their bodies rolled along with the intimate tempo. Hips to hips, legs entwined, they looked like they were fucking with their clothes on.

With a jolt, I was back to that uncertain place I’d been living since we’d started: excited beyond comprehension yet so anxious I wanted to scream.

“Now that’s aloha spirit at work, don’t you think?” Avery insinuated through the fog of my doubt. “After this song is over, he’s going to ask her to go back to his place. Think she’ll say yes?”

I knew she would and it made me hard. Avery pressed her leg against my erection and her lips into the spot behind my ear.

“She wants him. Remember Saturday, when I told you that here, she was free to be someone she’s not? Tonight, she wants to be his. Are you

going to let her?”

“Yes.”

“Do you want her to?”

“Yes...”

“Good. Here they come.”

The song had ended at some point. Avery extricated herself from my and turned to Sandy and Danielle. They walked hand-in-hand. The sight made me dizzy. Or maybe it was Avery’s words?

“Guys, I think we’re headed out.” As Sandy spoke, Danielle blinked and glanced away. “Dean, I’ll catch up with you tomorrow. We have more to discuss.”

“You’ve got my number.” How my voice stayed even was beyond me. “It was nice meeting you, Danielle.”

Her eyes locked onto mine, as bashful as I’ve ever seen them. *You sure about this?* they asked. Last chance.

I let the moment slip away like the ocean retreating down the beach.

“Nice meeting you, too, Dean. You two have fun.” Mischief gleamed behind her blue eyes. “Don’t do anything we wouldn’t.”

Had she...did she...?

My mind couldn’t even formulate the question before she and Sandy were headed for the exit.

Had she just given me permission to fuck Avery?

Avery certainly read it that way. She flattened herself against me, her mouth covering mine before I could backpedal out of it. By the time I pulled free, my wife was gone.

All those emotions that had been waging a pitched battle since Danielle and I had started playing? They took on a new twist, familiar yet different.

She led me off the dance floor and back to the bar. We leaned on it, facing one another. She looked up at me through her long lashes.

“Looks like it *does* work both ways.”

You don’t refuse a woman with Avery’s chiseled beauty. Not with those pointed brows or bright hazel irises. Certainly not with those cheekbones.

“Yeah. Good to know.”

I forced a chuckle, but my mind was already envisioning what she’d look like on her knees with her lips wrapped around my cock. This felt like

the fulfillment of a fantasy that I wasn't sure I wanted.

Avery spoke first.

"You know we can't do that, right?"

I released a breath, and with it, a healthy dose of tension. "Oh, thank God."

"Hey now. You're going to hurt my feelings, dude."

"No, no. That's not what I meant. You're super hot. You know that. But it doesn't feel right. It was never part of *my* fantasy, you know? And I was trying to figure out how to let you down without offending you."

Avery laughed.

"I'm a big girl. But I love that you're concerned. You're a true gentleman."

She straightened the lapel of my starched shirt and for a moment, I reconsidered. A night with a porn star wasn't something that came along very often. And Danielle *did* pretty much give me permission.

Avery read something else in my hesitation.

"You going to be okay? I know where Sandy lives. It still may not be too late."

To stop them? To watch? I shook my head.

"I'm fine. I mean, I'll be fine. Just... there's a lot to process."

Avery nodded. "Want to grab a bite to eat? Or a coffee? There are a few cafes open late night."

"I think I just want to go back to my room."

"Come on, let's get you into a cab then."

She escorted me through the music-blaring club—still empty—and out to the curb, where a line of taxis waited. Despite knowing where things stood, she still kissed me before putting me inside, and slipped a card into my hand.

"Call me if you change your mind. My cell's on there." One final smile blossomed across her beautiful face. "And if you're feeling lonely, there's a URL on there, too. Definitely not safe for work."

I trembled the whole ride back to the hotel. I even asked the cabbie to turn his A/C down only to learn it wasn't on. Hugging myself, I stared outside as the Hawaiian night raced by.

I tried taking my mind off the inevitable. I really did. I focused on the glittering canvas of the starry sky, something I could never see back home—was Danielle seeing the same thing as she lay on her back with Sandy pumping into her?

I shook my head.

The streets downtown had bustled earlier today; now they were empty but for a lone couple, leaning on one another and laughing. They hailed the taxi as we passed, but the driver didn't slow. They looked nothing like Sandy and Danielle, but I was reminded of them anyway.

I tried making chit-chat with the driver, but he didn't speak great English and that ended as poorly as my other attempts to distract. So I stopped trying.

Danielle was going to fuck another man.

How could a reality like that be so cold and hard, yet hot and vibrant at the same time? She loved me. I didn't question that anymore. But she also loved our game—I wasn't going to question that, either. At first, she did it for me, but somewhere along the way, she started enjoying it. She liked the eyes on her. The attention. It turned her on.

So here we were at the culmination of our game. Would things ever be the same? Could they?

I took a shower in my room, cold enough to discourage me from beating off. When I dried off, a text waited for me.

—you're sure?

It had arrived ten minutes ago. The shaking returned as I thumbed a reply.

—go for it

I waited another ten minutes, but received no response. My cock grew harder with each passing minute.

I retrieved the card Avery had given me from the pocket of my trousers, then grabbed my laptop. I knew one way to force my thoughts to other things.

The web address was to a profile page off of Island Erotica's site. I'd visited the porn site before—purely for research purposes!—and had been impressed by the classy design of it. Opening Avery's page didn't produce a dozen pop-ups. The screen wasn't littered with tasteless animated gif

advertises—just her face and bare shoulders, and those stunning eyes staring out at me.

Beside the photo was her bio and stats. She was born in L.A. Twenty-four-years-old. She was bi. Her favorite position to fuck was reverse cowboy.

Below that were thumbs of photo sets and videos she was in and large, glowing letters that read, *BECOME A MEMBER NOW AND SEE ALL OF AVERY.*

I scanned her sets. Most of them were solo shots. For some reason, that surprised me. After all the anticipation, I figured she was more hardcore. Of course, there were those, too. There were a handful of girl-girl sets and twice as many boy-girl shoots. Despite the small size of the thumbnails, Avery's sex appeal shined through. She defied the stereotypes I had of porn stars with her lean body and natural breasts. She should be modeling high fashion, not spreading her legs.

I clicked the join link and pulled out my credit card. Then my cock. The shakes returned, this time more out of heady anticipation than nerves.

I wish I could say that I took my time with Avery, savoring each photo as she revealed more and more of her tawny body. That had absolutely been my intention at some point. But when access was granted, I wolfed her down.

At least I got the order right. Solo sets. Lesbian sets. Hardcore sets. With the solo shoots, I realized how much I'd turned down by coming back here alone. I could have had those tits in my hands, rolling her pale nipples in my mouth. I could have kissed down her flat stomach. I could have pushed my cock into her glistening snatch, marked with a narrow wedge of hair as if to say *fuck here*.

But here I was, alone with my dick in my hand. Is this what it felt like to maintain my dignity?

I brushed my insecurities aside and moved on to the lesbian shoots. Avery's profile didn't lie. She was definitely bisexual. I could tell by the way she kissed her partners, deep kisses filled with tongue and passion, or how she went down on them, tongue slicing between their nether lips.

But I skimmed it all, eager to move on to the boy-girl shoots. To see the beauty who had hung off me all night—who called me “dude” and knew my secret—get fucked on film.

When her first boy-girl set loaded and my eyes danced across the screen of thumbnails, I thought for a moment that I'd fallen asleep—her partner couldn't have been Sandy, right? He just looked like him in my delirious mindset. Right?

I looked again. Even with the man out of focus most of the time, I couldn't deny it. It was him: blonde, styled hair, square jaw. The broad shoulders of an ox. My newest client was a fucking porn star?

I didn't bother loading any of the stills. I went straight for the video, expanding the movie to full screen. As I watched Sandy feed his fat cock into Avery's welcoming mouth, another realization hit me. This was the cock my wife was currently enjoying—a porn star's cock. Even after subtracting the length granted him by the photographer's angles and the way he'd shaved it bare, it was still huge.

The man fucking my wife was a porn star!?

That ended me. My cum arced over my chest, gutting me until all that was left was a shallow-breathing husk.

And even then, the video played on. Avery's moans assaulted me. She was on her side, Sandy behind her, his thick cock splitting her pussy in well-lit, well-produced HD.

Upon reflection, I should have known. The clues and connections had been there all night long. Mick and his job with Island Erotica. The people Sandy seemed to know. Even the set name, "Avery and *Alex*," should have prepared me.

I started to grow hard again. I slammed the lid of the laptop closed, listening to the hard drive spin down to sleep. That's how I felt. I cleaned myself, crawled into bed, and hoped sleep would embrace me.

It didn't. Not for a long time. Instead, I was haunted by images of Danielle and Sandy—made more vivid by the video I'd watched.

Like in the video, Danielle lay naked on her side, bathed in sunlight and surrounded by bright white linen. Sandy was behind her, buried to his clean shaven balls in her stretched pussy. She stretched her leg up on his hip to spread herself wider. To accommodate more of his girth. And when she came, she screamed his name.

I must have fallen asleep at some point. I woke the next morning to the sound of the door clicking closed. My mouth was dry. My head pounded with a hang-over. But with that sound, I was instantly awake.

“You’re back. What time is it?” My voice sounded like boots on gravel and felt worse.

“Just after ten. I didn’t mean to wake you.” Danielle was carrying her heels, but wore the same white outfit she’d had on last night.

So it wasn’t a dream.

She slipped into bed beside me, studied me for a long moment, then kissed me. It started soft and I resisted taking it deeper. My dreams were still fresh. Jealousy still rankled me. But there was love, too. And wonder. She pushed her tongue past my lips and I welcomed her in. The fresh scent of shampoo and soap enveloped me. She’d showered before coming back, which meant she’d actually done it...

“Tell me. Tell me what happened.” I was hard, and not just from morning wood.

Danielle fixed her beautiful blues on me, her lashes fluttering. She wore no makeup. No eye-liner. No blush. No lipstick. Yet still, her beauty made my heart ache. This was Danielle. My wife. My partner.

“I did it.”

My chest clenched.

“I fucked him.”

Chapter 5

Confessions

It's one thing to suspect. It's entirely different to *know*. And now I did. The world went mute and its silence crushed me. I could see Danielle talking. Her lips moved, her brow furrowed, but I couldn't hear a damn thing.

She'd fucked him. She'd fucked another man. My wife—the mother of my son and the woman I was going to grow old with—had let another man's cock into her.

"...Dean?" She bit her lower lip. Concern filled her eyes. "I knew I shouldn't have—"

I cut her off with a kiss, ramming my tongue into her mouth. I twisted her onto her back and rained kisses down from above. I moved from her lips with a smack and attacked the nape of her neck and the crook behind her ear. She gasped, finally recovering.

"You're so sexy." My voice was raspy and low, but against her ear, it was enough. "So, so fucking sexy."

"Mmm... Dean..."

"Tell me a story. Tell me what happened after you left."

The mesh shirt came off and I pulled the white bikini top away from her nipples. They swelled tight and hard, ready for my mouth.

"He...has a beautiful home. Huge one, right...right on the beach."

"That's not all he has that's huge." The words tumbled out before I could stop them. She didn't know about Alex the Pornstar—or if she did, she didn't know I knew.

I felt her stiffen a little and pull back. I looked up at her. Saw the flush in her cheeks.

"He's not huge."

Liar. "I'm sorry to hear that."

"I mean, he's not small, either." Her eyes flickered away. "Anyway, he took me on a tour of his place—"

"Which ended in the bedroom."

"Are you going to let me tell the story?"

"Sorry."

“We actually ended up on the back patio, listening to the ocean. We... kissed. For a long time. And, um, explored a lot with our hands.”

I remembered how much their hands had explored at Nuance. I kept my mouth shut, kissing down her flat belly.

“After a while, though, clothes started coming off. It all just felt natural, you know? I wasn’t nervous. I just went with it.”

I unsnapped her white shorts and peeled them open. She wasn’t wearing panties, and waxed hairless as it was, nothing hid the red of her pussy. Those puffy lips glistened in the morning light, already engorged.

“He...he pushed me down and I...took him into my mouth. Gah—”

I did the same to her, covering her cunt with my mouth and sucking gently.

“I felt so bad doing that. I could hear the waves and feel the breeze on my skin. And... well, he felt different in my mouth. I couldn’t pretend it was you.”

I sucked off her pussy and looked up at her. She’d closed her eyes, lost in the memory. “Had you been trying to pretend it was me before?”

“Sort of. Sometimes.”

“Did it turn you on? When you were so bad?”

“Yes. It’s crazy, but...I actually got myself off while blowing him. And I barely had to touch myself. I felt like such a slut but...yeah, honey, right there.”

I felt the imminence of her orgasm in her quivering thighs and her shallow breathes, and backed off. She groaned until I rose up over her and sliced my cock between her swollen pussy lips.

“Did he come in your mouth?”

“Yeah. It didn’t take long. He said he’d been pent up all night.”

“What happened next?”

“He ate me.” She eyed me. “He’s good with his tongue—not as good as you, but I still came all over his face.”

I wasn’t sure how much I could last. My balls tightened. I slowed my pace.

“After that, he was hard again. Said he liked how loud I got.”

“He made you moan, did he?” My hips picked up speed again.

“Yes, baby. I couldn’t help it.”

“So he was hard again...”

“Mm hm. He pulled me into his lap, facing the water. He told me to play with my nipples, so I did, while he...he...”

“Yes?” I heard the hysteria in my voice.

“While he entered me. While his cock filled my pussy. While he fucked me with his hard dick.”

“Uh, God!”

She met each thrust with a hard, upward undulation. The wet slapping of our hips were like whip cracks in my ears, driving me harder and faster.

“Did he make you come? Did his strange cock get you off?”

“Uh, yes. Yes, baby. Yes!” She tossed her head back, her mind and body reliving the moment. Her cunt clenched and coaxed, driving over the edge.

I exploded inside her, filling her with my heat and never slowing my pace. She cried harder, her orgasm finding a second wind. Was she thinking of Sandy’s cock? Was she thinking of what a slut she was? Or was she thinking of me?

“Gah!” I grasped her hips, yanked her one last time against me, and spilled the last of me as deep as it would go.

I collapsed atop her, huffing and sputtering into her golden hair. I felt her nails on my back and realized she’d left scratches there that I was only now discovering.

When I rediscovered my strength, I rolled off her and stared at the ceiling. She snuggled up beside me, stroking my chest in quiet contemplation.

“So how was your night? Did you have fun with that...other woman? She was pretty.”

“She was. But we didn’t do anything.”

She was like an idling engine that finally turned off.

“You could have. I would have been fine with it.”

“Really?”

“I mean, how could I not after...after last night?”

“You’d be jealous.” Something occurred to me then. “You *were* jealous, weren’t you?”

She hesitated before answering. “Kinda. Yeah.”

“And that’s what let you finally cross the line. You used that jealousy, didn’t you?”

Her silence was answer enough. Danielle had her own tumultuous set of emotions going into last night. I'd just been too busy focusing on mine.

"I'm not mad. I get it. Trust me."

She shifted. I felt her eyes on me.

"I do trust you. So much." She kissed my shoulder. "I was scared last night. Scared of myself. I felt things that I hadn't felt in years."

That bordered on a level of treacle I wasn't comfortable with. She seemed to hear it, too.

"Sorry, not like I have feelings for Sandy. Quite the opposite, actually. I've done a few things that I'm not exactly proud of. Really slutty things. Things I've never told you."

I kept my mouth shut as my heart accelerated into this new unknown.

"I've buried that girl. Or thought I did. It was easy once I met you. You made me want to be a better person. And for so long, she stayed buried."

"And then we started playing this game."

"Right. Even then, though, it was still me, Danielle, playing with you." She bit her lip. "Then I met Sandy."

She drew a breath. I could feel her quickening heart match mine.

"Remember the neighbor I used to tease? The one who lived behind my apartment in college?"

"The Peeping Tom who watched you fuck some guy."

How could I forget? I hadn't heard that story until after we'd begun this game. I got the feeling I was about to hear a whole lot more.

"So it's actually that guy I was with—not my neighbor—who reminds me so much of Sandy."

"Do I know him?"

"No, no. Tyler graduated before we met, and we were never a couple. Not in the romantic sense, anyway."

"Fuck buddies."

My wife had a fuck buddy. That blew me away.

"Sure. Anyway, he was actually the one who wanted to keep the curtains open that time, when the neighbor spied on us. We came home that night, drunk. We got into it. I'd worn this little party dress all night long and I was so horny... all those eyes on me like that... So when we started making out, I didn't realize the window wasn't covered until I was down to my panties. And when I did, I also saw the neighbor hiding at the edge of the curtain. So did Tyler.

“When I went to shut it, Tyler stopped me. ‘Let’s give him a show. You can do that for me, right, babe?’ He’d been saying stuff like that all night. I was his show. His arm candy. He made me feel so objectified. I hated it, but —”

“Couldn’t stop yourself.”

“Not even if I tried. Which I didn’t. Not hard enough. I wasn’t thinking straight. I let Tyler bend me over, right in front of the window, and fuck me. And when he asked me to put on a show for the neighbor, I did, rubbing my tits, fingering my clit. I never took my eyes off the neighbor. He saw it all and... it was so fucking hot.”

I’d heard the story before, but it still managed to make my cock stir.

“After that, Tyler was obsessed with showing me off. He’d been into it before, but fucking in front of the neighbor took it to a whole other place.”

I shifted, uncomfortable.

“Kind of like me and the wife-watching games?”

“Kind of. But that’s different. With us, it always felt more mutual—that’s how it felt to me, anyway. You were turned on because I was.”

That wasn’t the whole of it, but I didn’t interrupt.

“With Tyler, it was all about him. I was like a sexy accessory for him. A physical manifestation of his male ego.”

“And you liked that? That doesn’t sound like you.”

“It’s not. Not the ‘me’ you know, at least. But I was young and stupid. I’d been the nerd in high school. In college, I wanted to try being the... slut.” She winced at the word, but didn’t take it back.

“And Sandy reminds you of him?”

“Not quite. Sandy reminds me a little of how I felt with Tyler.”

“Like a slut, you mean?”

She nodded. Her hair felt like silk.

“Some of the things you and I have done recently remind me of that, too.”

“I’m sorry. I didn’t mean for you to feel like that—”

“I know. Don’t worry, baby. And I should have said something if it was really bothering me. But that’s just it. Part of me liked it. Part of me didn’t want to stop.”

“Like what?”

“Like at that club Saturday night. Fooling around in that booth with Sandy brought me back. Tyler used to like to play around like that in public.

I'd even gone down at him in a more visible booth than the one Saturday."

She looked up at me bashfully, like she was waiting to be judged. All I could think to say was, "That's crazy."

"Told you. After the incident with the neighbor, things got crazier. We only lasted another month, tops, but the things I ended up doing..." She shook her head. "It's like we both knew we were flaming out."

I didn't want to ask what she'd done then, but I couldn't not.

"What was the craziest thing you did?"

"Probably a foursome."

The confession peeled my sanity away, and behind it was anger. "Why didn't you ever tell me?"

"I wanted to, but it's not something you open a relationship with. *Hey, thanks for dinner. By the way, I'm a recovering slut who's just off a foursome with the last guy I was with.* And by the time I felt comfortable enough that I could tell you, I knew you were the one for me. I was afraid it would scare you off."

"Are you kidding me? You don't know guys, then, because that would have been hot to hear."

"Sure, guys love sluts. But they don't marry sluts. They don't see a family and a future with them. And that's fine. It is what it is. By that time, I wasn't the person I'd been in college. But I'd had my heart broken more than once when all a guy saw in me was a pair of tits and a fun time, when I wanted him to see the woman I'd become. I was afraid the same would happen with you."

This was hard for Dani to confess. I held her tight and kissed the top of her head. "I love you, honey. I would always love you."

"Easy to say now. Back then, I couldn't risk it."

"So a foursome, huh? What was that like?"

"See? You're trying to turn me back into a slut."

I started to get defensive when I saw her smile.

"Not a slut," I said. "That's not the right word. Not the way you're using it, anyway. But...maybe I was trying to unleash a crazier side of you. I think I may have been trying to do that for the past year."

"You say *tomaato*. I say *tomahto*." Dani giggled. "After last night, we can both probably say you were successful. At least temporarily."

"So tell me about the foursome."

"You're not going to let this one go, are you?"

“Now that I know? No way.”

Danielle gathered her thoughts, her hand making its lazy way down to my cock. All this talk had aroused me and she found me hard.

“I partied hard back then. Drank way too much. Hooked up with guys I’d never bring home to Mom. Looking back on it, it was stupid and reckless—”

“But you didn’t know. We all think we’re invincible at that age.”

“Tyler and I had been out partying. He’d kept me on edge all evening long, whispering how hot I looked, and how all the guys wanted to fuck me. I was so horny. By the time we got home, I was ready to tear his clothes off. But when we burst through the door, we walked in on Tyler’s roommate, Tom, who was getting a blow job from his girlfriend.”

“‘Don’t mind me,’ I remember Tom saying. His girlfriend didn’t even pause a beat. She just kept on sucking. And Tyler, much to my shock, dragged me over to the love seat next to it, settled in, and pulled me into his lap. He touched me, telling me to watch them. ‘Does it turn you on?’ he asked. It did. It so did. She was just going to town on him, her cheeks hollowing with each bob of her head, her ponytail bouncing like crazy. I wondered if that’s how I looked...”

She began to stroke my cock as her eyes went distant with memory. I didn’t say anything, afraid to break the spell.

“When Tyler pushed me between his legs, I went for it. Watching them was hot. Being watched... that was so much more. I could feel Tom’s eyes on me. I wanted him to wish he had me sucking him, not his girlfriend, so I gave Tyler the loudest, messiest blowjob I could. I actually got off when he did, and I didn’t even touch myself.”

She finally looked up at me, remembering I was there. “You’re so hard. I guess you’re not disgusted by me.”

I stroked her hair. “Not disgusted, no.”

She rose, settled her hips on mine, and took me back inside of her.

“Mmm... That’s nice. I love you so much, Dean. I’m sorry I never told you this stuff.”

“I understand. It took me a long time to confess the wife-watching thing.”

“Thanks.” She sighed, feeling me slid in and out of her. “For a long time after, I hated the person I’d been. It wasn’t how I was raised and when Bobby came along, it certainly wasn’t how I was going to raise him.”

“And that all changed with Sandy.”

“Yes and no. I think it had been changing for a while. Your fantasy brought up my own memories—”

“And you found yourself still ashamed, but also turned on.”

Danielle nodded. Her slowly gyrating hips felt like magic on me.

“That’s how I feel about you with other men. It’s confusing. On the one hand, I’m so jealous that I want to go ballistic. But it turns me on even more.”

“Well, I can tell you that energy you bottle up turns into some of the best sex I’ve ever had.”

“Better than the foursome?”

“Oh, definitely.”

“Better than last night?”

“Everything is better with you there. Last night, I kept wishing you were with me.”

“Me too.”

We made love in silence after that. I still had a lot of questions. Like what else happened during the foursome? She’d always said that she wasn’t attracted to other girls, but had she hooked up with the other girlfriend? Or both guys? And what about last night? She’d described her first time with Sandy, but I couldn’t believe that was the last. Not with her coming home at 10 the next morning.

But I kept it all to myself. There would be time to ask later. For now, I just sank back into the warm mattress and let Danielle’s rhythmic undulation take me to yet another orgasm.

I met with the people at HulaBabes after lunch. All three were older guys wearing Hawaiian shirts and sporting gray beards. I knew at once this wasn’t the right fit, but it took us two hours to collectively come to that conclusion. HulaBabes didn’t care about quality as much as it did about quantity. They supplied the quantity and were happy enough with the quality of their feeds.

The failed meeting gave me the late afternoon off, though. I was just about to call Danielle when Sandy called.

“I heard you struck out with the porn guys. Want to catch a happy hour?”

I wanted to go back to the hotel—to Danielle—but I was here for business. Sandy was a lot of things—nice guy, island guide, first man to fuck my wife since we were married—but above all that, he was business, a client who needed to be cultivated. So I reluctantly agreed to meet him for drinks and let Danielle know I'd be out.

The thing was, as far as Sandy knew, I'd traveled here on my own. And on my own, I had no where to go but back to my hotel.

"I'm sorry about last night. I should have been entertaining you. Instead, I abandoned you. Did you at least have fun with Aves?"

Sandy had picked me up and drove us out to an ocean-side bar in Lahaina. It looked like most of the bars I'd been to with its strings of colored lights hung about the perimeter and the ukulele and slack-key guitar dancing on a salty ocean breeze. I could get used to bars like this.

"Avery was awesome, but I couldn't." I tapped my ring. "I didn't clear this vacation for adventure."

Ha.

"Bummer, man. She's amazing."

I know. I saw.

"Don't worry about last night, either," I said. "I'm pretty sure I'm the one who should be entertaining you, not the other way around."

Sandy waved his hand. "Here, you're a guest. If I ever come to San Francisco, you can return the favor."

Now that would be complicated, I thought. He'd want to meet Danielle...

"You must really love your wife. Avery doesn't get turned down often."

"I bet. I won't lie. She was tempting. But yeah, I do love her."

I glanced up at Sandy. He was watching me carefully, beer in hand.

"Think you'll ever settle down?" I asked.

"Some day. Right now, I like being a free spirit." His grin said it all.

"She looked like a pretty free spirit last night."

Sandy chuckled, sipping his beer before answering.

"They always are when they're on vacation. But yeah, she was particularly... free."

My dick began to swell. "Fun night?"

"You have no idea."

Oh, but I did. Sort of.

“Like I said before, women on vacation tend to be someone they’re not when here. Free of the real world, they can unleash their inner slut. Well, hers was particularly dirty. A real screamer.”

“She didn’t look it. She was hot, but had an innocent thing going on.”

“It’s always the innocent looking ones, isn’t it?”

I so wanted to ask him for specifics, but that would have been weird. I hardly knew him, despite this conversation. Luckily, Sandy was in a chatty mood.

“We were up most of the night, I’d say. I think my stamina is better than most guys, but she challenged it. She’s a runner, apparently. Had just finished a marathon a month ago. She sure had the body for it.” He shook his head. “We fucked this morning, too, before she left. In my outdoor shower. That was her idea. She said she liked doing it outdoors.”

I thought of the waterfall encounter, which seemed so long ago. “Incredible.”

“You know, if I were to settle down, it would be with someone like her.”

“Yeah? Isn’t that the kind of woman you have fun with? Not marry?”

“Nah. Danielle is special. That’s what I was so drawn to. She’s got more going on than just a pretty smile. She’s the kind of woman who can be both crazy in bed, and great as a partner. She’ll make someone really happy one day.”

My voice, my body, everything felt strained. “Not you?”

“Maybe if she’d come into my life at another point. I told you, right now, I’m happy being free.”

The vice around my chest released itself. I almost gasped for breath but stopped myself. “Enjoy it. Something tells me you’ll find the right woman. You’ll know her when you do.”

“That what happened with you?”

“The first time I met my wife, it was as I was getting fired from this company I worked for.” I laughed at the memory.

“She was your boss?”

“A consultant. The kind you never want to bring in for your company. I was working for one of those small software companies that had expanded too quickly during the tech boom. We actually held on a little after the bubble burst, but we all knew it was a matter of time. When they fired us—sorry, made us more *efficient*, they called us all into the conference room

while they locked our computers and froze our accounts. More than half of us were let go that day. My wife was one of the consultants brought in to deal with it.”

It still made me laugh. She looked so young up there, as her own bosses made the reasoned announcements. Young and uncomfortable. It had been her first job out of school, a fresh masters in human resources degree in her hand, and she hated it.

“I ran into her at a bar later that day, where I had been consoling myself. I wouldn’t have approached her—not someone as pretty as her—under normal circumstances, but I had plenty of liquid courage. I wanted an apology. She gave me a date instead.”

Dani quit her job shortly after that. That kind of consulting wasn’t for her. Instead, she found a job at a smaller company working in their two-person HR department. That experience led her to manage the department, then one for a larger company, and now head of the corporate HR directorate she was at now.

“So when did you know she was the one?”

“When she handed me my termination letter and said, ‘I’m sorry.’ It’s stupid, but I believed that she really was. That’s how she’s always been. Compassionate to a fault. Empathetic, but not afraid to tell you how she feels.” I looked back at Sandy. “And being a drop-dead gorgeous blonde helps, too.”

“I’ll drink to that!” He raised his glass. “To drop-dead gorgeous blondes.”

Drinks turned into dinner. Dinner turned into more drinks. We talked about anything and everything. Movies. Sports. Television shows—being in Hawaii, *Lost* came up, of course. But mostly, we talked about surfing. Sandy lived and breathed it. It wasn’t a hobby. It wasn’t even just a passion. For Sandy, surfing was a philosophy. A way of life. It all went back to a board under his feet and his fingers tickling through the curl of a wave.

“Out there, you realize how little control you have in life. We’re all at the whim of forces so much greater than us. When surfing, it’s the waves that are our masters. In life, it’s circumstance. I try to do the best I can with what I’m given.”

“Which is a lot, it seems.”

“I’ve been fortunate, yeah. But I grew up on the poorer side of town. Surfing was all I had. Turned out, surfing was all I needed. And a little luck.

You, my friend, are part of that luck. Aloha Spirit would have done okay, but we were plateauing. In a few more years, we'd probably close our doors. Now...who knows, right?"

"You're being too modest. A man makes his own destiny. That's what I've always felt. You seize the opportunities you get. I saw your company's potential. I went after it."

"Don't confuse being an opportunist with control. The moment you think you're the master, the wave will flatten you. Always respect that."

"Thanks, wise one," I said.

"Ha. Right. Well, here's another piece of advice. Not mine, but a wiser man than me. One thing we can control is how we treat others. That's the true spirit of aloha. Respect one another because we're all connected."

"I will drink to that."

"You'll do more than that. You're done with that hotel and its breakfast buffet. I want you to stay at my place for the rest of your week here."

"I couldn't do that."

I couldn't leave my wife alone—but then, Sandy didn't know that.

"Nonsense. If you think it's an imposition, don't. I'd actually be insulted if you didn't take my offer. My house is huge. I have three empty bedrooms. You can have your pick."

Now this was a bind. I had no excuse. No way to politely decline without either revealing that I'd been lying about my wife being here, and if I did that, then he'd want to meet her. And if he met her—

"Come on. Let's go over there now. I've got beer there, and plenty more conversation."

"I..." Shit. "My stuff is back at my hotel and I've got a meeting tomorrow."

"Tomorrow afternoon, you mean. With Island Erotica, right?"

With your porn company. Right. Of course he'd know. "Yeah. It's a two o'clock. But I still need to prepare."

"I'll drive you back tomorrow then. We can get your stuff then. I've been meaning to stop by their place, anyway, so it all works out."

Right. It all works out.

I texted Danielle as we hailed a cab.

—complication. i won't be coming home tonight. talk to you tomorrow.

"Texting your wife?"

“Yeah.”

He looked at his watch. “She’s up late. Isn’t it after two there?”

I slid my phone back into my pocket before she could respond. “Yeah, but she sometimes gets worried. And we didn’t get to say goodnight. She’s probably asleep, though.” I ignored it as it vibrated and hoped he didn’t hear.

“Shit, bro. Didn’t mean to keep you from her. I didn’t realize the time.”

“Don’t worry about it. She can take care of herself.”

Even at night, Sandy’s home was impressive. It sat on the water, flanked in palm trees and sandy beach. Single-storied, the house sprawled out along the sand like a someone settling down for a nap.

We drank beers by the side of the kidney shaped pool, cast in the ghostly light of the submerged lamps. All I could think about was how he’d fucked Danielle right where I was sitting the night before. I could barely keep up with my end of the conversation, claiming to be tired when he called me on it.

“I’m sorry, man. You’ve had a long day. Come on, let me show you the guest room.”

He gave me a quick tour of his place on the way in. The floor plan was open and airy, with high ceilings and huge windows. The kitchen was state-of-the-art, the furniture was bohemian contemporary, and he had a television that must have been at least 70 inches large.

He showed me the bathroom I could use.

“The towels are clean. And there should be some soap and shampoo in there if you want to shower.”

I didn’t.

“I’m sorry. I’m dead on my feet.”

“Hey, no worries. We’ll finish the tour tomorrow.”

My guest room was three doors down and also looked out on the beach. I didn’t bother getting ready. I just stripped down to my boxers and climbed into bed. I could hear the crash of the ocean and the chirp of evening insects, but I couldn’t sleep. It should have been soothing. Instead, I squirmed.

This was a different kind of loneliness than what I'd gone through last night. Last night, I had insecurity to keep me company.

—are you still awake?

I sat in the dark, phone in hand, and waited. When Danielle didn't immediately pick up, irrational thoughts started nudging their way beneath the sheets with me. What if she'd found another bedmate for the night? What if she'd become so comfortable with her ride on the wild side that she couldn't get enough? What if she'd gone down to the pool that day and met that young guy from Sunday—the one who looked like me? She could be filled with his strange cock right now.

—still awake. where are you?

—at sandy's. fucking aloha spirit

—LOL. you better be alone!

—ditto

Her replies had come quickly after the first, but this next one took a moment.

—so you don't wish i just had earth shattering sex with a guy i met at the pool today?

Oh, God. Now I was hard.

—go on

—when you said you'd be out, i decided to keep lounging by the pool and drinking. met a guy. he said he'd keep me company.

Oh, God. Now I was hard and jacking off.

—what a gentleman

—you wouldn't be saying that if you knew the things we just did

Dani was lying, I knew, but that didn't stop it from turning me on. I pictured her on her back, naked in the bed, pressing her fingers between her thighs as she imagined herself being bad. It didn't matter whether the dirty things she texted were real—they were still dirty.

—did you fuck him?

—oh yes

Oh, God.

—did he make you come?

—so many times, dean. i was really bad

—how many times?

—i lost count. but i made him come four times by the end

Four times?! And “by the end?” Then I realized: she wasn’t talking about tonight. She was talking about last night. I felt like I’d been t-boned at an intersection by a car I didn’t know was there.

—so sandy’s not a gentleman?

Her reply didn’t arrive as quickly as the last. I wondered if she was scrambling on her end, realizing I’d figured out her game. Or was she playing with herself, coming at the memory of last night?

—no. definitely not

—i was on the patio where you first fucked him. nice view

Again, another long pause before her reply.

—i didn’t notice the view. i did from the bedroom, though. wrong side for a sunrise, but the sky glows just as pink in the west

They’d been up all night, fucking. We’d tried that once but couldn’t quite make it before dozing off.

—did you get any sleep?

—VERY little

—you’re thinking about it now, aren’t you?

—yes

—are you touching yourself?

—yes

—keep touching yourself. keep thinking about last night, and how naughty you were. how slutty you were, going back to a strange man’s house and fucking him into the morning. how you sucked him back to life each time he came, wanting more and more

—oh, dean

I could practically hear her moans through the text. I beat off in time, thumbing a text with my free hand.

—tell me something new. tell me something you did that i don't know

I'd burned by the point of no return. My cum boiled in my balls, on the threshold of a dizzying orgasm. I held my cock at its base, skin taut, not daring to move. Taking pressure off, or breathing the wrong way—or even breathing at all—and I'd be there.

—he came on my face

And a moment later.

—and i loved it

That destroyed me. I convulsed like a fucking volcano, my cum arcing in hot streams across my chest and thighs before I could cup and contain it. Things got hazy. I forgot to breath, and when I remembered, I couldn't breath enough.

My phone came alive in my hand, buzzing and rumbling, Danielle's photo flashing across its surface with her smiling white teeth and beautiful blue eyes. Then it went dark again. "Missed call: Danielle." I didn't have the strength to call her back. Luckily, she did it for me a moment later.

I didn't wait for her to say hello. My question was already spewing forth before I'd fully hit TALK. "Did you really?"

"Yes." Her voice was small, but the impact enormous.

"I... always thought you thought that was degrading."

"I did. I mean, if you'd have asked me a year ago, I would have told you *no way*. But last night, in the moment...I don't know. I can't explain it. I wanted it. I...I asked for it."

I saw it unfold in my head. Dani on her knees, looking up at Sandy. Begging for him to come on her. It kept taking my breath away.

"You want to be foursome girl with him."

She laughed. "*Foursome girl*. I guess I do."

I went to the window. I could just make out the waves, capped white and rippling in the night. With Sandy, Danielle could be the girl she had to deny in real life. Sandy attributed her loose behavior to the vacation. After hanging out with him, I knew it was more than that.

Her voice trembled down the line.

"Dean? You there? Say something."

“I’m here. And I’m not mad. Seriously. I think it’s super hot.”

I felt exposed. This wasn’t a confession I’d intended to make, but here it was, spewing forth.

“I think it’s so fucking sexy that you got carried away with Sandy. I get so jealous that it makes me gnash my teeth and clench my teeth—right now, I’m amped up on enough adrenaline that if you were here, you wouldn’t know what hit you—but I can’t think of a time when I thought you were sexier.”

“Really?”

“And I hate myself for thinking that. For objectifying you like that. Of turning you into a slut. But fuck, it’s hot.”

She was quiet for a long time. I didn’t dare speak. This could go either way.

It went the right way. I could breath easier.

“I love you, Dean.”

“I love you, too, Dani. I wish I wasn’t trapped here.”

“Poor you. A prisoner in that gorgeous beach front house.”

“There’s no where I’d rather be than with you. Right now.”

Those weren’t tears welling up in my eyes, were they?

“I’ll see you tomorrow, right?” she asked.

“We’ll figure out a way.”

“We better. I *need* you, Dean.”

I felt better when we hung up, wishing each other love and good nights, but it was still lonely. I drifted to sleep to the lull of the ocean, swept into a sea of confessions.

Chapter 6

Prisoner

The next day, Thursday, I woke to an empty house. 8:03, read the clock. Groggy and disoriented, I collected myself and my thoughts under the spray of Sandy's shower. The guy wanted me to stay at his place as a guest, and as far as he knew, I'd come to Hawaii alone. Further, Sandy had just become one of my most important clients—not the biggest, but certainly one with the highest upside.

Sandy had set out fresh fruit and granola on the island counter in his kitchen. I found some yogurt in the fridge and fixed myself a parfait, all the while puzzling out how I could extricate myself from this situation. I finished breakfast without a solution.

The kicker was that I couldn't even sneak out. My rental wasn't here. Hell, I didn't even know where "here" was. I decided to look around.

In daylight, the house was even more impressive. The high ceilings and high windows filled the rooms with sunlight, and Sandy's beachy furniture unified the indoor with the outdoor. I'd been wrong about my first impressions: this house wasn't a single story sprawl. The living room was high and expansive, filled with light, but the rest of the house was split into a couple levels. I could see the second floor loft overlooking the living room, and wondered what was up there.

Sandy's master suite made up part of it. Plush carpeting rose between my toes as I walked in. Two walk-in closets flanked the entrance to the room, along with a master bathroom that looked as big as my hotel room back at the Marriott.

I barely saw any of it. All my attention was focused on the king-sized bed. Sandy hadn't remade the bed that morning, sheets tossed and pillows askew. Morning light filtered in from the east side, through a pair of skylights built high into the ceiling.

I imagined Danielle waking in the middle of that bed, naked. Then I imagined her straddling Sandy, fucking him as the sun lit up her tussled blonde hair. My cock leapt to life. I shook my head and forced myself to leave the bedroom.

The room that overlooked the main living space was a game room that included a couple pinball machines, a red-felted billiard table, and a television only slightly smaller than the one downstairs. I looked at the pool table and pictured Danielle bent over it, getting fucked from behind, and had to leave that room, too.

In fact, that image haunted me anywhere I went, turning my insides to jelly and my cock to steel. I finally found a newspaper on the front door and settled in by the pool—consequently where I knew they'd fucked. For whatever reason, the certainty helped keep my erection at bay.

Sandy rolled in a half hour later, stripped down to his long swimming trunks. He carried a surfboard under one arm and a bag of breakfast in the other.

“Morning, man. Did you sleep well?”

Not really.

“Yes, it was great.”

“Good to hear. I picked up some grub in case you're still hungry.”

Sandy had more tattoos than I remembered from the video with Avery. In that video, he'd had a few tribal scrawls across his shoulders. Those had spread now, wrapping down his ribcage, across his muscled chest, and out to the middle of his thick biceps. It fit his surfer chic, but again, it didn't match up with the kind of guy Danielle was normally attracted to.

Even Sandy commented on how different we were once he'd lent me a pair of drunks to swim in.

“Don't take this as a come on or something, dude, but you know you've got that tall, dark, and handsome thing down to a tee, right? No wonder Avery was so disappointed when you didn't go home with her.”

I was flattered to be complimented by a guy built like Sandy.

“Thanks. Running's more my thing. I spend too much time on the road to get into a gym habit, but you can run anywhere.”

“I hear that. I'm fortunate to have a gym in the basement, and at work. And I rarely travel.”

“It shows.”

Sandy grinned. “Now are *you* coming on to *me*?”

I spent the morning with him, lounging by the pool and waxing poetic. He had the laid back attitude of a stoner without actually being a stoner.

“I did that back in the day and it was fun, but these days, I like keeping a clear head,” he explained.

In any other circumstances, I would have loved to have a relaxing morning in Hawaii. Are you kidding me? But I couldn't relax. All I wanted to do was get back to Dani. To hold her, and kiss her, and fuck her silly. Yet I was stuck with Sandy, a prisoner in paradise.

"Your meeting's at 2? Cool, we'll drive in after lunch. We can swing by your hotel so you can check out and get your stuff, then head over to Island Erotica. That work?"

No, it didn't, but I couldn't say that.

"Sure, works for me."

Shit, what was I going to do about Danielle being there?

"Be right back. I need to use the restroom."

—you need to gather your things and get another room. sandy is coming by to get my stuff. sorry babe, will catch up later

I didn't get an immediate response, and that's when the pressure cooker began. If Sandy saw that a woman was staying in my room, he'd rightly assume I'd actually brought my wife. Then he'd wonder why I'd lied about it. That alone could be disastrous. All trust would be flushed. I couldn't even imagine what he'd do if he learned that it was my wife he'd been sleeping with. Would he think it was some kind of bribe? Would he void our contract on the spot?

I was actually sweating by the time we rolled up to the Marriott and Sandy and I climbed out of his Hummer. I checked my phone again. Still no response. Oh, fuck.

"I can run up and grab my stuff. It's no big deal," I said.

"Fuck that. I'm here to help. Come on, let's go."

My heart had climbed halfway up my throat by the time we reached the door. My hand shook as I drew the keycard and slipped it in.

"Nice view," Sandy said.

He stepped inside, his eyes on the windows that looked out on the ocean as I scanned the room. Things were tidy. Housekeeping had made the bed and straightened things up. My suitcase sat on the suitcase stand, my suits were hung in the closet beside me.

And Danielle had moved her things out.

—squirming?

I was laughing before I could slip my phone back into my pocket.

"What's so funny?"

“Nothing. Just...something my wife texted.”

Sandy didn't press.

“Come on, let's get your things. Don't want to be late for the pornographers.”

Island Erotica's office was located on the third floor office building in downtown Kahului, nestled in between a consultancy firm and a real estate agency. The lobby wasn't as large as Aloha Spirit's, but it wasn't as seedy as HulaBabes', either.

Also unlike HulaBabes, the meeting went really well. It helped that I knew Mick, who could vouch for me. It *really* helped that these guys cared so much about quality.

“You have a brand that elevates it above your competition. Nimbus Solutions can help elevate you even higher.”

Sandy caught up with the others in the office while I was in negotiations. I wondered how long ago that video I'd watched had been shot. I don't remember a date on it, but I don't remember a lot of things clearly about that night.

Sandy was talking to Avery when I emerged from Island Erotica's small conference room. Today, she exemplified the girl-next-door. Her long auburn hair was loose and down. She'd traded her party dress for a worn pair of low-rise jeans and a snug t-shirt. The look worked very well for her, but I still imagined her naked. It was impossible not to.

“Well hello there. Come back to change your mind?” she asked me.

My cheeks warmed. “I don't think so.”

“Don't think? So there's a chance.”

“There's always a chance.”

I couldn't help myself, despite the crippling guilt that accompanied the throw-away line. Danielle wouldn't be okay with that, no matter what she said. I changed the subject.

“So what are you doing here?”

She smirked. “Are you asking me if I'm working?”

“Um, no. I didn't mean—”

“Want to watch? Or maybe you already did. Did you go to that link on my card?”

My face must have looked like a tomato. Her eyes lit up.

“You did! Did you like it?”

I needed to salvage some dignity here. “It was very well produced.”

They broke out in laughter.

“They do a good job here, don’t they, Sandy?”

“Very professional,” he agreed.

“It was nice seeing you again, Dean. You have my number if you want to see how the real thing matches up.”

I could not get away from Sandy. After leaving Island Erotica, we grabbed a drink down where the cruise ships docked.

“It’s quieter these days. Aloha Cruiselines stopped passing through here a few years back. Now we mostly get the smaller, private lines. It’s hurt the local economy, for sure.”

Sandy took a lot of pride in his birthplace. Seeing it hit harder times hurt him, as well, and he tried giving back as much as he could. That was clear by the number of people who knew him as we walked around. Everyone had a good word to say, a hearty handshake or a warm hug.

Sandy’s responses all felt genuine. “I’m so glad your daughter’s doing well,” or “Your brother’s restaurant serves the best lasagna on the island. I’ve sent all my friends there.”

An older woman approached us at dinner, tears welling beneath a frowning brow. “Thank you so much for saving my boy. We all thought he was lost.”

“He was just confused. We’ve all been there. I’m glad we could help.”

When she was gone, Sandy explained that the woman’s son had been a meth addict in the worst way. He wasn’t alone. Drug-use was on the rise as things with the economy got worse. Sandy had set up a free clinic to help fight it. The woman’s son was one of his success cases.

“He’s one of the few, sadly, but we have to try.”

I saw many of the qualities I loved in Danielle mirrored in Sandy. In a different world, they’d make a good couple. That made me uneasy, considering the game we were playing, but that was all behind us now. Sandy hadn’t brought her up today, and with his island hospitality kicking into overdrive, I didn’t see him leaving me again.

Still, I wanted to leave him. At least for a time. The more hours spent away from my beautiful wife, the more anxious I became.

“So tonight, I was thinking we go to one of my favorite spots in Maui. Nuance is more lounge than club. The music’s not so loud that you can’t talk, and they have amazing private booths.”

Yes, they sure did.

“I hate to be a downer, but I was actually thinking of turning in early, if that’s cool. I’m not as young as you—I’ll be 40 in a few months—and these long nights have me exhausted.”

“Hey, I totally understand. Let’s go back to mine and have some beers. Turn in early.”

I groaned. I needed to occupy him so I could see Danielle. This wasn’t working out.

“Don’t let me ruin your Thursday night. Go out. Have fun. Do a shot for me.”

He weighed his options, the host versus the young man. I knew I almost had him.

“Seriously, I’m good. Just drop me off at my car and give me a set of keys and I’ll be fine.”

“You sure?”

“One hundred percent.”

“Okay, man. But you better save up your strength, because tomorrow night we’re going all out.”

I shivered, wondering what that could mean, and thanked a higher power for finally getting away from Sandy’s hospitality.

I breathed a sigh of relief as I watched his Hummer pull out of the Marriott lot, leaving me next to my rental car. The fresh air and anticipation made me jittery.

I waited long enough that I was sure he wasn’t going to come back, then texted Danielle.

–i’m free. where are you?!

–still at the marriott. room 117

I speed-walked my way through the lobby and was practically running by the time I reached the room. I was breathing hard by the time the door opened.

Danielle was fastening a pair of earrings on: diamond studs that I'd given her for our fifth anniversary.

"That was fast."

I stepped into her, pulled her close, and kissed her. She squealed before returning the kiss, playing her tongue against mine.

I ran my hands down her body, covered in a terrycloth robe. She'd teased out her blonde hair, still warm from a recent blow-dry. I pulled back and looked at her for the first time. She'd put on a fresh application of makeup. Resplendent in smoky eye shadow and glittery eye liner, she carried a Sixties glam.

"Going out?"

Her eyes skittered away. "Actually, yes. Sandy just called and invited me out dancing."

My scalp burned. "Dancing..."

"I thought you were with him, so I accepted."

Well, this was interesting. Had I just sprung my own trap?

"I only just got away from him." Was that petulance in my voice?

"I've been trying to ditch him all day, but the guy is fucking super host."

"So you're not going dancing?"

"No. I'm supposed to be headed back to his place to sleep."

Danielle hid her smile with her hand. "Huh."

"Yeah. Huh."

Then we were laughing. I'm not sure who started. It didn't matter. It felt good. Cathartic. She ushered me into her new room and shut the door behind me, still in the tail end of her mirth.

"Want me to cancel?"

Interesting way she phrased the question. It wasn't a statement or suggestion. Did she actually want to go? My own question sizzled uncomfortably up my spine.

So I delayed answering either and reached for the belt of her robe. "I want to see what you were going to wear, first."

"Well, the outfit's not complete yet."

The robe hit the floor. After the long separation, Danielle's near naked body had my heart racing. I didn't recognize the lacy boy-short and bra set, but I liked the way it lifted her tits and conformed to the top-half of her ass cheeks. She did a spin for me on her toes, then kissed me.

"I had some free time today and got a few new things."

I looked beyond her, where the bed was covered in bags and boxes. “I see that.”

“Maybe I got a little carried away.”

She sauntered into the room. I couldn’t stop looking at her lace-encased ass—an ass that another man had enjoyed just two nights prior. The shopping spree wasn’t the only thing she’d gotten carried away with. And now she was going out with him again. This acidic high was becoming all too familiar.

When I couldn’t find my tongue, she explained her outfit.

“I thought I’d go with a Sixties theme.” Sitting on the edge of the bed, she pulled a pair of white patent go-go boots from a box.

“I figured, I could wear it for Halloween if nothing else.”

She stood and modeled in just her lingerie and boots. Was this a preview of what Sandy would get to see? If so, he was going to be happy. The three-inch heels transformed her already amazing legs and ass into perfection.

The dress was new, too, a short polyester mini printed with bold floral patterns. The oranges, pinks, and purples felt more Sixties mod than Hawaiian tropics, like the dress she’d last worn to Nuance, but she was definitely going for a theme.

“Wow. That’s short.” I began to understand why she went with boy-shorts rather than the thongs she preferred to wear beneath her dresses.

She tugged at the hem, which stopped higher on her thighs than anything I’d seen her wear in public.

“It’s not too much, is it?”

“I love it.”

“It feels fun.”

“Looks fun, too.” I collected her in my arms. She smelled good. Felt better. “My little Free Bird.”

“So...want me to cancel?”

“Now that you’re all dolled up? It doesn’t seem fair.”

She saw the permission in my joke. “Thank you, baby. I love you.”

Thank you. Thank you for letting me fuck another man. I would have laughed at the absurdity were I not so turned on.

“Dani, you know that woman you’re so afraid of? The foursome girl?”

She looked hesitant. “Yeah?”

“Find her tonight. You want to, I know you do. Don’t think about me. Or Bobby. Or work. Tonight, you’re a free bird.”

The kiss she gave me caught me off-balance. I didn’t fall, but I never caught up to its ferocity until she pulled away. Her lipstick had begun to smear, but before I could say anything, she dropped to her knees.

“How about I start now, then?”

“Uhh, Dani...”

She swallowed my cock in her warm, wet mouth, and wasted no time getting down to dick-sucking business. She wasn’t here to tease or prolong. She was here to blow me as swiftly and efficiently as she was capable of—which turned out to be pretty swift and exceptionally efficient.

She stormed my cock, her tongue a cyclone, her sucks high and pressurized. Even her words battered my ears like thunder, spoken between loud slurps.

“Tonight, I’m going to do this to Sandy. It makes me wet just thinking about it.”

She sucked me back in, drawing the head along the inside of her cheek. My knees trembled. She pulled off again.

“Maybe even in the club, tucked back in a booth, but with all those people around.”

She took me into her throat, her nose burying in my pubic hair. I thought of Sandy with his shaved crotch and large cock. Would she be able to take him this deep? Would she try?

“Oh, fuck, Dani...so close...”

She pulled back, jacking her frothy spit into my shaft as she looked up at me.

“Or maybe I’ll just fuck Sandy right there in the club. I’ve been thinking about his cock all day. I don’t know if I can wait much longer.”

I popped with just her hand on my cock. Danielle deftly dodged the load, letting it land across the bed and boxes. I crumpled to the floor, spent and gasping.

She pulled me close, her kiss gentle.

“I love you, Dean. So, so much. If you want me to stay, I’ll stay.”

“Did you really think about his cock all day?”

She didn’t pause a beat. “I did.”

“Then stop thinking and go. Have fun. We’ll talk in the morning.”

She must have sensed the conflict in me because her eyes didn't leave mine for a long moment.

“Are you sure? I'm not going to risk what we've got. The foursome girl was fun, but I'm not her anymore.”

But you want to be? I want you to be? That was a guilty thought.

“I know. But tonight, you will be. Go. Have fun. And I'll see you in the morning.”

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Chapter 7

Voyeur

Even with Danielle's torrid blowjob, I stayed hard the entire drive to Sandy's. I'd stayed with her as she brushed her teeth and fixed her makeup. We'd parted at the hotel's taxi stand, where she'd waved out the back window, off to see her lover.

Her lover. The word hammered like a nail into my heart. The woman I'd fallen in love with nine years ago had a lover. Would I have started this game a year ago if I'd known this was where we'd end up? Would I have sent that text?

—hey there stranger

We'd had a rare night without our son and decided to get a drink after work, like old times. Heavy traffic had delayed my arrival a few and Danielle was already sitting at the bar when I walked in. I saw her then as if for the first time: the kind of woman I'd do anything to get to know. Like me, she'd come straight from work and still had her suit on, a gray pants-and-jacket affair that complimented her slender body.

I'd read this article in Maxim—or one of those men's magazines—about spicing up a relationship with some role-playing. We'd pretend to be strangers and pick each other up. It had sounded silly at the time, but as I stood in the bar's entrance and watched Danielle thumb through her emails, I realized that there wouldn't be much need to pretend—we'd become strangers without even realizing it.

So I sent her the text, then approached her. She was confused at first, puzzled when I asked her if she was waiting for someone, rather than launch into a recollection of my work day.

"I was waiting for someone, but he appears to be a no show." She had such a beautiful smile.

"His loss. Mind if I join you?"

"I don't know. Give me a few good reasons," she said.

"Well, I'll buy you another Cosmo when you're done."

"Okay, so you're generous..." Her blue eyes flared. "Or like taking advantage of tipsy women. Go on."

“I’m a decent conversationalist. I can talk about more than just football and brewing beer.” Two things I actually loved, probably talked too much about, and knew Danielle didn’t care much for.

Danielle’s face broke and the impromptu role-play had almost ended. “Now you’re talking. One more reason and you can stay.”

“I’m told I’m pretty amazing in bed.”

Even now, the brazen line made me laugh. Back in that bar, we’d lost it. I hadn’t laughed so hard in years. We’d stopped our play after that, but the effects were felt the rest of the night. It had been the beginning of our reconnection.

Had I known then where it would lead, would I have done it?

The questions—and my hard-on—followed me all the way to Sandy’s house. He’d given me a set of keys and I entered through the door by the pool. The pool where they’d fucked. Where Danielle had become someone else’s lover.

Whatever. In I went, fixing myself a glass of water before heading to my room. You have no right to feel so much self-pity. You drove her into his arms. You and your fucked up games.

It was almost true. I could have believed it were it not for Danielle’s confession. Had the slut I’d unleashed always been inside her, trapped in a tower of morality? Was it only a matter of time before she escaped?

I didn’t sleep. Of course not. I lay in bed, listening to the ebb and flow of the ocean as moonlit shadows danced across the ceiling. I wondered what was happening right now. Were they dancing? Was she sucking his dick in the booth as she’d teased? Or was she so horny that she couldn’t suppress the urge to mount him right there in the club.

She’d let herself be fingered in a club. She’d gone down on him the following Monday, in the cab of his SUV. Those were without my explicit permission. Tonight, I’d given it. Tonight, I’d told her to find the slutty Danielle and explore.

I heard a sound around two in the morning. I was half asleep and delirious. I’d masturbated on and off through the night, although I’d denied myself release. It was as close to self-punishment as I was comfortable with. I didn’t like to think of myself as a cuckold, even though deep down I knew that’s what I was.

Keys in the door. And laughter—a woman's, bright and confident. Danielle.

I was on my feet so fast a wave of dizziness passed through me. My cock unfurled, ready to be touched again. I gave it a tentative tug before rooting for my pants in the dark.

Another peal of laughter drifted through the quiet house. My stomach tensed. My heart raced. I pushed the door open enough to peer out.

“You're so bad.”

Her giggles were like sandbags being laid atop my chest. I was barely breathing when I heard the spit-slap of their kisses through the door.

I had to see. If I sat in the dark any longer, my heart would climb the rest of the way up my throat.

I thanked Sandy for choosing tiled floors. They were cool beneath my bare feet, but silent. I crept down the short hallway, adrenaline roaring louder than the ocean surf. My pupils must have been wide enough to drive a truck through.

The ghostly light of the pool flickered across the walls and ceiling of the living room, illuminating the open space in more than enough light to see what was going on. They'd settled onto the couch, turned most of the way in my direction. Danielle rose over Sandy, clutching his face as they swapped noisy spit.

Even though I knew better, I'd still clung to the hope that maybe it wasn't Danielle that Sandy had brought home. Maybe she'd backed out and he'd found some floozy to warm his bed. Maybe she'd been lying to me all along, telling me what I wanted to hear, teasing me that she'd been with another when she hadn't. Maybe this was all some elaborate hoax.

Seeing her there, her white go-go boots shiny on either side of Sandy's thighs, I could no longer deny any of it. This was happening—had happened. Would happen. And fuck, I wanted it to.

Her Sixties mini-dress had crept high enough to expose the lower curves of her buttocks and Sandy's hands covered them a moment later. When he pushed the dress higher, I gasped. Her panties—those sexy boy-shorts I'd seen earlier—were gone.

I ducked back into the alcove, worried that they heard my shock. Danielle's cry squelched that fear, but not the fire that consumed my body.

I peeked back out. Danielle's dress was off. Sure enough, she was naked but for her boots and bra, which was pulled down to bare her nipples.

Sandy sucked on those swollen caps as he ran a finger down her backside. She moaned louder, writhing against his hand as he curled the finger inside her from behind.

Sandy's linen shirt was unbuttoned and open, his tanned chest stony where Danielle was soft. She braced on his tree-trunk of a neck, thick and corded with flexing muscles.

"Uh, Goddd..."

She leaned further into him, pushing his face between her tits as he dipped a second finger into her pussy. She lifted her ass and clutched his head for support, smothering him with her cleavage.

"Yes, uh. Yes!"

I realized I was stroking myself again almost too late. An orgasm welled up in me, stopping only when I turned away from the scene and held my breath. Even then, Danielle's screaming orgasm nearly did me in.

Before I could firmly recover, I heard the clink of a belt being undone and the whisper of conversation I couldn't quite understand. I wished I could get closer, but couldn't. Not without being exposed.

That's when I remembered the game room upstairs, dark enough to hide in, with a balcony that perched right over their sofa.

I wanted to race up there in my eagerness, but the more prudent side of me wrestled back control. For the moment. I crept through the dark, each step as light as a cat's. The floorboards of the stairs and second story were thick and solid, but even one creak could give me away.

Then again, who'd care if it did? Not Danielle, who'd probably get off knowing I was watching. Not Sandy, who didn't seem to have much modesty when it came to this stuff—he'd done porn, after all. That left me who wanted to remain hidden, to watch from the shadows as Danielle did naughty things with another man. I wanted to see the unadulterated version and know how she behaved when she didn't know I was there.

Enough moonlight filtered into the game room that I could make out the black of the pool table and avoid rattling the cues along the wall. I heard Sandy's throaty grunts below and wondered if they'd moved on to the main show. Desperate not to miss anything, I padded swiftly across the room, using the table's edge as a guide.

Two pool balls rattled together and for one terrifying moment, I froze. Did they hear? Was a busted? Fire bloomed along my collar and raced up the back of my head. I held my breath. I opened my ears.

“Fuck, babe, your mouth feels so good. Uhh...”

I shut my eyes and sighed. Safe. For now. Pulling my hand away, I crept up to the railing and peered over.

Danielle was on her knees on the floor, her blonde hair bouncing between Sandy’s powerful thighs. He’d stripped out of his clothes and was lounging, tattooed arms thrown back behind his head. Dani used her right hand to jerk him as she sucked. Her left was splayed along the rippled landscape of his abs, as if to remind herself that he was real—and that he was not me?

I found myself comparing. I couldn’t help it, especially since she’d been in this very position with me just a few hours earlier. I wasn’t built like Sandy. Sure, I had broad shoulders and a chest I was proud of, but mine was a runner’s body where Sandy was a fucking beefcake.

Insecurity crept in at the edges. Danielle swept her hand up over the peaks of Sandy’s defined pectoral muscles, tweaking a dark nipple as she raced to blow him. I couldn’t compete with that.

“I’ve been thinking about this all night long. Ever since you gave me that teaser back at the club.”

The balcony was only fifteen feet away and I could hear Sandy’s words clearly.

“I can’t believe you did that.”

Danielle pulled off and looked up at him.

“Can’t believe I sucked your cock there? Or that I didn’t let you finish?”

“Both.”

I caught a glimpse of his fullness at last. He glistened large and thick as she pumped him between her fingers. Like in the video I’d watched the other night, he was as bare as Danielle was, a tower of sculpted flesh almost too thick for Danielle to clasp. She stroked his smooth sac.

She tugged a groan out of him.

“Do I frustrate you?”

“Nah. I know you’re not just a tease.”

I almost snorted as I thought of all the men who came before Sandy. Danielle must have been thinking the same thing.

“I can be,” she said.

“Not with me.”

I expected protest or challenge from Danielle. Instead, she shivered and lowered her mouth back to his cock. Sandy put a hand in her shoulder.

“No. As much as I love your mouth, I’m ready for more. Get me a condom.”

Danielle reached into the drawer of the side table next to the couch and pulled out a foil wrapper. As she tore it open with her teeth, it dawned on me that she didn’t need to be told where to find Sandy’s stash of rubbers. She knew. She’d done this before.

Sandy brushed her hair as she rolled it across his length. He said, “Tell me you’ve been thinking of this since yesterday.”

“You think highly of yourself, don’t you?”

“Sometimes.” There was Sandy’s good-natured laugh. “But you didn’t answer your question.”

“It crossed my mind.”

She crawled into his lap, hoisting up onto her knees until his cock rested against her moist lips. My breath caught.

“But I bet you’ve thought of it more than me.”

“You’re probably right. You do have one pretty pussy.”

“Looks even better with your cock inside it.”

She looked like Danielle. She sounded like Danielle. But I couldn’t reconcile her words and her actions with Danielle. As my mind grappled with the two sides of my wife, she sank onto Sandy’s stiff cock.

She shuddered, taking him slowly.

“Oh, yes...”

An agony of my own crept in as I watched Danielle. No more denials. No more games. This was real. Another man had his dick inside my wife. I’d been close ever since I’d moved up here. That thought nearly set me off.

“Ngh, ngh, ngh...”

Dani’s moans drifted up to me like the bubbles in champagne, turning my world dizzy and off-kilter.

Their hips accelerated—not just Danielle’s, but Sandy’s as well. The fucking took on a frenetic vibe. He slipped out at one point, glancing off her ass with a groan before positioning back against her sodden entrance. This time, he entered her without effort.

Sandy took control her hips after that, holding her above as he drove his cock in and out from below. He may have been on the bottom, but there

was no question that it was Sandy fucking Danielle, not the other way around. And she ate it up.

“Ohmygod. Oh, my, *God!*”

If she was worried about waking me in some other part of the house, she didn’t demonstrate it. She steadied herself with one hand on Sandy’s chest as the other tweaked her nipple.

“You feel so good. So good...” Sandy’s voice came on strained. “You’ve been thinking about it, too, haven’t you?”

“Yes! Ohhh...”

“I bet you played with yourself when you did.”

“Yes. I—uhhh!” I could hear the imminence of Dani’s orgasm in her guttural response.

“Did you come, thinking of this?”

“Yes!”

“Are you going to come now?”

“Yes! Yes!”

Her hips came to life again; although I wasn’t sure if that was because Sandy was guiding them along his length, or by her own volition.

“God, baby, so, so good!”

The sex hadn’t tipped me over the edge. I could abstract that, turn it into a porn production of life-like quality. Fuck knows how many times I’d imagined this moment over the past year. It was the kissing that crawled deep inside me and stirred up a riot of jealousy and hurt.

In those last moments, Sandy reached up and pulled Danielle’s mouth to his, drawing her into a loose, passionate embrace. She loved to kiss when we made love, but for some reason, I’d left that out of my fantasies when she was with other men. Watching them go at it in the throes of her orgasm brought bile to my throat—and cum welling up through my shaft.

I squeezed my cock through my pajama bottoms and came, just as my wife did. She pulled her lips from Sandy’s when it became too hard to kiss, her cries washing his face. He didn’t stop with the fucking. Didn’t slow until she begged him to stop.

“Enough, enough...too much...”

And when he did, she folded into his arms, still balanced on his cock, and kissed him warmly with a giggle.

“That was amazing.”

“Totally. You’re pretty inspiring.”

“So why didn’t you come? After a night of teasing, how could you hold back?”

I wondered the same thing. I certainly hadn’t been able to.

“Part of it’s the condom. But I also want to make the night last.”

“You didn’t seem to have trouble the other night. Don’t you have faith that I can get you back up?”

“Good point. Your mouth might be the most inspiring part of you.”

She laughed.

“You really know how to make a girl feel special.”

“You’re a great cock sucker. That doesn’t feel good to hear?”

At least part of Danielle loved hearing it. Her laugh said as much.

“What else is great about me?”

“I love your eyes. They look great when you blow me.”

Dani snorted.

“Your tits are pretty great, too. Especially when you wrapped them around my cock the other night.”

Wait, what? She’d *tit* fucked him?

“I’m detecting a theme here.”

“You’re ass actually may be your greatest feature—”

“You’re an ass.”

He kept on going without acknowledging her. “—but your pussy is a close second in greatness. But shouldn’t you have some kind of wild bush to go with that outfit?” He waved at the scraps of her dress on the floor.

Danielle’s reply was flat. “Do you really want that?”

“As much as I like thematic integrity, hell no.”

“So the great things about me all involve things that rubbed up against your cock.”

Sandy pulled her close and kissed her. “You know you’re great. I know how lucky I am, just being able to have you for a short time.”

The intimacy of the moment left me uneasy. Should I not be seeing this? Or was this the heart of my fantasy?

“Then show me how much you appreciate me,” Danielle replied.

“Yes, ma’am.”

He rolled her onto her back, his cock never slipping from her. She opened her legs around him, resting the heel of one on the couch and the other at the ridge of his buttocks.

My cock rose as they started to fuck again. Sandy's broad back blocked out most of Danielle's body, but from my vantage and the way they were stretched out along the sofa, I could see enough. I could see the way Dani caressed his thick biceps and arched up against his stony body. I watched the tattoos dance and play across Sandy's back as his muscles flexed and relaxed with each thrust. And at times, I caught glimpses of their union as they rutted—my wife stretched around Sandy's latex-sheathed cock. Each brief look sent a jolt through me, electrified lust and jealousy and unease.

Sandy's hissed question reached my ears like a torpedo blast.

"You close, babe?"

Danielle's response resembled a yes, pressurized and garbled. Sandy took it to be one, pounding her harder and faster. She linked her other foot behind his back and squeezed. It didn't slow Sandy down. He fucked her just as hard, lifting her bodily off the couch before slamming back down.

I was stroking myself in harmony with the two downstairs. Their tanned bodies were coated in sweat, turning the scene into something out of a magazine—not my real life. I zeroed in on Danielle's face, writhing in ecstasy. It was a tortured face—eyes squeezed shut, nostrils flaring—but one I was used to giving her. I'd been in dreams that felt less disembodied than this—but none ever so sexy.

Sandy pinned her down against the cushions, wrenching his hips from her pincered grasp, lifting her legs above his shoulders, and practically folding her in half.

"Ngh! What are you—"

Sandy answered with action, hammering her with short, quick thrusts that rocked her. Turned her into mush. She collected her tits in her hands, pinched her nipples, and screamed.

Sandy's grunts and groans, which had been building beneath the more vocal cries of Danielle, finally overwhelmed my wife's moans.

"Uh. Uh! UH!"

He rammed one last time, a sodden slap of skin that pressed her knees into her breasts and lifted her ass up off the bed, and came.

Somehow, I did not. I took my hand away at the last moment, leaned heavily on the railing, not caring anymore if I was discovered, and watched the two lovers twitch and sigh in the fading throes of their mutual orgasm.

Danielle shivered when it was over and Sandy set her legs down in a more natural position. He still hung over her, his pelvis against hers, arms thick with exertion.

Danielle brushed her golden hair from her face, damp and darkened with sweat, and shivered again. “God, I’m going to remember that one for a while.”

“I hope so.” Sandy leaned in and kissed her.

I shifted on my feet when they didn’t immediately break the kiss. My stomach churned as it grew deeper. Sandy tilted his head and pushed his tongue with Dani’s mouth as her fingers threaded into his short, sweaty hair.

Seeing that cut deeper than the wild fuck I’d just witnessed. This wasn’t part of my fantasy. My dreams were filled with heart-pounding moans, thrusts, grunts. With seeing Danielle unleash something unbridled and new. With all things physical, yet nothing more. This? This was more.

Incredibly, Sandy began to pump his hips again, slow and steady. Their lips parted a fraction of an inch, heads still pressed together. They shared their heavy breaths, holding each other as they started having sex again.

That’s when I came. Watching that intimate embrace felt like a betrayal, yet it was too sexy to watch for long. The last image I had before cum filled my boxers and I looked away was Danielle looking deep into Sandy’s eyes, her hand still cradling his head and her legs open around his undulating hips.

My second orgasm drained me, taking my energy along with my excitement. I lost my stomach for the fantasy. As I listened to their more hushed love-making, I wondered if that’s what it was: love.

It was silly. I knew that as soon as I thought it. Danielle loved me above all else, and I trusted her with my whole heart. She wasn’t the kind of woman who took these matters lightly, or fell in love so fast. I’d been the first person to use the L word, and she hadn’t reciprocated for another three months. “I had to be sure,” she’d explained. “I had to know.”

I leaned against the pool table for strength, but their quiet gasps conspired against me. She didn’t love Sandy, no, but what if she loved what she was doing with him? She’d buried a part of herself after meeting me. What if that part was meant to stay buried?

“Ngh, yes. Ohhh, yes...”

My cock stirred and I hated myself for it. What wrong with me? I could be losing my wife, and yet I was turned me.

The coupling below grew louder, picking up momentum. I heard the wisp of bodies shifting, a quiet giggle, some whispered words. I had to look again.

Sandy was sitting up and Danielle was in his lap, much like the first position they'd been in. Only this time, they held each other and kissed the whole time, her breasts compressed between them, his hands on her ass, guiding her slow rise and fall.

She tipped her head away and to the side as her orgasm built. Sandy took her neck, kissing the supple skin. Her climax rocked her, smaller than the fireworks of her last two, but somehow more profound.

"Come on, let's go to bed."

She rose from his lap and gathered her things.

Sandy pulled the condom off his once-again hard beast. It sagged with cum—from his last, I had to assume. He couldn't stay hard after coming twice, could he? I wasn't used to feeling inadequate, but that's how I felt now.

Danielle reached out, as though to draw him along by the hand. Instead, she grasped his erection and laughed. "Come on, big boy. You still need to fuck me doggy-style like you promised."

"I'm a man of my word."

She pulled him by the cock out of sight, although I could hear their hushed laughter down the hall and up the stairs behind me. I heard the door to the master bedroom open and close, and then nothing.

I stood in the dark for the longest time, filling the black with my tumbling thoughts. Tomorrow we'd talk, but about what? About how turned on I was? About how worried?

When I got back to my room, my phone glowed beside my bed. A text.

—hey there, stranger. enjoy the show?

At least that was a question for which I had an answer.

Chapter 8

Honesty

“Wake up, man. We’ve got some great waves this morning.”

I turned in my bed, groggy and confused. Was that Sandy’s voice? Or was I still dreaming? I rubbed my eyes and started to look around when Sandy threw the curtains open and sunlight poured in. I immediately shut them.

“Beautiful morning. Let’s not waste it.”

I glanced at the clock, proclaiming that it was just after six in the morning in bleary red numbers. I groaned.

“Come on, man, don’t tell me you didn’t get enough rest. You’re the one who went to bed early.”

And you’re the one who stayed up late, fucking my wife. Had that been a dream, too? This man was too energetic to have stayed up so late, so I was beginning to think that it was.

“I’m up, I’m up.” I sat up, immediately wanting to crawl back into bed.

“Get your suit on. I’ll meet you in front by the garage.”

I thought of my wife upstairs, passed out on the bed after her heated night of sex. That’s where I’d rather be. But that’s where I couldn’t be at all. Sandy couldn’t know our connection. That would ruin everything. So I rooted through my suitcase, found my trunks, and threw a t-shirt on over that.

For some reason, I expected to see evidence of last night out in the living room. Maybe Danielle’s crumpled dress, a discarded thong, a used condom. In the brilliant light of the Hawaiian morning, though, the airy room was as pristine and innocuous as it had ever been.

I glanced back at the house as I climbed into the yellow hummer. The bedroom windows didn’t face out this side, but could she hear the rumble of the SUV’s engine? Was she thankful that she could put off dealing with me a little longer?

“I’m surprised you’re up so early. Sounded like you had a live one last night.”

“Oh, you heard that?” Sandy hadn’t bothered with a shirt—a nice reminder of what my wife found so alluring in him. “Did we keep you up?”

“Nah,” I lied. “I did wake up a few times though.”

“So that’s why you’re so sleepy, even though you went to bed at what? Nine?”

“And how are you not?”

“Dude, the only thing that gets me more energized than a sexy woman is surfing.”

“Then you should have brought her along.”

I hoped I was doing a good job coming off collected. My insides were doing their best to sabotage me.

“I should have. Maybe tomorrow morning,” he said.

“Tomorrow morning?”

Sandy grinned. “Sorry, I forgot to mention. We’ve got another roommate. She flies out Saturday, too. You remember Danielle? The blonde I was with at Beach Club?”

“How could I forget her?”

“Yeah, she’s pretty incredible.” He shook his head, his eyes going glassy with memory, but didn’t elaborate. That only made it worse.

“Anyway, she’s not doing anything for the rest of her trip, so I asked her to hang out. I didn’t think you’d mind.”

Who me? Her husband? Mind if she hung out with her lover right before me? Why would I mind?

“You don’t mind, do you?” he asked.

“Nah.” *Liar.*

“Cool.”

Had she even thought about how awkward this would be? Or had she jumped at the opportunity to spend more time with Sandy without a second thought to me being around.

“So that was her last night?”

“The one and only.”

“Was she as good as she sounded?” Did that sound chummy? I couldn’t *not* ask it.

“Better, although she does sound pretty good, doesn’t she?” He shook his head. “She’s a special one, like I said. I wish I could keep her for more than a few nights.”

I thought of the way they'd kissed last night, slow and sensual. I forced myself to stop wringing my hands.

"Think you're falling for her? You said something about that the other night."

Fear pushed the question out, and when he didn't answer immediately, fear was all I could feel.

"My life's not a rom-com. I don't think people 'fall' for each other like they do in the movies. Could I see her playing a bigger part in my life? Sure."

Now that fear was trying to flatten me into the bucket seat.

"But not this life," he went on. "Another time, another place. Right? Who knows where I'll be in five years. Right now, though, I'm not looking for anyone. Not even one as awesome as Danielle."

"I don't understand that."

We pulled into a beach lot, empty but for a couple other cars, laden with surf-boards. He looked at me for a long moment before answering.

"You will. Trust me." He shut off the engine. "Now, here we are. Time to experience something better than sex."

Sandy was patient with his lessons. We went at it for an hour and a half, surfing the bunny slopes of the ocean—little baby rolls that proved surprisingly difficult to mount and ride. I got up once—well one and a half times—but it was exhilarating. I wanted more and knew that if I lived here, this would be something I could get into.

When we got back, it was close to eight and the sun had risen to a confident spot in the high, blue sky. As we unstrapped the boards from the roof of the Hummer, I turned to Sandy.

"You were right. I feel awake now."

"Really gets your blood going, doesn't it?"

"It does. Catching a bigger wave must be awesome."

"Nothing like it. I'm telling you, better than sex."

We walked around the side of the house, to the pool patio. Danielle was stretched out on lounge wearing nothing but an oversized men's button down and her sunglasses. She set a copy of Surf Magazine down and smiled at us. "Good morning."

Sandy turned to me. "I take back what I just said."

I would have laughed had a circus not decided to set up tent in my stomach. This was exactly what I'd been worried about: that third wheel feeling with my own wife.

Sandy crossed over to her, settling down at her side. He kissed her, long and deep. I had to look away.

"You remember Dean, right?" Sandy asked her.

Danielle dropped her eyes, staring up at me through her lashes. "Of course. He's a memorable looking guy."

"Careful now, or I might get jealous." Sandy's ironic statement diffused some of the tension. Danielle and I laughed.

"I doubt that. Have you ever been jealous?" she challenged.

"Jared Colston's parents let him surf the North Shore before mine. That burned me up."

"Surfing. Of course that's what would make you jealous," she said.

"You aren't mine. Even if we were together, you wouldn't be. Why would I ever be jealous?"

Those were some wise words.

"Dean there is married. Does your wife make you jealous?" he asked.

Focus on Sandy. Don't you dare look at Danielle. "Are you asking if I trust her? Because I do. But sure, sometimes I get jealous. I don't think I own her though."

Danielle asked the next question. "So why do you get jealous?"

I had no answer to that that wouldn't give up the game. "She's a beautiful woman. I'm not the only one who notices. But it's not a bad thing—jealousy. I'd be worried if I *didn't* get jealous from time to time."

"It's a nice reminder of what you've got," Sandy said. "Interesting."

Both their eyes were on me. What would they think if I just ran off?

Danielle saved me, holding the magazine that she'd been reading up to Sandy. "Did you know you're in here?"

"Am I?" He couldn't have sounded less genuine.

"And there are some pretty interesting things in here."

"Yeah. Ocean really is my middle name. My parents were kind of hippies."

"Not that."

Sandy's smile revealed that he knew exactly what she was referring to.

Danielle let me in on the secret. "Sandy here had a brief, yet prolific, career in pornography."

Eyes wide, brows up, that's how you fake surprise, right?

"Really?"

"It's not a big deal. Dean, you've been to Island Erotica's offices. Not as seedy as you were expecting, right?"

"Right, but it's still porn!" Danielle made an excellent point.

"And it was decent money, too. It helped me turn Aloha Spirit into something greater than a hobby. Probably not what the ancestors had in mind for aloha, but I think the ends justified the means."

"All sacrifice, was it?" Danielle rolled her eyes.

"Have you ever actually had sex on the beach? Sand gets *everywhere*." He flashed that dimpled grin, all charm. "It was a hard job, but someone's got to do it."

He wiped Danielle's skeptical expression away with a kiss that turned into more. The awkwardness returned. This time, I made my quiet retreat.

Confusion and envy raced through my veins. Jealousy and uncertainty marched in step with my beating heart. Yet there was no mistaking it: everything about this situation was a turn on. My cock hung fat, swelling each time I thought of what was happening right behind me. My balls tingled. That vibrancy I'd felt catching my one wave? I felt it here, a hundred times as strong.

They didn't stay out on the patio for long, coming in just as I poured myself a cup of coffee. Danielle disappeared upstairs as Sandy explained that he had to go in to work for part of the day.

"I left my car in town last night, so I'm going to drop Danielle off and she'll drive it back once she's got her stuff."

Once she's got her stuff. I was going to be feeling some blue balls today!

He pulled out a hiking map of the areas and pointed out some great locations to hit up. I'd already done one of the trails with Danielle last Sunday, but didn't let on. There were some great hikes not far from here.

Not that I'd be going on any of those. Not at first, anyway. With Sandy at work, this may be the last chance I'd have to be alone with Dani. I wasn't going to miss that.

She came down, back in her Sixties dress and boots from last night, ready for her drive-of-shame. I snickered at her when Sandy wasn't looking. She made slits of her eyes and stuck her tongue out.

“I’ll be in touch tonight. I’m thinking dinner out somewhere, then we’ll see where the evening takes us. Sound good?” Before I could answer Sandy’s question, he went on. “And no backing out tonight, Dean. This is your last night in Maui and you promised me we’d go all out tonight.”

I didn’t think I’d promised that at all. “Sounds like a plan. See you later?”

The drive into town and back should have taken two hours, tops. I must have felt every second of those two hours. I tried distracting myself. I took a shower—only to stop it short after I couldn’t stop from stroking myself. I took a long walk down Sandy’s private beach. I found my Kindle and tried reading. None of it worked.

Two hours turned into two and a half. Then three. I began to suspect that Danielle’s quick trip there and back had encountered a detour—one that left me with an undying erection. Blue balls would definitely be in store for me today.

I ended up by the pool, staring at the screen of my Kindle while my imagination conjured sordid half-images of what Danielle and Sandy were doing in her empty hotel room. I touched myself enough to keep my cock hard, like a gardener tending to new growth.

That’s how Danielle found me: distracted and hard, my hand between my thighs.

“Need help with that?”

I was too turned on to be embarrassed. “Please.”

She’d dressed down, slipping into a frayed pair of jean shorts and a loose blouse. I could see the straps of her tank top at her shoulders. With her hair back in a ponytail, it was a nice reminder of who my wife was.

Rather than dropping to her knees as I’d come to expect on this trip, though, she sat down next to me and kissed me. I savored the taste of mint as our tongues danced. She put a hand on my crotch, feeling the length of me, and pulled back.

“Sorry I didn’t come right back. I got...delayed.”

“Sandy?”

She didn’t glance away, although I swear her eyes wavered a little. “Yeah.”

“The man is a machine.”

Danielle hesitated. “I’m really sorry about this situation. I know you find it awkward—you’re not alone. But when he asked me to spend my last night with him, I couldn’t think of an excuse fast enough.”

“I know what you mean,” I said. “It was the same with me. It’s hard to turn the guy down, isn’t it?”

She blushed at my unintended double entendre.

“He’s pretty persuasive.” She leaned down and kissed me again. “But so are you. You’ve got me doing things that I never thought I’d do again.”

Again. That reminder. “So how did you feel last night?”

Danielle looked away, into the pool. “The truth?”

“Always.”

She nodded, but kept her focus on the glassy ripple of the chlorinated water. The edges of her mouth curled into a wistful smile.

“Sexy. Then guilty.”

Guilty enough that you did it again, just now, I didn’t point out.

She finally looked back at me. Worry lines scrawled across her forehead and between her brows.

“I hate that it makes you so jealous. I don’t ever want to hurt you.”

“*Jealousy* doesn’t mean *hurt*.”

The reassurance tumbled out of my mouth before I realized I didn’t completely buy into it. Honesty, right? I took a deep breath.

“But seeing some of that last night did hurt me. Not the fucking—that was hot. Better than I’d ever imagined. But seeing you with him...kissing him...laughing with him...that’s what really made me jealous and...I guess upset.”

Danielle’s clear blue eyes watered over. She touched my face. “Oh, Dean. I’m so sorry.”

I hated seeing her like that. “Don’t apologize. I’m still wrapping my head around it, but I think that’s part of the turn-on. If it didn’t hurt, then it wouldn’t be so hot.”

Danielle sniffled a laugh and wiped back a tear. “That’s fucked up, you know.”

I laughed, too, even as I blinked away the wetness in my own eyes. “Yeah, I know.”

“Thank you.”

“For what?” I asked.

“For being honest. I know it’s not an easy thing to do.”

“I’ll always be honest with you, Dani. That’s the only way we’re going to make it through this.”

She nodded, then paused. “Not the only way.”

Danielle climbed into my lap. We kissed for a long time, warmed by the sun and one another’s arms. We peeled our clothes back like opening gifts, reveling in our soft, naked bodies.

I’d not spent nearly as much time lying out this past week, but I tanned easily and I’d spent enough time reviewing files by the pool that it showed. I could get used to this life: the outdoors as my office, my beautiful wife never far.

Dani’s skin had achieved that ideal, golden hue, apart from the paler triangles that marked her bikini. I traced her tan lines, first around her breasts, then down between her thighs. Her skin singed my fingertips as I dipped them into her pussy. She arched, clutching my shoulder for support.

“You don’t need Sandy to be sexy, you know.” I tapped my thumb against her clit and she squirmed. “You’re so hot.”

Dani moaned as she danced on my hand.

“And you never have to feel guilty for what you did. I was there. Watching. It was so sexy.” And she was so wet. “I don’t think I’ve ever been so turned on. Even the hard parts to watch were sexy.”

Dani shut her eyes. Was she remembering? Were the creases forming on her brow delivered with memories of Sandy’s cock?

“Watching him take you like that—hard and in control...God.”

My cock rose, solid as steel, and brushed against Danielle’s buttocks.

“And the kissing...”

The images tangled in my slithering stomach. All that kissing. All that intimacy.

Dani rocked on my fingers and studied me, her face tight.

“You liked watching me kiss him?” It was hardly a question. “He was a good kisser. You know how much I love that. I could have spent the whole night just making out with him.”

“So why didn’t you?”

She leaned down, as though to kiss me too, then veered off. Her breathing tickled my ear.

“Because I needed to feel his cock again.”

Needed...Again... Her words set in like a fever. I felt delirious. Then I felt her pussy envelope my cock, molten. Tight. Still tight, despite all the

sex and the big cock.

“That feels good.” Dani sighed. “That feels right.”

We made love out there in the sun, as languid as a summer day. We kissed. We nuzzled. We tried a few positions on the lounge, but settled on the one we’d started in: Danielle straddling me as I held her close. She wanted me to cum inside her, and when she asked for it, I gave it to her gladly.

The come down was better than last night, when I’d been alone and Danielle and Sandy had each other, but it was still deflating. Sober and sated, my insecurities started creeping back.

“Last night, he asked if you’d thought of his—” Cock. “Of him. And you said that you did.”

“I think I said that it ‘crossed my mind.’” She knew she wasn’t going to get out of this one. “Yeah, I did.”

“A lot?”

“Yes.”

“Did you think about him when you were alone, and I was here?”

“Are you asking if I played with myself while thinking of fucking Sandy? Did the thought of his cock make me so horny that I couldn’t help slipping my hand inside my panties? Did I imagine my fingers were actually Sandy’s penis?”

She kissed the tip of my nose and smiled. She looked too sweet to be saying these things.

“Because if that’s what you’re asking, then the answer is yes. I sure did.”

With that, she stood, turned, and dove cleanly into the pool. My dick had begun to make an unlikely recovery, waving wet and forlorn as I watched Danielle frolic.

We spent the next few hours out on the patio. Danielle sunned nude, vowing to fight back her tan lines. I went and got a suit. I’d burned the sensitive skin on my cock once before—a painful lesson I only needed once.

I fixed us a lunch from Sandy’s surprisingly well-stocked fridge and we even managed a brief call with our son. After a week at camp, he’d practically forgotten who we were—a claim that we could almost make ourselves.

“So you really liked watching us?” Danielle asked in the last hours of the afternoon. Sandy had texted that he was on his way back and Danielle had slipped back into her bikini.

“Do you really have to ask?”

“Don’t be sarcastic, dear. I’m serious. I know it turned you on—the evidence of that’s pretty overwhelming.” She laughed. “But did you *like* it?”

It was a more complex question. I still didn’t have a good answer for it, although I’d started to work something out.

“Do you like your job?”

Dani looked confused. “Yes. You know I do.”

“Does it excite you?”

“Sure. Parts of it, anyway. I mean, HR can be tough at times, but mostly it’s about giving people the tools to grow—both professionally and personally. And that’s really fulfilling.”

“But you also have to fire people. Do you like doing that?”

“You, of all people, know that I don’t.”

I grinned. “You know, if you hadn’t fired me, we might never have met. But that’s getting away from my point.”

“Which is?”

“You take the good with the bad. The ‘employee termination’ side is just as much a part of your job as lunch-and-learns and handing out bonuses.” I was totally rambling, but the thread started making sense.

“Now, while it may seem like how you feel about your job and how I felt last night watching you and Sandy might be apples and oranges, the same kind of applies. My emotions were all over the map. But did I like it?” My cock had begun to rise. “Definitely.”

Danielle sat, thinking. I hated that I couldn’t see her eyes behind her sunglasses. “So there was bad?”

“There was jealousy.” And more. “Seeing you like that, so into it with another man, was sometimes hard to watch. But like I’ve said, it was also really sexy.”

Until the moment passed, then I felt like shit.

She sensed my unspoken caveats. “What else?”

I wished I had sunglasses of my own. I felt naked under her gaze.

“After I came...those times were the hardest. The most sobering.”

Danielle nodded. "I know what you mean. That's how I felt, too. I felt so guilty, once the moment had passed. Like, how could I do something like that? How could I risk what we have?" She pointed between us. "Was I insane, to give it all up for a great orgasm?"

Great, huh?

"Exactly. How could I have pushed you into another man's arms just for a quick thrill? Was I the stupidest man on earth?"

"I think what we need to recognize is that we're not in this alone. You didn't push me into anything. And I'd never fool around with Sandy without you." She stood and moved to my lounge, pushing her sunglasses into her blonde hair. "Last night, knowing you were up there, watching me, was...wow."

"Best night of your life?"

"Maybe most exciting. In a purely sexual sense."

"Better than anything back in college?"

"Oh, definitely. I mean, I loved that I could let myself go like that... and I'm not going to lie, at times, I wasn't thinking a whole lot about you. But I loved that I knew you were there when I did."

"Gee, thanks."

"Maybe tonight, you can do more than just watch."

I hadn't expected that. "Really?"

Danielle giggled. "Yeah. If we're being completely honest with each other—and I'm honest with myself—I think I've wanted to be with two guys since... well, for a while."

"Since the last time you were with two guys?"

She flushed. "Yeah, I guess. It's not a major fantasy or anything, but... yeah."

So she'd been with both guys during that encounter, way back in school. Had she been with the other girl, too?

"You know, we'd need another woman to complete that fantasy."

"For your version, maybe." She laughed. Typical Dani response. Then she surprised me. "Maybe we can see if Sandy knows someone."

"Really?"

"I'm not promising anything. But you haven't truly met the Danielle of old. Maybe tonight you will?"

Chapter 9

Foursome Girl

Sandy and I were waiting for Danielle to emerge from the bedroom, where she'd spent the good part of an hour primping and preparing. We were about half way through the drinks Sandy had fixed us when he gestured to the stairs.

"This is where I'm supposed to make a joke about women taking forever to get ready, right?"

"That's usually how that conversation goes, yeah," I replied.

He nodded, sipped, then shook his head. "See, I don't really have a problem with it. I mean, what's a little waiting for beauty? Where's the rush?"

I totally agreed, and told him so.

Were this not the man fucking my wife, I could really be friends with him. Thing was, we could never be friends. Not anymore. Not with the deceit between us. If he found out the true relationship between Danielle and I, he'd either be angry or hurt, and I didn't want to think about the repercussions of either. Not yet. Maybe not ever.

No, I had to be content with this moment, sipping bourbon with the man and enjoying his casual outlook on life. Maybe I could learn something from this. *What would Sandy do?* Would Sandy balk at prospect of hanging out with his wife and his wife's lover for a night? Would it have his stomach in knots?

"See? Now that's worth the wait."

Danielle emerged, and Sandy was 100% right.

"Wow, you look gorgeous," I said.

I only realized how inappropriate the compliment was coming from someone who was supposed to be a complete stranger, although neither seemed to notice. Sandy was too busy drinking her in.

The black dress was unlike any I'd ever seen on Danielle—the kind of dress Danielle derisively associated with sluts and trash. As short as last night's outfit without the costume-quality, the strapless wrap dress covered just a little more than a towel would.

"I think you two dropped your jaws on the floor."

Her heels clicked along the tiled floor as she crossed the room—approaching Sandy, not me. This game still managed to disorient me, even with all the lines we’d crossed, and as I watched her kiss Sandy—lightly to protect her lipstick—I hardened enough that I had to adjust.

“Who’s DD tonight?” Dani asked. She took Sandy’s bourbon out of his hand and sipped. “Not it.”

I was about to offer when Sandy shook his head.

“Oh no. No one’s holding back tonight. You’re my guests. I’m not letting either of you do that. We’ve got a driver tonight. Car’s waiting outside.”

“You really know how to impress a girl.” She linked arms with Sandy, but her toothy smile was for me. “What do you think, Dean, should I sleep with him tonight?”

Déjà vu coiled around my response.

“Only if I get to watch.”

“Hmm...let’s see how the night goes first.”

Having had this conversation before didn’t diminish the shivering excitement that surged up and down my spine now.

The car turned out to be a stretch limo, idling glossy and white under the warm lights of Sandy’s driveway. Danielle looked back at Sandy, impressed. The driver opened the door, and I caught myself staring at Danielle’s legs as she climbed in. Looking over at Sandy, I wasn’t the only one. He met my eyes and nodded with a grin.

We opened a bottle of champagne on the way into town—of course—but only finished half before we arrived.

“We’ll finish that on the way back.”

Just like every other night that I’d been out with Sandy, he walked into the restaurant knowing half the people there. He knew the hostess, waved hello to people on our way to the table, and even knew the guy sitting next to us.

“Long time, Jared. How’ve you been?”

“I can’t complain. Business has been decent. I’m out in LA. Just a tourist now, I guess.” He laughed. “You?”

“Still doing the surfing thing.”

If I'd thought Sandy looked like a meathead when I'd first met him, it was only because he hadn't been standing next to Jared. Shaved head, earring, arms as thick as my thighs, Jared made Sandy look like an adolescent. Things had started to go south for him too, I could tell. Those arms didn't bulge as much as I imagined they had a few years ago, and his barrel of a chest was showing signs of flab. That didn't diminish the bravado that dripped from his pores.

"Who do we have here?" he asked. The question was clearly not about me.

"Where are my manners? This is my newest business partner, Dean." At my name, Jared seemed to notice me for the first time. I waved. "And this is Danielle."

It was weird, not being introduced as a couple.

"It's nice to meet you." His gaze flickered over me before lighting on Danielle. "You're too good for this guy."

I felt the hackles rise on the back of my neck—and the jab wasn't even directed at me.

"I don't think I'm very good at all." Danielle batted her lashes. My pants tightened.

"OK, now I know you definitely should be with me."

Danielle leaned against Sandy, who put his arm around her. "I've never bought into the idea of what I should and shouldn't be doing. I do what I like. What turns me on."

When she looked at me, I read the look: are you ready for this ride?

"So what turns you on?"

"All kinds of things—most of them not appropriate for dinner conversation."

Jared licked his lips. That's how I felt, too: hungry for more of this sexy woman who looked like my wife.

"Try me."

Dani always liked a challenge.

"Sure, but I'm not volunteering. You get one question, and I'll promise to answer truthfully."

"Anything?"

"Anything. But let me get my drink first. I'll take a margarita." With that, she excused herself to the restroom, leaving us to watch her walk away, hips swinging.

Jared turned to Sandy as soon as she was out of earshot. “She’s smoking. How did you manage that?”

Sandy shrugged. “You can think it’s luck if you want.”

“Oh, I did. As soon as you sat down.”

“And yet here you are, eating alone.”

I pictured antelopes striking skulls, although I wasn’t sure even an antelope would fair so well against Jared’s large dome.

“You were always the luckier one, Sandy. So tell me, she as good as she talks?”

“Better, although she’s not as easy as you probably think.”

“But you’ve fucked her.”

“I’m not gonna lie. I did.”

It was like I wasn’t even there. This was a locker room conversation about my wife, without anyone knowing it was my wife.

“You loosened her up for me. Thanks, bud.”

“We should all dream boldly.”

“That body’s one I could dream about. It for real?”

“It sure is. All natural, nothing added, but everything removed, if you know what I mean. But it’s not just her body alone that makes her so amazing.”

“I’m gathering that. She’s feisty.”

“She’s got a head on her shoulders.”

“And a mouth that can get pretty filthy. She a screamer?”

Sandy winked at me. “She can get pretty loud. Dean knows about that.”

“The two of you tag-teamed her? Now I really need to get in on this.”

“You guys are talking about me, I hope.”

Danielle returned before Sandy could correct Jared’s assumption. Our drinks arrived shortly after—margarita for Danielle, a bourbon for me. I didn’t even notice what the others had ordered. Hell, I didn’t even remember putting the orders in at all.

“So how do you know Sandy?” I asked.

“We grew up together. Learned to surf together.”

“Wait, you’re Jared Colston.” I made the connection moments after Danielle voiced it. “Only guy to make Sandy jealous.”

Jared turned to Sandy. “That true?”

“I was ready for the North Shore. I’d been dreaming about it. But you got to go.”

“You weren’t ready. Hell, I wasn’t, either. Your parents were just smarter than mine. But enough about that. Danielle here has a drink and I’ve got my question.”

Danielle sipped her margarita. “I’m ready. Bring it.”

“Ever been with more than one guy at once?”

Dani’s lips curled upwards. “Somehow, I knew that’d be the question.”

“Must be wishful thinking. So?”

“Yes.”

Her small answer made a huge splash, even though I knew the answer. Jared pressed. “By ‘been with,’ I mean fucked. At the same time.”

“I’m following. The answer’s still yes.”

I took a quavering breath. My heart raced.

“Together?”

Danielle laughed. She put on a face that probably looked confident to Sandy and Jared, but after years of marriage, I didn’t miss the tightness in her smile and the color at the base of her neck.

She answered, steady and open.

“Together. At the same time. One did his thing behind me while I did mine to the other.” She scooped up salt from the rim of her glass and sucked it off. “Oh, and yes, I loved it. Too much.”

That last was said with a glance at me. That wasn’t for show or effect. That was genuine. Breathing became even harder.

“Do you want to do it again?” For a beat, I thought the question had come out of my own mouth. It was exactly what I was thinking, right down to the thinly veiled suggestion.

But Danielle kept looking at Jared. “I told you, you get only one question.”

“Come on, baby, don’t be coy. We all know you want it.”

“I do? “

“Hell yeah. If you loved last night too much, tonight is going to drive you insane.”

“Last night?” Danielle looked at Jared, then at me, confused, before she got it. “Oh, right. *Last night.*”

Jared thought her threesome confession wasn’t from the distant past, but something the three of us had already done.

Jared plowed on, mistaken assumptions and all. “Sandy, I never got your whole aloha spirit philosophy, but I’d like some.” He was looking at Danielle like she was a sizzling steak that had just been set down.

Now it didn’t take years of marriage to see her fluster. It was clear enough to all.

“I’m sorry to disappoint, but that’s not how it works.”

“Do you need another drink then? Because you can’t tell me that a chick wearing that dress, out to dinner with two guys she’d just fucked, doesn’t work that way.”

That was the sound of the evening crashing around us. All the courage Danielle had to build to get to here was balanced with the weight of how wrong it was. Even her dress stretched the comfort zone of the woman I’d married. In one sentence, Jared tipped the scales in the worst possible direction.

“Does that usually work for you? Being rude and disrespectful?” Danielle delivered the questions cool and even. “If so, then I feel sorry for the women who fall for it.”

OK, so maybe Jared hadn’t ruined the night after all.

Before Jared could recover from the rhetorical lashing, Danielle pressed her attack.

“Each of these guys are way more of a man than you will ever be, and I get them both. When you go home tonight, whether it’s alone or with some sorry and insecure companion, I want you to think about all the dirty things I’ll be doing with Sandy and Dean. And when you do, think about how I rejected you—”

“You bitch!” Jared lashed out at her, quicker than I’d thought a guy his size could. Sandy was there to block the blow and suddenly, our table and everyone around us was on their feet.

Everything happened so fast. Plates crashed to the ground. Sandy was in Jared’s face, shoulders back and fists clenched. Danielle curled up against me, under my arm.

“Time to go, old friend.” I could see Sandy’s jaw clench and grind.

Jared glanced at us, then back at Sandy. For a split second, I was sure things would escalate. Violence waited in the wings.

Then Jared backed off, hands up as he salvaged the pride that was as shattered as the plates around him.

“Where’s your fucking aloha spirit now, *Alexander*? Aren’t we all God’s creatures, or whatever the fuck?”

And he was gone. So were our appetites. We’d supped on adrenaline and were all ready for a change of scenery. Sandy grinned at us as the dust settled.

“You two up for some dancing?”

After the eventful dinner, the electric buzz of the club felt right. Our crackling adrenaline beat in sync with the wild electronica. We harmonized with the strobe lights. And when Sandy bought us a round of tequila shots, the night truly began.

Nuance had been a lounge. The Beach Club had a gimmicky charm. 727 was a club, from the glitzy dress code to the hard techno that rattled my eardrums. There would be no conversations here, only drinking and dancing.

Sandy knew people here, of course, although I didn’t catch most of their shouted names, and when I did I promptly forgot them. I was too preoccupied with Danielle and Sandy and what a beautiful couple they made.

“So we meet again.” The husky voice in my ear could only belong to one person: Avery.

“Are you sure you’re not stalking me?” I asked, turning to bask in her beauty.

She was glammed up tonight, wrapped in a shimmering red mandarin minidress with her hair up in a tight bun.

She squinted at me. “Pretty sure you’ve got that backwards, dude. Fourth time in a week definitely puts you in stalker territory.”

“Well, if I had to inadvertently stalk someone, I could have done worse.”

Her nipples pushed through the scarlet silk of her dress. Was she wearing a bra?

“Your words say one thing while your eyes say another,” she said.

I dragged my gaze back to her batting lashes. Busted. “Four times is a bit much for coincidence. What’s going on here, seriously?”

“Well, the first three really were coincidences. Tonight, I was invited.”

Avery brushed by me to say hello to Sandy and Danielle. There were warm hugs exchanged by the women and greetings shouted into one another's ears. Sandy and Danielle had gone to Nuance last night. They must have run into Avery there.

I reached for my drink, only to find it empty. Maui was a small place and the circle that Sandy ran in was even smaller. Avery said that my secret was safe with her, but sooner or later, it would slip. It made thinking about our departure from this paradise that much easier.

As I watched Avery and Danielle exchange whispered words, my paranoia made itself known in stomach-turning magnificence. Was my secret already out? Did Sandy know?

The man himself clapped his hand over my shoulder and I jumped. "Having fun?"

"Yeah," I yelled back. "Those two look close."

"It's a nice sight, isn't it?"

Whatever they were talking about, it was about me. Or Sandy. They kept looking over us and giggling.

"Something happen last night?"

Sandy grinned. He didn't reply immediately.

My eyes widened. Heat built around my collar.

"Not exactly. Not like you're probably thinking." He smiled and waved at the women. "But Danielle did confess that she found Avery sexy."

He stared at Sandy, who was still focused on my wife. "Like, she's interested?"

"More like curious."

"No shit." No shit!

Avery whispered into Danielle's ear. My wife stared at me before nodding. Next thing, she was being led by the hand onto the dance floor by the leggy model.

"I invited Avery to see just how curious Danielle was," Sandy said.

The women found the rhythm before they stepped out on the floor.

He went on. "Told you tonight was going to be fun."

I thought about the blondes I'd watched dance last Saturday—less than a week and it felt like ages ago. That had been a tempting sight. Now that it was my wife out there, shaking her hips in time with another woman, I was enraptured.

So was the rest of the room—the male half, anyway.

Unlike those blondes last week, Avery and Danielle didn't crawl all over one another. They didn't hump and grope. But they were together, without a doubt. They did it with their eye contact, gazes fixed and swimming. They did it with the sway of their hips and how they'd continue to whisper and flirt as they danced.

It was a show—had to be—but they didn't look showy. They looked like a couple. Sandy and I watched them through two songs before he suggested that we join them.

Automatically, I went for Danielle. Only when Sandy got to her first did I remember that tonight, she wasn't mine.

Avery leaned close to Danielle, whispering something into her ear that made my wife laugh out loud. Avery leaned back and wiggled her ass against me.

"We were wondering how long it would take you boys to come join us. We were just getting cozy."

"I could see that," I said.

"I have a feeling that by the end of the night, things are going to get much cozier."

Avery must have felt my cock lurch against her backside, but said nothing. Instead, her hips drove against me, in time with the beat, as Danielle got her freak on with Sandy.

I'd watched her dance with other men before, including Sandy, of course, but I'd never been so close. I could reach out and touch her. Avery did, brushing the backs of her fingers along Danielle's blushing cheek.

Danielle glanced at me as she reached behind Avery's neck and pulled the other woman close. Then all her focus was on Avery—and mine on the women as they kissed.

Excitement seared through me. My stomach twisted—for the first time this week without a hint of jealousy or unease. I clung to Avery's hips as I watched their mouths open to one another and their tongues played.

Their lips parted as smoothly as they'd come together. Danielle's face was flush. From excitement or embarrassment? She turned away before I could tell, wrapping her arms around Sandy and drawing him into a hard, passionate kiss.

Avery caught my head over her shoulder and pulled me down to hers.

"Enjoy that?"

She didn't wait for my answer. She kissed me, too. I tasted Danielle's lipstick on her. To resist didn't even cross my mind. My cock, digging into this luscious woman's ass, was in full control.

We held the over-the-shoulder kiss long enough for my hands to climb up the lower reaches of her ribcage and confirm that she wasn't wearing a bra beneath the blood red dress.

Before I could collect her small breasts in my palms, though, Sandy interrupted the moment.

"Let's get out of here."

Remembering where we were, my eyes flew open. I snapped back to the present—to the throb of techno and the press of the dancers around us. And to Danielle, who'd just watched me kiss another woman in front of her for the first time. Her brow was creased a bit, her blue eyes curious rather than upset.

"Yeah, let's go." Was that really me saying that?

Danielle held my eyes for a long moment. *You sure about this?* she seemed to ask, and suddenly I wasn't.

"Cool, let me go close my tab," Sandy said. We all made our way off the floor. Sandy broke off, and Avery followed, saying that she had to do the same.

Alone in a crowd, at least for a moment, the silence and the staring continued. Where to begin? What to say? Danielle spoke first.

"Watching you kiss Avery—"

"I'm so sorry about that."

She shook her head. "No, don't be." She let out a ragged breath. "It was so hot."

"What?"

"I think I'm starting to understand how you feel. It made me jealous, seeing you kiss her, but at the same time..." She shook her head and leaned in. "I'm so horny."

We risked a kiss. For a heated moment, I didn't care if Sandy or Avery discovered us. I needed to feel my wife's touch and tongue. "Same with you and Sandy."

"And me and Avery?" She looked wicked, lips curled up at the ends.

"No jealousy there. That was just hot. But I thought you weren't attracted to women..."

“I never thought I wanted to be with other men, either. Things change.”

That was true—and probably the most frightening thing about our game. Things changed, and when they did, would we still be together?

Danielle saw the anxiety on my face.

“Honey, if you want to stop, just tell me and it will. I can still get out of tonight. I can say that my friend called and needs me there. Or that I’m just not feeling it tonight. Or that I got ill.”

She was giving me a way out that didn’t jeopardize the contract. Tonight couldn’t be blamed on the circumstances or the set-up. If we went forward, we did so because we both wanted to.

“I don’t want to stop. Do you?”

“No.” Danielle’s single word answer reminded me how uncomfortable it could be to have an erection in a pair of fitted trousers.

“And what if Avery wants to play?”

“With you?” Danielle’s face danced. “Or me?”

“Would you mind if she played with me?” I asked.

“I’m counting on it.”

“And what about her with you?”

She bit her lower lip, her long lashes fluttering. Her answer was the same: “I’m counting on it.”

The limo idled outside the club, waiting us to emerge from the club. It was just past 11 and a line still stretched along the side of the building. I felt their eyes and their envy. Here I was, exiting with a couple of beautiful women walking ahead of us, hand-in-hand in tiny dresses.

They climbed in first, flashing bare legs and inviting smiles. Avery caught me trying to look up her dress, winking as she followed Danielle into the cab of the limo. My heart clamored to keep up.

The black leather seating stretched down one side of the limo. Opposite was the bar, lit by neon blue and fully stocked. Our half-finished bottle of champagne sat chilling in a bucket of ice, surrounded by four empty flutes.

Danielle and Avery settled at the front of the limo, up against the privacy window where the bench bended. Arms entwined, they made quite a pair. Sandy glanced at me, grinning, and pulled the door shut behind us.

Into the intercom, he instructed the driver to take the scenic route home. Based on the way he watched the women, I knew what kind of scenery he had in mind.

“That was some show you put on in the club, you two.”

“What makes you think it was just a show?” Avery stroked Danielle’s bare shoulder with her thumb.

“Aves, I thought you were the one with the theory that women only behave that way to attract men?”

“Most of the time.” She turned to Danielle and kissed my wife softly on the neck. Danielle sighed, but didn’t protest. “But sometimes, the attraction is genuine. Wouldn’t you say so, Danielle?”

Dani looked at us, heavy-lidded. “Sometimes it is, yes.”

Then she turned to Avery and kissed her on the mouth, her tongue unraveling. My jaw went slack. My cock strained. The kiss turned into more. Their hands explored, relishing in the soft feel of womanly skin. Danielle caressed Avery’s neck and face before making tentative passes along the other woman’s silk-covered breasts. Avery began at Danielle’s legs and climbed higher until her hand disappeared beneath my wife’s short dress.

Danielle broke the kiss with a gasp, rocking her head back and Avery’s wrist twisted between her thighs.

“I can’t wait to taste you.” Avery kissed Danielle’s exposed neck.

Danielle moaned, biting her lower lip. She lifted a leg onto the seat, spreading herself for Avery and the other woman teased her neck. When Danielle started gyrating her hips against Avery, there was little doubt about what was going on—or that Danielle was into it.

Sandy poured two glasses of champagne and we silently toasted the scene that was unfolding. Danielle’s eyes fluttered open at the clink, but only for a moment.

As Avery worked Danielle’s neck with her mouth and sex with her right hand, she teased my wife’s breasts, cupping and squeezing through the black dress. Avery pulled at the top, easing both dress and strapless bra low enough that a pink nipple popped into view, long and swollen. My mouth watered to taste it. Avery did.

“Ngh!” Danielle seized up, stuffing Avery’s mouth with breast as her body brimmed with orgasm. Avery didn’t relent, sucking Danielle’s nipple between her lips as the hand between her thighs went to furious work.

“Oh my God. Oh my God!”

Watching Danielle come was like watching the sun breach the horizon in the morning. I was dazzled, unable to focus on anything but the unfolding beauty before me. Only this wasn't the sun. This was my wife. With another woman. Coming in heaving proclamations.

Sandy set his glass of champagne down, grabbed the bottle, and slid across the seat, over to the two.

Avery sat back, withdrawing her glistening fingers from between Danielle's thighs, and licked them one by one.

“That was beautiful,” Sandy said. He offered her the bottle. “Drink?”

Danielle nodded, reaching for the bottle, but Sandy pulled it away. “Allow me.”

Sandy lifted the bottle to Danielle's lips. I expected protest, but she offered none, letting herself be fed. Sandy pulled the bottle away, but not before some of the golden bubbly overflowed her lips. He kissed down into her, tasting the fizz on her mouth as he drove his tongue home.

Avery didn't remain idle. Looking at me brightly, she slipped to the floor between my wife's thighs. I'm not sure Danielle even knew what was happening. She was too busy kissing Sandy and enjoying the way his hands palmed her breasts to feel Avery's touch up the outside of her thighs.

I rubbed myself through of my pants, rocking my fingers across the steely column. I considered abandoning modesty and pulling it out, but despite what was unfolding before me, I couldn't take it that far. Not yet.

We were on the highway now, gliding by street lamps that illuminated the darkened cab of the limo in measured strafes. I felt like I was blinking too slow, and with each blink, something new was revealed: Avery reaching beneath Danielle's dress; Danielle lifting her hips to allow the other woman to pull her thong down her thighs; Avery kissing up the inside of Danielle's thighs as my blonde wife looked on, her breathing short and labored.

The slow strobe of the lights caught the sheen of Danielle's sweat, dreamy in the half-dark. It danced in the glistening rise of her bare mound and the shine of Avery's dark, pinned-up hair.

Danielle's arched back, the tip of her tongue digging into her upper lip as Avery's mouth found her sex. Auburn hair blocked my view, but my imagination—and Danielle's moans—filled in all that was needed.

I rubbed harder, feeling a cramp develop in the meat of my thumb. Once again, I thought about unzipping myself. And once again, I dismissed

it. There'd be time for that later. For now, I wanted to savor this sight.

Danielle lounged as far back as she could on the cushioned bench. She lifted her leg over Avery's shoulder as the other woman's head bobbed and rocked between her thighs. Sandy attacked her tits, pushing the top of her mini down until it looked more like a girdle than a dress.

"Uh, God. Uhmygod!" Danielle bucked and cried beneath the onslaught. The limo seemed to pick up speed down the road. The lights blurred by, faster and faster. Danielle buried Sandy's face between her tits and closed her thighs around Avery's head as pleasure overwhelmed resistance and she crashed through her orgasm.

I barely escaped my own, having to yank my hand away as I felt my balls tighten and my breath catch. Even then, I almost filled my shorts with cum as the writhing scene before me played out. That was my wife in the middle of those tangled body. My wife who'd just come at the hands—and tongue—of another woman.

And we hadn't even reached our final destination.

I downed the last of my champagne, feeling the fizz down my throat. The limo had come to a stop. When had that happened? I blinked. We were idling in front of Sandy's home.

Looking back at the threesome, my cock jumped again. Avery and Danielle were kissing deeply, sharing the taste of my wife's climax.

Sandy slid away, headed for the door.

"Ladies, why don't we take this some place more comfortable?"

Nothing that followed felt real. How could it be? Danielle and I were normal people, leading normal lives in a normal suburb. We had one kid and dual incomes. We had coworkers we liked enough to eat lunch with but not dinner. And when it came to sex, we were more vanilla than Ben & Jerry's.

And yet here I was, reclined on a white sofa—the same white sofa I'd watched Danielle get fucked on the night—as two sexy women sucked my cock.

Danielle had been the one to suggest it. Otherwise, I don't think I would have felt comfortable doing anything physical in front of her. "Dean has been so patient," she'd said to Avery.

"He has."

“Want to show him some love?”

“Yes,” Avery said.

I was caught in a current stronger than I could ever swim. They led me to the couch, pushed me back, and smothered me. Avery’s lips found mine as Danielle went to work on my belt and trousers.

“You’re not getting away from me tonight.” Avery’s whispered promise put me off balance. Danielle mouth descending over my hard-on had me reeling.

My wife watched me between my legs, deep pools of blue that swirled with lust. She turned her head and licked along my shaft, zigging and zagging across the underside in a way that had me shuddered after the second pass.

By the time she made a third, Avery joined her on the floor. She tucked a strand of blonde hair back from Danielle’s face and watched my wife swallow my erection. I couldn’t remember a time when I was this hard—and that was counting all the moments of this past week. And I grew harder still when Avery ducked beneath Danielle’s bobbing face to swallow my balls.

This is what it felt like to be struck by lightning. There was no way to prepare. The jolt came from nowhere, burning every molecule in my body. I arched off the sofa, ramming my cock down Danielle’s throat.

Danielle gagged. That sound and my concern were all that kept me from losing it. My eyes fluttered open. The apology was poised on my lips. Danielle recovered before I could voice it, gripping my cock and regaining control.

After that, it was bliss. The two women worked me like they’d been doing it for a lifetime. At first, they simply traded off, one sucking me as the other lapped at my balls. I couldn’t take my eyes off them, but even if I had, I would have known whose mouth was on me from the technique. Danielle’s was tender and familiar. Avery’s mouth was an adventure in new sensation.

When they started working my shaft together, lips and tongues rising on either side of my shaft, I knew my time was imminent. I watched as their tongues slithered and sliced, mouths meeting above my cockhead where they shared a deep kiss.

After that, I held on as long as I could, but I was done. I exploded in Avery’s mouth as Danielle kissed her neck and fondled my balls. Avery

took it all, pulling away once the pulsating stopped. She turned to my wife, pulled her close for a kiss.

They giggled as they swapped spit and cum, but after half a minute, the kiss turned passionate. As droopy eyed as I was, I couldn't take my eyes off of them. Danielle held nothing back.

Avery pulled her mandarin dress open. She was nude beneath but for a red g-string, visibly damp.

"Do you eat pussy as well as you suck cock?" Avery asked.

"I don't know. I've never done that."

"But you want to?"

Danielle's eyes were all over Avery's slender body and small breasts. "Yes."

My ears burned. I wouldn't have believed what I'd heard had I not watched my wife crawl across the floor and peel Avery's panties off. Even then, I could have denied that this was happening, until Danielle buried her face between the other woman's legs.

Avery gasped, tossing her head back.

"Yes, baby. Just like that. Do what comes natur—AL!"

Avery glanced at me with a smile that said, *That's right, your wife is eating my pussy*. My cock began to rise again as my heart pumped hard and fast.

Then entered Sandy, stage left. I'd been so focused on the girls that I'd forgotten all about our host. He was nude and erect, a sculpture of man in its purest form: hard, cut, and unabashed. He didn't go to Avery, but to Danielle's side, running his hand down her spine.

"How does she taste? Is it everything you imagined it would be?" His hand disappeared beneath her dress. She squirmed, but kept her mouth on Avery. "Listen to her moan. Hear how short her breaths are? That's because of you, you naughty girl."

Sandy's words—or maybe his fingers—spurred Danielle on, which in turn pushed Avery's pleasure higher. She cried out, now fully into the feel of my wife's ministrations.

"God, that's so hot, watching you eat pussy. Guess you're not bi-curious anymore, are you?"

Danielle moaned, wiggling her hips against Sandy's hand, but only lapped faster.

“I can feel how excited this is making you. You’re so fucking wet.” He kissed the back of her neck. “Make her cum and I’ll be sure to reward you.”

Fully recovered from my own orgasm, I sat up just in time to watch Avery rock through her own. She lifted her hips off the floor, grinding her cunt against Danielle’s face as she let loose a long, guttural cry.

Flopping back, she ran her hands across her high forehead and into her hair, which had started to unravel from its bun.

“Jesus. I’ve been with too many girls just doing it for show. I’d forgotten what it was like to be with a chick who’s really into it.”

Danielle blushed as Sandy helped her to her knees. “Just doing what came naturally.”

“Then I’d say you’re a natural.” Avery set her head back down and stared at the ceiling, glassy-eyed.

Me, my attention was all on Sandy and Danielle. Jealousy coursed through my veins as freely as hot blood, but I was powerless to move. I kept waiting for Danielle to look in my direction, to check my expression and ask if it was ok to proceed with the lift of a brow. But she did none of that. She never took her eyes off of Sandy and his godlike body.

“Want your reward?”

Danielle nodded.

He unclasped the wrap dress, and it quickly pooled around her ankles. Her panties were still back in the limo and he made quick work of her bra. Her tanned skin was glossy with sweat, and this scene felt torn from the pages of a high end men’s magazine.

Sandy held up a wrapped condom.

“Open it. I think you’ll like what I got you.”

Danielle tore open the foil wrapper with her teeth and rolled it along his thick member. We hadn’t used a condom in nine years, but Danielle looked like she’d been doing it forever.

Sandy took her hand and pulled her back into the sofa behind him. He sat first, she followed, straddling his hips and positioning his latex-encased cock against her glistening opening.

There was no glance back at me. No check to see if this was all right. This was a line they’d ready crossed, again and again, yet to me, every time felt as raw as the first. Danielle sank down onto Sandy, a slow, torturous penetration. Was he really that big? Did it really take that much care to get acclimated?

“She loves his cock.” Avery’s words crawled inside my head. “Watch her hips rise and fall. Slow. See? She’s savoring it.”

I’d seen them together before, but not like this. Up there in the loft, I was far enough removed that it took on a show-like quality. I was up there, where reality was anchored, and crazy stuff was happening down here.

But now, I was in the moment. I couldn’t deny that my wife was bouncing up and down on another man’s cock, even if I wanted to—and I didn’t. Even with her back turned completely to me, there was no mistaking it was Danielle. I recognized that ass that Sandy was cupping. Those were the dimples I loved so much, pips in her lower back. Her bikini tan had begun to fade with her recent nude sunbathing, but even those lines teased me: this is Danielle, this is your wife, and that is not you beneath her.

She braced herself on Sandy’s shoulders and started gyrating faster. Sandy’s squeezed her buttocks, guiding her along his length. The moans quickly followed.

I felt something on my own cock, resurrected and stronger than ever. Avery’s hand. It felt warm and firm. And elastic? Looking down, I realized she was rolling a condom on. Alarm bells started going off. No, I couldn’t do this. I couldn’t—

And then I looked into Avery’s eyes, wide and hazel and inviting, and knew I didn’t have a chance.

“Don’t think about it,” Avery whispered. “You think they’re thinking about you?”

With that, she climbed into my lap, facing out, and impaled herself on my dick.

Even through the latex, Avery’s pussy felt sleek and new. Her orientation lasted three, slow strokes. From there, she fucked like the porn star that she was. She moved her hips in ways I’d never experienced before.

Yet despite her driving fuck, I couldn’t keep my eyes off Danielle, and as good as Avery felt, it was my twisting gut that dominated all other sensations.

Sandy noticed us first. A whisper from him and Danielle turned to look, too. Her eyes grew wide, jumping from my face to my buried cock.

Guilt burned through me. I felt caught—busted, like she’d just walked in on me cheating. My adrenaline spiked and suddenly, my balls were tightening, filling my condom with cum in my shame.

Danielle saw my face grow slack as my orgasm ambushed me. Her eyes went wider, although the shock I saw there was replaced with something fiery. She started fucking Sandy faster, even as my cock grew soft. Her bounces sent wet slaps to my ears.

Avery slipped off my lap when I was done unloading. She sank to her knees, plucked the condom off, and covered my semi-flaccid cock with her magical mouth.

On the other couch, Danielle and Sandy rearranged themselves. Lying on their sides, Sandy entered my wife from behind, lifting her leg to rest on his hip. I had a clear view of his girth dipping in and out of her bald snatch. But even that lewd sight wasn't going to be enough to get me up after coming twice in quick succession.

Sandy spooned Danielle, tweaking her nipples as she rolled through another noisy climax. His hips drove hard enough to break up her moans, a skipping record of sex.

And the whole time, Danielle's eyes were on me, squinting and creased—sometimes no wider than slits—but never wavering. Sandy came behind her, grunting out his orgasm as he filled the condom. At last, the couple across from us went still.

I didn't know what to say for the longest time. No one did. Avery crawled up beside me. She smelled fresh and feminine, but in such a different way than Danielle. I shot a glance at my wife, who continued to watch me. There was contemplation behind those blue eyes now. Was she okay with what just happened? More than anything, I wanted to take her somewhere private to talk, but here, with our ruse, that was impossible.

So I excused myself to go to the bathroom, more to splash water on my face than relieve myself. The image staring back at me was as familiar as my wife had been out there: same hooked nose and dark hair, same dark eyes and broad shoulders. But did I really know this man? He'd just fucked another woman—fucked her and enjoyed it. My cock began to rise at the thought, even as everything else roiled with guilt.

I forced my mind to Danielle, who shared as much of the blame, but at least I'd given her permission.

The doubt arrived on fluttering wings. Would I have given permission if I'd known just how into it Dani would be?

My cock rose higher at that thought, too. She'd truly given herself to Sandy, and would give herself to him again and again before the night was

over. The thought excited, even as it sliced me to tatters. Tonight, the lines were clear: she was his, and Avery was mine.

I ran into Danielle just outside the door. She'd slipped Sandy's shirt on without buttoning it. Before I could analyze what that meant, though, she grabbed me and kissed me hard. Then it didn't matter. I collected her close. It was good to feel something familiar for a change.

"That was so hot," she whispered after the kiss.

"So you're okay?"

Her eyes told me *not quite*.

"Yeah. But it's weird." She chewed on her lip. "Now I definitely know how you feel. How something can be so sexy, yet so maddening at the same time. When I saw you with Avery, the first thing I wanted to do was claw her off you."

I scratched the back of my neck. That wasn't good.

"We never talked about her and I—"

"I'm not upset. How could I be? And seriously, it was hotter than anything I've seen... maybe ever." She kissed me swiftly. "You better get back out there before they suspect something's going on."

I nodded. "I love you, Dani. If you want me to stop, just say so. Okay?"

"Oh, Dean. I love you, too. And hell no, I don't want you to stop. Before the night is over, I want you to fuck her while she goes down on me."

And with that, she slid into the bathroom, leaving me with a towering erection.

Sandy and Avery had moved into the kitchen area of the main room, casual despite what had just happened. Sandy wore a tattered robe I'd seem him wear after a surfing outing, and Avery hadn't bothered to cover herself at all. As I approached, I realized how out of my league I was. These two were beautiful creatures with bodies sculpted for sex. I was just a guy with a fantasy.

"Someone's ready for round two." Avery noticed my erection right away. "Glass of water first?"

She half turned, inviting me to look at her nudity—an invitation I gladly accepted. Things had been so frantic and focused on my wife that I hadn't had a chance to check her out until now. She looked the same as she had in her videos, although maybe a shade paler. Model slim with small,

high breasts and narrow hips, I had a hard time wrapping my brain around the fact that I'd just fucked her. And would be fucking her again.

Before the night is over, I want you to fuck her while she goes down on me.

I glanced between her legs, where her thin landing strip adorned her oiled pussy, and blushed.

"I don't think he heard you," Sandy said.

"Sorry, what?" When I met their eyes, my flush deepened.

"I was commenting that you like to watch." Her mouth curled up wickedly. "And while it was fun to watch with you, I'm more about being watched."

"Then I just made your day." I hoped my smile came off as more confident than the way I felt.

She sidled up close, leaning into me. Her voice rolled across me like distant thunder. "You more than made my day earlier. You and your sexy-ass wife." Lightning was in her eyes.

I realized what she'd just said, aloud, and whipped my head around. Sandy was gone and Danielle had not reappeared.

"Don't worry, we're alone."

I remembered how easy it was to be overheard in this house. "Still..."

Avery laughed. "Doesn't the fear of discovery turn you on? You're playing with fire, you know. I mean, just think about what would happen if Sandy knew..."

Panic began to claw up the inside of my chest. For the first time this week, it occurred to me that maybe Avery could easily blackmail us. She went from cool, laid back beach chick to something much more dangerous. Was that a touch of crazy dancing in her hazel irises?

Then she laughed again and the rising hysteria dissipated.

"I'm just fucking with you. You've got nothing to fear from me. Besides, Sandy probably wouldn't care. He'd probably think it's cool, what you and Danielle have...so long as he gets to keep banging her."

"Comforting."

"Should be, sweetie." The word sounded wrong off her lips. "As far as acting out sordid fantasies of wife watching and minor cuckoldry, this is about as risk-free as it'll ever get."

She had me there.

"In all seriousness, how are you doing? You okay?"

“I’m confused, but nothing new there.”

“There was something new, though...” She ran her hand along her shoulder blade. She had such well-formed breasts.

“Well, yeah. There was that. And that was weird at first, too. With you.” Glancing back up at her pretty face, I wasn’t sure I wanted to have this serious a conversation with her. “I haven’t worn a condom in years.”

“She loves you, you know. I can tell by the way she looks at you... and the way she looked at *me* when she saw us together. Fuck, I thought I’d be cut down by those lasers.”

“We talked in the hall. She’s not upset with you.”

“I know, but you of all people should know nothing is that simple. For example, I bet those two are fucking right now. How does that make you feel?”

Jealousy twisted in my gut. I told her as much.

“But you’re also turned on, right?”

“Crazy turned on.”

She closed her fingers around me. “Want to go watch?”

“Hell yeah.”

I could hear them from the top of the stairs. Danielle’s cries rose above Sandy’s, sharp moans that punctuated each thrust of his cock. “Ah! Ah! Yes!”

Avery squeezed my hand. We entered together.

At first, all I could see in the moonlight-drenched room was Sandy and his broad, muscled back. His hard ass, slick with sweat, clenched and fell, driving down into the bed—into Danielle.

I made out her legs, one splayed to the side, the other hoisted over Sandy’s shoulder. I could see her hand clinging Sandy’s neck as he fucked her.

Avery led me into the room. They didn’t take notice, even as we settled onto the bed beside them.

Danielle was an active participant in the wild copulation, driving her hips up with each of Sandy’s down strokes. She practically hung from her lover’s powerful frame, her entire body lifted from the bed more often than not.

“That’s so hot.” Avery’s whisper reminded me that I wasn’t alone in my voyeurism—that someone else was witnessing my wife’s sanctioned betrayal. “She should try out for Island Erotica. She’s a natural.”

I couldn’t deny it. I’d never seen her so into the sex, but I couldn’t tell if that was because I’d never her watched her fuck from the third person, or if she was more into it with Sandy than with me. The uncertainty unnerved me almost as much as it turned me on.

Sweat beaded on their tanned flesh as they entered the final fuck. Only Danielle’s shoulders and the back of her head touched the mattress. Sandy’s clutched her hips and ass and grunted through his final, fast strokes. Danielle released the hand on his neck, spearing it between her legs. She screamed and thrashed, damp golden hair whipping about her.

Sandy rammed one last time into my wife, bellowing as he ground his pelvis into her clutching sex.

When it was over, Danielle flopped back lifeless, her chest rising and falling in short, shallow breathes.

Avery kissed me. “I can’t just watch anymore.”

She crawled over to Danielle, swinging her leg over my wife’s face, and introduced Dani to the magic of a girl-on-girl sixty-nine.

From the way she kept her hair over her shoulder and out of her face to the way she dragged her long tongue across Danielle’s lower tummy, every action titillated—every move was part of the performance. I realized why she was so successful in her industry.

Ass poised high, Avery’s slim torso swooped down over Danielle. She closed her mouth over my wife’s mound like one savors a ripe peach. Danielle gasped, tipping her head back and clutching the sheets around her. Then Avery lowered her thighs, smothering the blonde with her sex.

Danielle didn’t hesitate. She returned Avery’s oral caress with equal ardor, curling her hands around the other woman’s hips and butt and lifting her head between Avery’s thighs.

Watching the two women shiver and ride each other left me dizzy with excitement. This thrill differed from the nauseating heat that came when watching Danielle with Sandy. No jealousy riddled the sight of these two. I felt no confusion at the sixty-nining female bodies.

I also couldn’t simply just watch. My cock was too hard and too ready. Danielle’s words returned as I grabbed a condom and moved into position behind Avery. *Before the night is over, I want you to fuck her while she goes*

down on me. While this wasn't quite what she had in mind, I didn't see any objection in her eyes as I looked down at her.

She'd pulled back from Avery's snatch to watch me, giving me a short nod. I slipped into Avery's buttery warmth without resistance, clutching my hips as I reveled in her.

As before, Avery had felt fantastic, new and different and totally not Danielle. When I felt Danielle's tongue swirl around my balls, I nearly lost it. I pulled back, unwilling to come after just a dozen strokes.

Danielle's mouth replaced my cock with her tongue. She flicked across Avery's clit and dragged her hips down against her face.

Throwing her head back, Avery cried out.

I glanced at Sandy, who was leaning against the wall. He held a drink in one hand and his swelling member in the other. He nodded and raised his glass to me. *Have fun, my friend.*

Taking a deep breath and my cock by the hand, I entered Avery again. And again, I nearly lost it after a handful of strokes. This time, I stayed inside her, glancing at the ceiling to stave off the orgasm.

That worked. Mostly. I felt my scrotum tighten. I felt the heady buzz of a rising climax. But somehow, I didn't come. Maybe it was the two earlier orgasms. Maybe it was the promise of so much more that night. Whatever it was, when I came down from those dizzying heights, still hard and still pumping, I didn't stop to dwell.

"Oh God! Oh God!" Even the way Avery cried out and came seemed designed to boil my blood.

Fucking a porn star made me *feel* like a porn star. I squeezed her hips until her skin turned white, drilling her as she rocked back. Danielle hooked a leg over her head and pulled the screaming woman against her sex.

I took her with longer and longer strokes—too long for Danielle to keep up her ball play. I could still feel her under there, tongue lapping at Avery's clit as we worked her hard. It felt good. We felt like a team again—although this was a sport I never thought we'd be playing together.

Sandy joined us at last, wanting in on the fun. He tossed back his drink, wiped his mouth, and knelt before Avery's face and Danielle's pussy, cock sheathed and full.

I felt Danielle's groan wash over my shaft and balls as he entered her. I swear I grew an extra inch.

Hips in hand, I rammed home, so hard that it drove Avery's clit against Danielle's fluttered tongue. Avery shrieked.

The sense of marital teamwork lasted one more keening moment. Then I saw Sandy there, bouncing his wonder dick inside Danielle, and the lines began to blur all over again. Partnerships started dissolving.

Avery reached out, grabbed Sandy's head, and planted a hard, deep kiss on him. The deconstruction of who was with who was complete. Pulling out of the kiss, she shared one with me over her shoulder as our foursome proceeded along its path to polyamorous oblivion.

I splayed my hand across her tailbone and rose up on my haunches. The angle assaulted her g-spot and felt fantastic with each pass: tight and hard and different. I could feel her kegel muscles rippling around my shaft, stronger than I thought possible.

Avery's voice was a hum in my ears, a bassy note to the staccato of our slapping skin.

"You like that? Dean?" She delivered her words in clipped bursts. "Feels good. Doesn't it? Almost as good as...Dani's tongue on my clit."

That image ended me. I lasted two more strokes before my balls tightened. This time, there was no stopping it. I didn't try. I ground my pelvis into Avery's plush ass, released the breath I'd been holding throughout the final stretch, and emptied my balls.

Avery joined me in total release with a satisfying cry. Her body shook with it. Her cunt milked me. I had to pull away, gasping, as things went from blissful to overwhelming.

I flopped back, exhausted. I'd run a marathon without leaving this house. My lungs couldn't take in enough air to fight off the stars the formed at the edges of my vision. I looked up at the ceiling, wondering if I was going to pass out, and forced breath in through my nostrils.

I felt the bed shift, but when I looked, I didn't comprehend. Avery turned onto her back, her legs wide. Danielle didn't hesitate. She repositioned herself with an eagerness that surprised me, and dove for the Avery's pussy.

I blinked slowly, unable to shake the fatigue of my climax. My eyes felt heavy, but I wasn't ready to sleep. I didn't want to miss a second. I rubbed my hand over my face, squeezed my eyes shut, then forced them open.

Sandy moved in behind Danielle, caressing her hips as he watched her eat Avery's pussy. He glanced at me, grinned as if to say, 'Enjoy the show,' and ran his glistening cock down the crack of her ass. All those fears of inadequacy came bubbling up again, but that grin was as friendly as ever. Enjoy. Watch. Watch me fuck your wife.

"Ngh!"

Danielle warbled cry shocked me awake again. She lifted her head from Avery's sex, her words ripping from her throat. He didn't take her gently. He didn't ease in. He rammed home, letting her feel the fullness of his cock.

"Oh, baby. Dani...uhhh...That's so fucking good."

She groaned and grunted with each thrust. "Fuck me. Fuck me!"

And he did. Truly and deeply. It was wild and hard. Unadulterated and adulterous. He took her as I'd just taken Avery—like a lover, not a husband.

Danielle rested her head on the inside of her Avery's thigh, but couldn't focus on the other woman any longer. Her concentration was fragmented. She'd lost her mind to the stretch of his cock and the clap of his heavy balls against her clit. Did she even realize where she was? Did she know who she was begging to fuck her harder?

Avery slipped away and crawled into my arms as we watched the lovers rearrange themselves. Without missing a beat, Sandy flipped Dani onto her back as he took them into their final act.

Danielle cried out, exploding in another orgasm.

"Yes, right there!" She oo'ed. She gasped. She writhed on his cock as he held her hips steady and drilled the last scraps of sanity from her.

Reaching down, he pulled her up onto his arms like she weighed nothing. Another orgasm took her—or maybe it was the same, reenergized. She rocked her head back and gyrated her hips on Sandy as he nuzzled her neck and racked his fingernails down her back.

"That's so hot," Avery whispered beside me.

She wasn't wrong.

"Fuck, babe, I can't hold back any more—"

Danielle pulled his mouth against hers and kissed him with a passion that would be burned into my brain for the rest of my life. Pain lanced through me as my sore cock jumped to life.

"So—uh...good!"

Danielle twisted away from Sandy as the man roared and dominated her body.

By the time they done, I was half-erect again, as battered and used as my cock was.

Avery rolled Dani onto her back and dropped between her thighs. Danielle shifted and sighed, but her reaction was muted.

I crawled over to her, brushing her golden hair from her face. Her lips parted, but her eyes remained shut: a maiden with a dream. I didn't stop to consider the situation—the complicated tangle of who was with who and how well I was supposed to know this gasping blonde. She was my soul mate, and nothing was going to stop me from what we did next.

Kissing her, I felt my cock harden one last, improbable time. I ignored the chafed soreness. I wasn't going to end this night without sharing it with my wife.

Avery demurred as I crawled over her. She gingerly took my cock and guided it against Danielle's slippery sex. Pain throbbed along my length as I pushed into her surprisingly tight pussy.

Danielle hissed, rocking her head back and curling a hand behind my head.

I breathed. I stroked a steady pace, lingering when I was fully embedded, always eager to push back in. The dull ache never went away, but the glide of Danielle's cunt helped me ignore it.

Everything that had happened prior to that moment was fucking: whether it was Sandy and Danielle, me and Avery, or the two women. Danielle and I made love, and we couldn't disguise it. Not in the gentle rise and swift fall of her hips. Not in the way we looked at one another. Not in the love we shared. And I didn't care.

Avery was the first to join us, leaning down to share a kiss with Danielle. The wet exchange reminded the two of us that we were not alone—but that we were far from apart. This time, as our twosome went from three to four, Danielle and I were at the center of it. Sandy and Avery were merely props to this debauchery.

Danielle flipped onto her hands and knees again, sucking on Sandy's cock as I took her from behind. Avery shimmied under us, suckling at Dani's tits and caressing my pounding balls.

Outside, the sky above the dark ocean began to blush. Morning arrived, yawning and slow. Night still ruled in the shadows of Sandy's

bedroom, where our pile of sweat-slick flesh danced and coiled.

Danielle yanked off Sandy, glancing back at me. Her face twisted with her imminent orgasm. Her cry was laced with hysteria. “Come, Dean. Plee —”

I did, triggering her release, last of the night. Avery had been exciting in her newness. Danielle just felt right.

As the four of us crawled beneath the sheets, I realized I’d fucked Danielle without a condom. If I’d had more energy, I would have laughed at the notion that fucking my wife bare-back could ever be considered taboo. But all I had energy was to lay down next to Danielle, with Sandy and Avery flanking us, and for the first time in two days, look into her eyes as I drifted off to sleep.

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Chapter 10

Sunset

I slept late into the next morning, my dreams fevered and strange. When I woke, I was alone in the tumble and tangle of Sandy's king. My mouth felt like a cotton ball and my morning wood screamed bloody murder.

The cobwebs refused to clear out. I glared up at the sun, which beamed through the skylights from its perch in the center of the blue sky. What time was it? My stomach groaned, empty.

Had last night really happened? I looked around. The room looked different in the brilliance of the Hawaiian daylight, but not different enough to convince me I'd dreamt the orgy. There was the console with its mini-bar, where Sandy had fixed his drink and watched us. There was the driftwood headboard. There were the doors that Avery had led me by the hand through. And all around me were the sheets, high in thread count and tussled like Danielle's golden hair by the time we found sleep.

I was naked, of course, but someone had left a folded robe at the foot of the bed. My legs ached when I got to my feet, and when I pulled on the robe, I learned that my arms ached even more. Hell, everything ached. My abs. My chest. The muscles in my ass. My cock most of all. I winced every time it stiffened—which was frequent as details from the night before returned.

The clock by the side of the bed read 12:08, but that had to be wrong. The last time I'd slept past nine in the morning was before our son was born. I didn't think my body was capable.

The house was quiet enough that I could hear the waves breaking up the beach outside. Sandy was in the kitchen, fixing a sandwich for lunch. He wore white cargo shorts and a Hawaiian shirt with the three buttons undone.

"Hey, man. You sleep well?"

"Yeah." I didn't know what else to say. "You?"

"After a night like last night, I always sleep well." Verbal confirmation that last night happened. "You hungry?"

My stomach grumbled. "Very."

He slid his plate across the counter. "Here. Eat up."

“I’m not going to take your lunch.”

Sandy waved it off and started making a second sandwich. “Danielle’s by the pool, sunning. Avery already left, but said to look her up next time you’re in Maui. Oh, and that she’s converting your account at IE to a lifetime membership.”

“How thoughtful.”

Sandy grinned. “That’s one name for her.”

I bit into the sandwich. The lettuce crunched and the fresh tomatoes awakened my taste buds. I was hungrier than I realized.

“We cool, Dean? Are you cool with last night?”

What I really wanted to do was talk to my wife and find out if she was alright, but she wasn’t here.

“Yeah. I mean, it was nuts—I’ve never done anything like that. But I can’t complain, either.”

Sandy seemed to analyze what I was saying as he laid slices of ham across his mayo-lathered bread.

“Glad to hear it. We’re going to be working together for a long time, I hope. I like you, Dean. And you know how much I like your wife.”

I froze, mid-bite. *Your wife?* I almost spit out the sandwich. Instead, I swallowed and coughed.

“You...know?”

“I’ve known since Tuesday. All it took was a quick Google search of your name. I was curious about you after that second meeting. Fuck, was I surprised when I discovered who your wife was.”

This was a nightmare. I had no words. The contract was gone, but that was the last of my concern. This could mean my job. Possibly my marriage. If this came out, what would our friends think of us? Our family? Our son?!

But...Sandy had mentioned working together for a long time. And he didn’t seem pissed.

“I’m sorry.” I didn’t know what else to say.

“Why are you apologizing, man? I think it’s awesome, what you two have. Kinky as hell, but also way cool. Not many couples share that kind of love and trust, like you and Danielle. You asked me last night about her. I told you then, I could see myself with someone like Danielle. You actually *are* with her.”

I hoped that was true after last night.

“And after watching you two together...” He shook his head. “Those were some fireworks, man. It was like catching the perfect wave.”

I could have said the same about watching him and her, but didn’t. “So you’re not pissed?”

“Not at all. Envious, maybe, but how can I be pissed? You let me bang your wife for a week.”

“When you put it like that...” It sent my heart racing all over again. “We didn’t know you were the client, last Saturday.”

“I was wondering about that. I figured that was the case. If this was all some ploy to get my business, you would have come out and introduced her to me. But you never struck me as the kind of guy who’d resort to cheap tricks.”

“Good, because I’m not.”

He sliced his sandwich diagonally. “Why don’t you take your lunch outside. I’ll give you guys some privacy.”

“Thanks man. I suppose we’ve got a lot to talk about.”

Sandy nodded. “And don’t make plans tonight. I’ve arranged something special.”

Special made me nervous, but what could I do? I’d relinquished control a long time ago.

Danielle was stretched out on her stomach, naked and shimmering. I stood at the sliding glass doors for a moment, just taking her in. Her tan lines were almost gone and her hair had lightened in the sun.

I wondered if she knew that Sandy knew, and if she did, when did she find out.

“You awake?” I took a seat on the neighboring lounge and set my lunch between us.

“Mm. Barely.” She cleared the sleep from her throat. “You’re finally up.”

“I can’t remember the last time I slept so late.”

“It was after your office Christmas party. That one with the open bar when that guy got fired. You slept until two the next day, if I recall. I remember because I went to the Johnson’s Christmas party alone.”

I did remember that now. It must have been seven years ago. “Glad I don’t feel like that. My head hurts just remembering it.”

Danielle pushed up onto her elbows. My eyes darted to her hanging breasts. “Still can’t get enough?”

“Dani, I’ll never get enough.”

“Good.”

She set her head back down and we stared at one another for the longest time.

“Want to talk about last night?” I asked.

I knew the conversation we had to have. It was as unnerving as it was unavoidable.

“So last night...” she said.

“Sure. It certainly was an eventful meal.”

“Yeah, last night...”

“I still can’t believe what we did.”

“I can’t, either,” she said, then added, “but my body sure can.”

“Yeah. You were incredible last night. I knew you had it in you—”

“Don’t, Dean. Don’t do that.”

“Do what?”

“Turn me into a slut.”

I touched her face. “I told you, baby, not a slut. You’ll never be a slut to me. Not the way you mean, anyway.”

She looked skeptical. “I can’t be her for you.”

“You don’t have to be.”

She shook her head, like I wasn’t getting something. “I can’t be her for you.”

It took a moment to sink in, and when it did, it dragged my insides with it. I spoke the obvious like an idiot. “But you can for Sandy...”

She couldn’t look me in the eyes, and that hurt more than the realization.

“Are you falling for him?”

She shot a hard look at him. “Don’t be ridiculous, Dean. It has nothing to do with that.”

“Then talk to me.”

“I love you. I *love* you. Understand? I can’t imagine spending the rest of my life with anyone else. You’re the father of my child. You’re the only man I’ve ever loved—or will ever love. You’re my soul mate.”

She sat up and knelt in the space between our chairs. This time, my eyes stayed on hers.

“I can’t be a slut for my soul mate. I’m sorry. I’ve tried. It’s not me. It’s not in my nature.”

“Last night—”

“Was crazy. A once-in-a-lifetime experience.”

“And you did it for Sandy?” My words felt like a cat-o-nine-tails raking across my back.

“He had something to do with it. So did Avery. So did *you* and Avery. But yes, I don’t think it would have happened without Sandy.”

She chewed on her words, but delivered them anyway.

“I realized something last night; why none of the other nights playing our game ever worked. I can’t just be a slut like that. Like I said, it’s not me. I don’t like feeling cheap. And I’m sorry to say, but sometimes when we go out, that’s how I feel.”

“And you don’t feel cheap with Sandy.”

It wasn’t a question, but she answered it anyway. “That’s not it, exactly. I just... I know he’s not judging me. On any level. He’s just not that kind of guy. I’ve never met anyone like him. Even with you, I worry about what you’ll think of me in the morning.”

“Well, it’s morning—or afternoon—”

“And?”

I wanted to give her an honest answer, but I wasn’t sure how I really felt. Some of what she said was true. I’d watched her fuck another man while she sucked my cock. Did that diminish the image of the woman I’d married?

“See? I knew it.” She didn’t blink, but I saw emotion build wetly in the rims.

I took her in my arms and pulled her until our foreheads touched and our noses nuzzled.

“Dani, I still love you as much as I’ve ever loved you. Even more. I love that you’ve got a wild side.” That felt true. “It’s a sexy little secret.”

“But you had to think about it. That’s why I can’t be that woman for you—”

I kissed her to stop this downward spiral. “You can be whoever you want to be, Dani. Stop over-thinking it. I love you just like this.”

Finally, a smile. “Naked and on my knees? I bet you do.”

That made me laugh. I did have one last serious question for her, though. “Did you know that Sandy knows we’re married?”

Dani didn't look surprised, but she still shook her head.

"I didn't, but I had a hunch. I got to thinking about it last night, when the three of us went out to dinner. Who does that for a brand new business partner? Who takes an associate out on a date with him, complete with chauffeur and limo?"

"You don't buy his aloha spirit thing?"

"Actually, I do. But that's not why he did what he did. We know that now."

"You're a smart one, Danielle Williams."

"So did you know?" she asked.

"I had no clue until he told me just now. Does it change anything? About how you feel about him?"

"I told you, I don't *feel* anything for him. Not like that. I mean, I feel a connection with him, but it's not love. I've only ever felt that with you."

"Okay, I can live with that."

"Good. Now, can you live with sharing the other half of your sandwich? I'm starving."

The rest of the afternoon passed just as I'd imagined a Hawaii afternoon should. We lay in the sun. We read. We shared light conversation. It was almost tranquil enough for me to relax.

Almost, but not quite.

I wasn't sure that was possible as long as Danielle and Sandy were in the same vicinity. I watched them on full alert, the knots in my neck tightening to hard little golf balls.

They behaved. Sandy was a perfect gentleman and Danielle seemed to take my concerns to heart. There was no touching, no overt flirting. They didn't sneak off to make out (or more). But I could feel the sexual frisson between them. It hummed and popped like power lines in the rain. I saw it in the way she looked at him a fraction of a second longer than she should. Or how Sandy's voice softened when they spoke.

She had given a part of herself to this other man—a piece that was never going to be mine. Was it ever meant to be? That stung. What happened to no secrets? To giving all of one another? Isn't that what a marriage was all about?

Danielle knew me too well not to pick up on my turmoil, but didn't say anything until dinner.

And what a dinner it was. Sandy had erected a cabana on the beach. The curtains were gathered around the posts to let the sun and the ocean breeze in. Sandy cooked the meal himself, grilled fish served on a bed of rice and pineapple chutney. He served us at a table for two, wearing a white tuxedo jacket mismatched with white board shorts and worn sandals.

"You're not going to eat with us?" I asked because I knew Dani wouldn't.

"Not tonight. Tonight's your last night here. It should be special. When you're finished eating—or need anything else—just text me and I'll come out. Now, enjoy."

As he retreated back to his home, I thought about what Avery had said: *this is about as risk-free as it'll ever get*. She was right then, and she was right now. Sandy was non-threatening, respectful, yet charming enough to show Dani a good time. For Dani to have gone this far, she needed a guy like Sandy. The seduction couldn't have been built on booze and good looks alone.

But that right there was the double edged sword.

"So what's on your mind, Dean? Talk to me."

I wasn't ready for that conversation yet, but I had plenty of other questions.

"So you and Avery got pretty close. I didn't know you liked girls."

Her hands twitched to cover her blush, but she didn't. "I didn't, either. God, I can't believe I did that."

"Do you regret it?"

"No."

I didn't think so. "Did it turn you on?"

"What do you think?"

She wore her black and white striped bikini. With her hair fixed up with a flower, nothing shielded me from the evidence of her excitement; her nipples speared through the bikini top, high and hard.

"It's turning you on right now. You want to do it again."

"What about you? Did it turn you on, watching me with her?" She ran her foot up my leg and nuzzled it against my crotch. "Feels like a yes."

"Watching you turns me on, yes, but we've established that for a while."

She batted her lashes. "We have, haven't we?"

"How about you? Are you still okay with me and Avery?"

Danielle nodded. "I thought it was really sexy. Especially at the end, when we were all together. I can kind of understand what you get out of it."

"Just kind of?"

"I don't think I'll ever understand it fully." She reached across the table and covered my hand. "I'm sorry, honey, but that's the truth."

I nodded. "I don't know if I will, either." We smiled, but didn't laugh. "But it's sexy. Just thinking about it gets me hard."

The image of Sandy's cock sinking into Danielle's glistening pussy sent a jolt along my length. I took a shallow breath.

"But?"

Here we were again, having the big conversation. With a glass of wine and some food in my belly, I was ready.

"I think of you and Sandy, and see you share something that I'm not a part of," I said.

She started to protest, but I cut her off.

"I know you love me. And rationally, I know that he's not a threat. Like, at all."

"But you're still jealous."

"Yeah. And I hate that I am, but I can't help it. I even get where you're coming from. You and I have history. You know that I prefer my tooth brushes green and my bacon extra crispy. You know things about me that even I don't. Like how I apparently prefer window to aisle seats."

Danielle covered her mouth as tears sprung to her eyes.

"I'm the first person you wake up next to and the last you see before going to bed. We finish each other's sentences. You already said it: we're soul mates. I get that." My vision blurred with tears of my own. "To me, you're one person. But to a guy like Sandy, you can be anyone."

She couldn't deny it. She knew I was right.

"I get all that, but honey. Baby," I said, squeezing her hands. "I want you to feel as open with me as you are with him. I may have been shocked by last night, but it was still incredible. I'm amazed that I can still learn things about you. Even now."

"Oh, Dean..."

"You keep worrying about being slutty. Being dirty. Like it's a bad thing. Something to hide away and be ashamed up. But I'm telling you, to

me, it's not like that. I'm not going to judge. I love all of you."

Danielle looked up at me with those bright blue eyes. Finally, her last defenses dropped away. Whatever guilt she'd been holding onto, whatever reservations she' She took a deep breath, held my gaze, and nodded.

We leaned in and kissed, tasting the salt of our tears on our lips. When we pulled back, I could see the sunset in her eyes, bright orange and vibrant pink over deep blue.

I took her by the hand and stood. Behind the table sat a cushioned lounge, striped green and white, facing the ocean. We sank into it, falling into each other's arms.

We kissed as the waves crashed up the beach. I ran my hand over the roll of her hip, slipping my fingers through the silky folds of her sarong. I could feel heat radiate through the gossamer material.

We undressed in the quiet of the setting sun. We didn't bother pulling the curtains of the cabana. The only home visible was Sandy's and we were beyond modesty with him.

When she reclined on the couch and looked up at me, I know she saw the man I'd just described: the one who met her at the end of the aisle at St. Anthony's almost ten years ago. I made love to her as that man, letting the past week wash away with the setting sun.

"Oh, Dean..." Her back arched as I entered her.

Even after riding Sandy's monster cock all night, she felt as good as she always had, tight and warm and familiar. There was symbolism there, but she felt too good for me to process it.

"Dani, baby, I love you. So much."

She wrapped her legs around me, squeezing with each down stroke. Welcoming. Encouraging. That was new; something learned from her lover. My cock flexed and grew as my heart trembled.

"Oh, Dean. Dean. Dean!"

My name off her lips washed away the building jealousy. She was here with me, mind and body. Time for me to do the same.

We rolled and shifted until she was above me. The sun's lazy journey to the edge of the ocean was almost complete. The watercolor trail of orange, red, and pink washed over our pumping bodies, clinging to our sweat.

I held Dani's undulating hips. Watched my cock dip in and out of her. Watched her flat stomach ripple and her soft breasts bounce. Watched her

watch me. Just watched.

She bent down, her lips inches from mine when I came. I pulled her head against me, hearing her sputter and gasp against my neck. She came quietly as I filled her, a secret orgasm that could only be shared by true lovers.

We rolled into a snug spoon, facing the beach. The brilliance in the sky began to yield to night.

As the last sliver of the sun fell off the horizon, Danielle broke the pleasant silence.

“I’d always imagined sex on the beach to be sandier.”

“Fantasies are like that, aren’t they? They’re never what you expected.”

“I’m sorry I said what I said earlier. If I can’t be someone for you, then I shouldn’t be her for anyone.”

“Too bad it’s not that simple, is it?”

She sighed in my arms.

“You know, you’re right about what you said earlier. About the kind of person I want to be in your eyes. But I don’t want to share any of me with anyone else. You’re my everything, and I want to be yours.”

“So what are you saying? That last night—that this last week—was a mistake?”

She snuggled back into me. “I don’t think so. Do you?”

“No,” I said. I didn’t know what it was.

“Tonight was amazing. The sunset. Being outside. Being with *you*. Of all the things we did this week—the waterfall, playing the game, and Sandy, of course—the best were the ones when *you* were there. I mean, playing with Sandy was one of the craziest, hottest things I’ve ever done in my life, but there was always something missing when it was just he and I. I just didn’t realize it until you were there to fill it.”

My heart swelled. “Interesting choice of words.”

“I’m being serious here, Dean!”

“You’re awesome, Dani. I love you so much. Every part of you, even the one that likes group sex.”

Now it was my cock that swelled.

“Aw. So romantic.”

She turned. The sun had set, but I could still see her face light up with a smile.

“I love you, too, even the man who gets off watching me have group sex.”

“You know, we still have most of the night, and Sandy right up there.” I picked up my phone and turned it over in my hand. “Want to practice being crazy for me?”

“I don’t think she’s someone I ever want to be comfortable with, but...” She took the phone from me and looked me in the eye. “...why don’t we see what happens?”

—we’re finished eating

Our bated breath filled the silence. And then:

—i’ll be right there

Danielle kissed me softly, held it, and released. “Whatever happens, don’t just watch me.”

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Epilogue

We slept for most of the flight home. I vaguely remember connecting in Honolulu and that the flight attendants wore bright blue Hawaiian shirts and orchids in their hair. Even the process of retrieving our car from SFO and driving home was shrouded in fog.

Was it possible to be hung-over from sex? That last night in Maui certainly tried to prove that theory.

Danielle had intended to make the night last; and it had—well into the morning. She teased us at first, sitting us side by side on the cabana couch as she alternated sucking us off. When her jaw began to get sore, she climbed onto Sandy and sank on his primed cock. After that, she alternated fucking us. Even then, she didn't let us come. Not until she'd found her own release with each of us.

I came first, despite already coming earlier, but Sandy wasn't far behind. We moved inside after that. Things got hazy. A group shower was involved. I remember groping her wet curves and how she said something about being smothered in man-flesh. I remember her dropping to her knees and fucking Sandy with her soap-covered tits. Then fucking me with them.

We slept a little. Fucked more. Close to sunrise, I woke to her fucking Sandy again, lost in each other. I just lay there and watched, my groggy mind happy for her before sleep took me again.

Sandy had insisted he drive us to the airport and walk us in. I was surprised when he pulled me in for a hug.

"Aloha, my friend. I'm looking forward to working with you in the future."

He hugged Danielle, too, although theirs felt more intimate.

"And you've been amazing. He's lucky to have you."

"And I'm lucky to have him." That smile was with me still, wide and bright.

We didn't discuss the future, although that conversation was out there, waiting to be had. It would be a good one, full of optimism and openness. We both knew it. Now was a time to reflect and revel.

Danielle and I had grown closer, learning something about one another that we didn't know we had. It was scary and exhilarating and profound.

Sandy would have had some surfing apology for the feeling: something about catching a new kind of wave and riding her to her breaks. I was just excited to discover it.

Was that our last adventure with Sandy? Not even close. Were there more firsts and new discoveries? Absolutely.

But that's a story for another time.

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